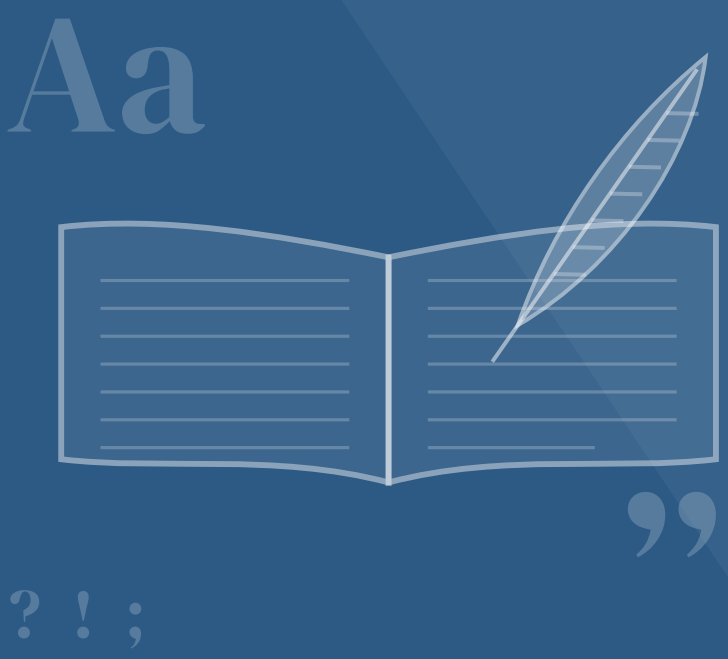
VENVLEARNING

STUDENT TEXTBOOK



English Language Arts

GRADE 7

Lessons, examples, and practice for the whole year

2026–2027 School Year · 9 units

VENVLEARNING

Grade 7
English Language Arts

STUDENT TEXTBOOK

2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 Language and Meaning
Unit 2 Long Passages and the Power of Nouns
Unit 3 Mystery and Grammar
Unit 4 Craft and Perspective
Unit 5 Modifiers and Precise Description
Unit 6 Sentence Craft
Unit 7 Voices of the Harlem Renaissance
Unit 8 Conventions and Word Choice
Unit 9 Capstone: Style, Revision, and Reflection

This book belongs to _____

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this book

Each lesson starts with an I can goal and a Get Ready question. Read the lesson with your teacher. Read the Model boxes to see how a strong reader thinks, then answer the Your Turn questions. Your practice pages are in your Student Workbook, labeled with the same lesson number. When a lesson says Read in Your Reader, read that chapter in your Core Knowledge Reader first.

- Key Idea boxes hold the most important rule or fact. Learn these.
- Watch Out boxes warn you about common mistakes.
- Every Friday there is a short Weekly Check in your workbook. The last Friday of a unit is the Unit Test.

Contents

Language and Meaning 8

Lesson 1.1: Reading Dickens's Language 10

Lesson 1.2: Greek and Latin Roots and Affixes 12

Lesson 1.3: Context Clues in Complex Texts 13

Lesson 1.4: Reference Tools and Word Origins 15

Lesson 1.5: Connotation and Denotation 16

Lesson 1.6: Figurative Language: Simile, Metaphor, and Hyperbole 18

Lesson 1.7: Word Relationships and Analogies 20

Lesson 1.8: Sound and Rhythm in Prose 21

Lesson 1.9: Citing Several Pieces of Evidence 22

Lesson 1.10: Inferring Character from Dialogue 24

Lesson 1.11: Inference in Informational Text 25

Lesson 1.12: Writing a Claim-Evidence-Reasoning Paragraph 27

Lesson 1.13: Theme and Its Development 28

Lesson 1.14: Central Ideas in Informational Text 30

Lesson 1.15: Writing an Objective Summary 31

Lesson 1.16: How Setting Shapes Characters and Plot 32

Unit 1 Study Guide 34

Long Passages and the Power of Nouns 35

Lesson 2.1: Tracking Multiple Plotlines 37

Lesson 2.2: Close Reading a Speech 38

Lesson 2.3: Inference Across a Long Informational Text 40

Lesson 2.4: Writing a Multi-Paragraph Evidence Response 42

Lesson 2.5: How a Scene Contributes to the Whole 43

Lesson 2.6: Analyzing a Famous Speech 44

Lesson 2.7: Comparing Text and Performance 46

Lesson 2.8: Writing a Scene Analysis 47

Lesson 2.9: Kinds of Nouns 48

Lesson 2.10: Noun Functions in Sentences 50

Lesson 2.11: Appositives 51

Lesson 2.12: Forming Nouns from Other Words 52

Lesson 2.13: Precise Nouns for Vivid Writing 53

Lesson 2.14: Possessive Nouns and Clear Reference 54

Lesson 2.15: Writing a Literary Analysis Essay 55

Lesson 2.16: Revising the Essay for Precision 56

Unit 2 Study Guide 58

Mystery and Grammar 59

Lesson 3.1: The Mystery Genre and Frame Narratives 61

Lesson 3.2: Pronoun Case 63

Lesson 3.3: Clear Pronoun Reference 64

Lesson 3.4: Characterization Through Description 65

Lesson 3.5: Building Suspense Through Pursuit 66

Lesson 3.6: Pronoun-Antecedent Agreement and Indefinite Pronouns 68

Lesson 3.7: Reflexive, Intensive, and Relative Pronouns: Who and Whom 69

Lesson 3.8: Writing a Character Analysis with Clear Pronouns 70

Lesson 3.9: Verb Tenses: Simple, Perfect, and Progressive 71

Lesson 3.10: Active and Passive Voice 72

Lesson 3.11: Verb Moods 74

Lesson 3.12: Analyzing Voice and Mood for Effect . . . 75
Lesson 3.13: Clues, Red Herrings, and Foreshadowing . . . 76
Lesson 3.14: Avoiding Shifts in Tense, Voice, and Mood . . . 78
Lesson 3.15: Writing a News Report . . . 79
Lesson 3.16: Editing for Pronouns and Verbs . . . 80
Unit 3 Study Guide . . . 81

Craft and Perspective . . . 82

Lesson 4.1: Word Choice and Tone . . . 84
Lesson 4.2: Structure: Letters, Documents, and Delay . . . 85
Lesson 4.3: How Sections Build an Informational Text . . . 86
Lesson 4.4: Technical Vocabulary . . . 88
Lesson 4.5: Point of View and Dramatic Irony . . . 89
Lesson 4.6: Author's Purpose and Point of View in Arguments . . . 91
Lesson 4.7: Acknowledging Other Viewpoints . . . 93
Lesson 4.8: Retelling from a Different Point of View . . . 94
Lesson 4.9: Testimony and Reliability . . . 95
Lesson 4.10: Pacing and Sentence Structure at the Climax . . . 96
Lesson 4.11: Symbolism . . . 97
Lesson 4.12: Writing a Craft Analysis Paragraph . . . 98
Lesson 4.13: The Confession and the Theme of Duality . . . 99
Lesson 4.14: Comparing Narrators Across the Novel . . . 101
Lesson 4.15: Fiction and History: Self-Experimentation . . . 102
Lesson 4.16: Writing a Comparative Analysis . . . 104
Unit 4 Study Guide . . . 105

Modifiers and Precise Description . . . 106

Lesson 5.1: Science Fiction and the Frame Narrative . . . 108
Lesson 5.2: Adjectives: Proper, Compound, and Coordinate . . . 109
Lesson 5.3: Adverbs and Their Placement . . . 111
Lesson 5.4: How Modifiers Create Description . . . 112
Lesson 5.5: Comparative and Superlative Forms . . . 113

Lesson 5.6: Phrases and Clauses as Modifiers . . . 114
Lesson 5.7: Misplaced and Dangling Modifiers . . . 115
Lesson 5.8: Precise Modifiers in Scientific Writing . . . 116
Lesson 5.9: Prepositions and Prepositional Phrases . . . 118
Lesson 5.10: Interjections and Tone in Dialogue . . . 119
Lesson 5.11: Conjunctions: Coordinating, Subordinating, and Correlative . . . 121
Lesson 5.12: Parts of Speech in Context . . . 122
Lesson 5.13: Analyzing Descriptive Writing . . . 123
Lesson 5.14: Planning a Science-Fiction Scene . . . 124
Lesson 5.15: Drafting with Precise Modifiers and Concise Language . . . 125
Lesson 5.16: Revising and Editing the Scene . . . 126
Unit 5 Study Guide . . . 128

Sentence Craft . . . 129

Lesson 6.1: Utopia or Dystopia? . . . 131
Lesson 6.2: Independent and Dependent Clauses . . . 132
Lesson 6.3: Four Sentence Types . . . 134
Lesson 6.4: Analyzing Sentence Structure for Effect . . . 135
Lesson 6.5: Revising a Hypothesis . . . 136
Lesson 6.6: Five Kinds of Phrases . . . 137
Lesson 6.7: Participial Phrases as Modifiers . . . 139
Lesson 6.8: Gerunds and Infinitives as Nouns . . . 140
Lesson 6.9: Allegory and Social Commentary . . . 141
Lesson 6.10: Combining with Conjunctions and Relative Clauses . . . 142
Lesson 6.11: Combining with Phrases . . . 143
Lesson 6.12: Precision vs. Over-Combining . . . 144
Lesson 6.13: Symbolism in the Palace and the Fire . . . 145
Lesson 6.14: Sentence Variety . . . 146
Lesson 6.15: Parallel Structure . . . 147
Lesson 6.16: Revising an Analytical Essay . . . 148
Unit 6 Study Guide . . . 149

Voices of the Harlem Renaissance 150

Lesson 7.1: Entering the Harlem Renaissance 152

Lesson 7.2: Analyzing a Poem: Dunbar's “We Wear the Mask” 154

Lesson 7.3: Comparing Sources: How Authors Shape Information 156

Lesson 7.4: Comparing Claims Across Sources 158

Lesson 7.5: The Great Migration: Causes and Effects 159

Lesson 7.6: Evaluating Reasons and Evidence 161

Lesson 7.7: Comparing Text and Data 163

Lesson 7.8: Writing an Argument with Strong Evidence 164

Lesson 7.9: The Black Press and Long-Passage Analysis 165

Lesson 7.10: Quoting, Paraphrasing, and Citing Sources 167

Lesson 7.11: Credibility and Accuracy of Sources 168

Lesson 7.12: Research Questions 169

Lesson 7.13: Locke's Argument 170

Lesson 7.14: Planning a Synthesis Essay 172

Lesson 7.15: Drafting the Synthesis Essay 173

Lesson 7.16: Revising, Citing, and Publishing 174

Unit 7 Study Guide 175

Conventions and Word Choice 176

Lesson 8.1: The Climax: The Trap of the White Sphinx 178

Lesson 8.2: Comma Rules 179

Lesson 8.3: Semicolons and Colons 180

Lesson 8.4: Dashes, Parentheses, Ellipses, and Advanced Capitalization 181

Lesson 8.5: Imagery and Mood in the Far Future 183

Lesson 8.6: Quotations and Titles 184

Lesson 8.7: Common Errors: Splices, Run-Ons, Fragments, and Agreement 185

Lesson 8.8: Editing a Passage in Context 186

Lesson 8.9: Evidence, Belief, and the Narrator 187

Lesson 8.10: Greek and Latin Roots Review 189

Lesson 8.11: Commonly Confused Words 190

Lesson 8.12: Spelling Rules and Patterns . . . 191
Lesson 8.13: Open Endings and Symbols . . . 192
Lesson 8.14: Using Reference Tools for Precise Word Choice . . . 193
Lesson 8.15: Concise, Formal Style . . . 194
Lesson 8.16: Final Edit of a Portfolio Piece . . . 195
Unit 8 Study Guide . . . 197

Capstone: Style, Revision, and Reflection . . . 198

Lesson 9.1: Langston Hughes and the Sound of a Poem . . . 200
Lesson 9.2: Tone and Mood . . . 202
Lesson 9.3: Developing Your Own Voice . . . 203
Lesson 9.4: Comparing Styles Across Time . . . 205
Lesson 9.5: Georgia Douglas Johnson: Building a Community . . . 207
Lesson 9.6: Transitions That Show Relationships . . . 209
Lesson 9.7: Text Structures . . . 210
Lesson 9.8: Cohesive Paragraphs . . . 211
Lesson 9.9: Elise Johnson McDougald: An Argument from Evidence . . . 212
Lesson 9.10: Revising Claims and Counterclaims . . . 214
Lesson 9.11: Revising Evidence and Citations . . . 215
Lesson 9.12: Revision Workshop . . . 217
Lesson 9.13: Dreams and Masks: A Conversation Across Generations . . . 218
Lesson 9.14: Year in Review: Reading Literature and Information . . . 219
Lesson 9.15: Year in Review: Language and Conventions . . . 220
Lesson 9.16: Portfolio Reflection and Presentation . . . 221
Unit 9 Study Guide . . . 222

Glossary . . . 223

UNIT 1

Language and Meaning

Dickens's language, roots and context, connotation and figurative language, evidence and inference, theme and objective summary, with A Christmas Carol, Introduction–Stave Three.

A cold-hearted miser, a ghost in chains, and three Spirits who visit on Christmas Eve: A Christmas Carol is one of the most famous stories ever written. In this unit you'll learn to read Dickens's language with confidence, unlock words with roots and context, analyze connotation and figurative language, support inferences with several pieces of evidence, and trace themes as they develop.

In this unit you will…

- Read a classic novella's language using translation strategies.
- Use roots, affixes, context, and reference tools to determine meaning.
- Analyze connotation, figurative language, word relationships, and sound.
- Cite several pieces of evidence to support inferences and claims.
- Determine and trace themes and central ideas; write objective summaries.

WHY IT MATTERS

Dickens wrote this story to change how readers treated the poor, and it worked; analyzing connotation and figurative language helps you see how ads, speeches, and news shape opinion today.

UNIT VOCABULARY

archaic	No longer in common use.
connotation	The feeling a word carries.
simile	A comparison using like or as.
theme	A message about life.
objective summary	A neutral, concise retelling.
parallelism	Repeating a grammatical pattern.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
1.1	Reading Dickens's Language
1.2	Greek and Latin Roots and Affixes
1.3	Context Clues in Complex Texts
1.4	Reference Tools and Word Origins
1.5	Connotation and Denotation
1.6	Figurative Language: Simile, Metaphor, and Hyperbole
1.7	Word Relationships and Analogies
1.8	Sound and Rhythm in Prose
1.9	Citing Several Pieces of Evidence
1.10	Inferring Character from Dialogue
1.11	Inference in Informational Text
1.12	Writing a Claim-Evidence-Reasoning Paragraph
1.13	Theme and Its Development
1.14	Central Ideas in Informational Text
1.15	Writing an Objective Summary
1.16	How Setting Shapes Characters and Plot

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · RL.7.4, RL.7.5

Lesson 1.1: Reading Dickens's Language

I can use strategies to read and understand the language of a classic novel.

WORDS TO KNOW

novella	A story longer than a short story but shorter than a novel.
archaic	Old-fashioned; no longer in common use.
narrator	The voice that tells a story. Dickens's narrator often speaks directly to the reader.

GET READY

Read this line aloud: "Old Marley was as dead as a door-nail." Why would a story begin by insisting that someone is dead?

READ IN YOUR READER

A Christmas Carol Reader · Introduction and Stave One (first section)

As you read: Who is Scrooge? How do other people react to him on Christmas Eve?

Dickens wrote A Christmas Carol in 1843, so most of his words are familiar, but some are old-fashioned or British, and his sentences can be long. Three strategies help: read aloud for meaning, translate old words, and break long sentences at their semicolons and commas.

Dickens's word	Modern meaning
'Change	the Exchange, where merchants met to do business
counting-house	a business office
humbug	nonsense; a fraud
dog-days	the hottest days of summer
rime	frost
comforter	a long woolen scarf
workhouse	a grim public home for the very poor

NOVELLA EXCERPT

From A Christmas Carol, Stave One (original text)

Charles Dickens, A Christmas Carol (1843). Public domain.

MARLEY was dead: to begin with. There is no doubt whatever about that. The register of his burial was signed by the clergyman, the clerk, the undertaker, and the chief mourner. Scrooge signed it: and Scrooge's name was good upon 'Change, for anything he chose to put his hand to. Old Marley was as dead as a door-nail.

"Bah!" said Scrooge, "Humbug!"

MODEL · TRANSLATE A SENTENCE

"Scrooge's name was good upon 'Change, for anything he chose to put his hand to."

1 'Change = the Exchange, where merchants did business.

2 his name was good = people trusted his signature.

3 anything he chose to put his hand to = any deal he signed.

Model answer: "The merchants trusted Scrooge's signature on any deal he made." He is respected in business, which tells us money is what he is known for.

KEY IDEA

Read aloud, translate old words, and break long sentences into parts. Meaning first, then details.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does "Humbug!" mean?
2. What is a counting-house?
3. What happens on Christmas Eve in the first section of Stave One?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Read aloud, translate old words, break long sentences into parts.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · L.7.4b

Lesson 1.2: Greek and Latin Roots and Affixes

I can use Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine word meanings.

WORDS TO KNOW

root	A word part that carries the core meaning.
affix	A prefix or suffix.

GET READY

What do benefit, benevolent, and benefactor have in common?

Root / affix	Meaning	Examples
bene	good, well	benefit, benevolent, benefactor
mal	bad	malice, malfunction, malevolent
liber	free	liberty, liberal, liberality
voc / vok	voice, call	vocal, invoke, revoke
dict	say	predict, contradict, verdict
spect	look	spectator, inspect, spectre
ject	throw	reject, project, eject
-ous / -ose	full of	covetous, morose
sol	alone	solitary, solo, desolate

MODEL · ANALYZE A WORD

What does malevolent mean?

1 mal = bad.

2 vol = wish (as in voluntary).

3 -ent = having the quality of.

Model answer: wishing harm to others; evil-minded

KEY IDEA

Break a word into parts, combine meanings, then check the context.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. benevolent
2. solitary
3. spectator

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Roots and affixes unlock meaning; confirm with context.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · L.7.4a, RL.7.4

Lesson 1.3: Context Clues in Complex Texts

I can use context to determine the meaning of words and phrases in complex texts.

GET READY

In “Many saved for months by joining a goose club, paying a few pennies each week to a shopkeeper,” what is a goose club?

Complex texts often define words indirectly. Use the sentence, the paragraph, and the overall meaning. Clues include definitions, restatements, examples, contrasts, and cause-effect relationships.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Christmas in Dickens's London

An original informational text

1 In 1843, London was the largest city in the world, home to about two million people. Its factories, banks, and docks made some families very rich. Yet many Londoners lived crowded into a single damp room, and a coal fire, a hot meal, or a pair of boots was a luxury.

2 For a working family, the Christmas feast took planning. Many saved for months by joining a goose club, paying a few pennies each week to a shopkeeper so that they could collect a goose at Christmas. Families with no oven of their own carried their dinner to the local baker's shop, where it was roasted in the big bread ovens for a small fee.

3 People who could not support themselves at all might be sent to a workhouse. Under the Poor Law of 1834, workhouses were made deliberately unpleasant: families were separated, the work was hard, and the food was plain and meager, so that only the truly desperate would ask to enter.

4 Christmas itself was changing. The first Christmas card for sale was printed in London in 1843, the same year A Christmas Carol appeared. Over the following decades, the holiday grew from a modest celebration into the family festival of gifts, feasting, and charity that Dickens's story helped to shape.

MODEL · USE PARAGRAPH CONTEXT

What was a goose club?

1 The sentence restates it: “paying a few pennies each week to a shopkeeper.”

2 The purpose follows: “so that they could collect a goose at Christmas.”

Model answer: a savings plan for buying a Christmas goose a little at a time

KEY IDEA

Use the sentence, the paragraph, and the passage's overall meaning to figure out unfamiliar words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why did families take their dinner to the baker's?
2. What does “deliberately unpleasant” tell you about workhouses?
3. What context clue shows how big London was?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use sentence, paragraph, and passage context.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · L.7.4c, L.7.4d

Lesson 1.4: Reference Tools and Word Origins

I can use dictionaries, glossaries, and footnotes to find meanings, pronunciations, parts of speech, and origins.

WORDS TO KNOW

etymology	The origin and history of a word.
glossary	A list of difficult words and their meanings, like the Words to Know boxes in your Reader.

GET READY

Where would you look to find out what "miser" means and how to say it?

Dictionaries give pronunciation, part of speech, definitions, and etymology. Your Reader's Words to Know boxes work like a glossary. Always check your inferred meaning against a reference.

MODEL · READ A DICTIONARY ENTRY

miser (MY-zer), noun. A person who hoards money and spends as little as possible. [Latin miser, wretched, unhappy]

1 Pronunciation: MY-zer.

2 Part of speech: noun.

3 Etymology: from the Latin word for "wretched."

Model answer: A miser hoards money; the word's origin hints that misers are unhappy, which is exactly Scrooge's problem.

KEY IDEA

Use references to confirm meanings, pronunciation, part of speech, and word origins.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How is miser pronounced?
2. What does etymology tell you?
3. What part of your Reader works like a glossary?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

References confirm meaning, pronunciation, part of speech, and origin.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · L.7.5c, RL.7.4

Lesson 1.5: Connotation and Denotation

I can distinguish between the denotation and connotation of words.

WORDS TO KNOW

denotation	A word's dictionary meaning.
connotation	The feelings or associations a word carries: positive, negative, or neutral.

GET READY

Would you rather be called thrifty or stingy? Don't they mean the same thing?

READ IN YOUR READER

A Christmas Carol Reader · Stave One (second section)

As you read: What is Marley's Ghost wearing, and why? Which words show how he feels about the life he lived?

Words with similar denotations can have very different connotations. Writers choose words to shape how readers feel.

OPINION WRITING

Two Reviews of the Same Restaurant

Original examples

Review A. The Harbor Grill is a cozy little spot with a relaxed atmosphere. The menu is simple, and the portions are generous. Service is unhurried, giving diners time to enjoy their meal.

Review B. The Harbor Grill is a cramped little spot with a sleepy atmosphere. The menu is limited, and the portions are excessive. Service is slow, leaving diners waiting for their meal.

MODEL · COMPARE CONNOTATIONS

cozy vs cramped

1 Denotation: both mean small.

2 Connotation: cozy = warm, comfortable (positive); cramped = uncomfortably tight (negative).

Model answer: Same size, opposite feeling.

KEY IDEA

Same denotation, different connotation. Word choice shapes the reader's feelings.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Connotation of “relaxed” vs “sleepy”

2. Connotation of “generous” vs “excessive”

3. Which review is more favorable?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Connotation shapes feeling beyond the dictionary meaning.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · L.7.5a, RL.7.4

Lesson 1.6: Figurative Language: Simile, Metaphor, and Hyperbole

I can interpret figurative language and explain its effect.

WORDS TO KNOW

simile	A comparison using like or as.
hyperbole	Deliberate exaggeration for effect.
extended metaphor	A metaphor developed over several sentences.

GET READY

What does Dickens mean when he says Scrooge is "solitary as an oyster"?

NOVELLA EXCERPT

Scrooge, Stave One (original text)

Charles Dickens, A Christmas Carol. Public domain.

Oh! But he was a tight-fisted hand at the grind-stone, Scrooge! a squeezing, wrenching, grasping, scraping, clutching, covetous, old sinner! Hard and sharp as flint, from which no steel had ever struck out generous fire; secret, and self-contained, and solitary as an oyster. The cold within him froze his old features, nipped his pointed nose, shrivelled his cheek, stiffened his gait; made his eyes red, his thin lips blue; and spoke out shrewdly in his grating voice. A frosty rime was on his head, and on his eyebrows, and his wiry chin. He carried his own low temperature always about with him; he iced his office in the dog-days; and didn't thaw it one degree at Christmas.

External heat and cold had little influence on Scrooge. No warmth could warm, no wintry weather chill him. No wind that blew was bitterer than he, no falling snow was more intent upon its purpose, no pelting rain less open to entreaty.

MODEL · INTERPRET

"Hard and sharp as flint, from which no steel had ever struck out generous fire."

1. Literal: flint is a hard stone; striking it with steel makes sparks for a fire.
2. Figurative: no one has ever struck even a spark of generosity out of Scrooge.
3. Effect: Scrooge seems cold, hard, and impossible to warm.

Model answer: The simile and the image of fire show that generosity cannot be struck out of Scrooge.

Cold runs through the whole paragraph as an extended metaphor: the cold inside Scrooge freezes his face, he “iced his office,” and he never thaws, even at Christmas. Today, calling someone “a Scrooge” means he or she is stingy, which shows how strongly Dickens's character has shaped our language.

KEY IDEA

Identify the device, explain the comparison, then explain its effect on meaning or mood.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Device in “solitary as an oyster”
2. What does it mean to call someone “a Scrooge” today?
3. Device in “he iced his office in the dog-days”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Device → comparison → effect.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · L.7.5b

Lesson 1.7: Word Relationships and Analogies

I can use relationships between words to understand each word better.

WORDS TO KNOW

analogy — A comparison of two pairs of words that share the same relationship.

GET READY

Complete: Captain is to ship as king is to ___.

Relationship	Example
synonyms	miser : skinflint
antonyms	generous : stingy
part to whole	link : chain
cause to effect	frost : ice
item to category	Scrooge : character
worker to tool	clerk : pen
degree	chilly : frozen

MODEL · SOLVE AN ANALOGY

captain : ship :: king : ___

1 Relationship: a captain rules a ship.

2 A king rules a ___ .

Model answer: kingdom

KEY IDEA

Name the relationship in the first pair, then find the word that creates the same relationship.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. loyal : traitor :: brave : ___

2. page : book :: stave : ___

3. drizzle : downpour :: breeze : ___

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Name the relationship; match it.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · RL.7.4

Lesson 1.8: Sound and Rhythm in Prose

I can analyze the effect of repetition, rhythm, and sound in prose.

WORDS TO KNOW

alliteration	Repetition of beginning consonant sounds.
parallelism	Repeating the same grammatical pattern, such as "no warmth could warm, no wintry weather chill him."
read-aloud prose	Prose written to be heard as well as read. Dickens performed this story on stage.

GET READY

Why might a writer pile up a long list of words instead of choosing just one?

Dickens wrote A Christmas Carol to be read aloud, and later performed it himself in theaters. His sentences have rhythm: he piles up lists, repeats patterns, and repeats sounds. Sound and rhythm help reveal character and mood.

MODEL · HEAR THE LIST

"a squeezing, wrenching, grasping, scraping, clutching, covetous, old sinner!"

1 Six words in a row all describe greed.

2 Most end in -ing and are full of harsh sounds (sq, wr, gr, scr, cl).

3 Effect: the list sounds like grabbing hands that won't let go.

Model answer: The harsh, piled-up list makes Scrooge's greed sound ugly and endless.

MODEL · HEAR THE PATTERN

"No warmth could warm, no wintry weather chill him. No wind that blew was bitterer than he…"

1 Parallelism: "No warmth… no wintry weather… No wind…"

2 Alliteration: warmth, warm, wintry, weather, wind.

Model answer: The repeated “No…” builds the idea that nothing at all can reach Scrooge.

KEY IDEA

Lists, repetition, parallelism, and repeated sounds create mood and reveal character.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Find the alliteration in “No warmth could warm, no wintry weather chill him.”
2. What pattern repeats in that sentence?
3. Why did Dickens care how his sentences sound?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Sound devices create mood and reveal character.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.9 · RL.7.1

Lesson 1.9: Citing Several Pieces of Evidence

I can cite several pieces of textual evidence to support an analysis.

WORDS TO KNOW

textual evidence	Quotations or details from the text that support a claim.

GET READY

Is one quotation enough to prove that Scrooge is starting to change?

READ IN YOUR READER

A Christmas Carol Reader · Stave Two

As you read: What does Scrooge see from his past? How does he react to each scene?

Grade 7 analysis requires several pieces of evidence. Choose evidence from different parts of the text, and introduce each with a phrase that shows where it comes from (Early in the stave… Later, at Fezziwig's party…).

MODEL · BUILD A CLAIM WITH EVIDENCE

Claim: Scrooge's memories begin to soften him.

1 Evidence 1: He weeps to see himself as a lonely boy left at school.

2 Evidence 2: He wishes he had given something to the boy singing a carol at his door.

3 Evidence 3: After Fezziwig's party, he wishes he could “say a word or two” to his clerk.

Model answer: Three pieces of evidence from different moments show a pattern of change.

KEY IDEA

Use several, varied pieces of evidence; show where each comes from.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why use evidence from different parts?

2. Introduce a quote with its location.

3. Who comes to bring young Scrooge home from school?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Several, varied pieces of evidence build strong analysis.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.10 · RL.7.1, RL.7.3

Lesson 1.10: Inferring Character from Dialogue

I can make inferences about characters from what they say and how others respond.

WORDS TO KNOW

subtext	The meaning beneath what a character actually says.

GET READY

When someone says “Nothing” in a quiet voice after a long pause, what do they really mean?

Dickens's narrator tells us a great deal, but some of the most important moments are left for readers to infer from dialogue, actions, and other characters' reactions. Listen for subtext.

Character	What they say or do (Stave Two)	What we can infer
Scrooge	After praising Fezziwig, says “Nothing particular,” then wishes to say a word to his clerk	He is thinking guiltily about how he treats Bob
Fezziwig	“No more work to-night. Christmas Eve, Dick. Christmas, Ebenezer!”	He is generous and joyful and treats his apprentices like family
Belle	“Another idol has displaced me… A golden one.”	She is hurt but calm; she sees that money now matters more to him than she does

KEY IDEA

Infer from dialogue, actions, and reactions; look for subtext.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is subtext?
2. What does Fezziwig's party show about him?
3. Why might Scrooge say “Nothing particular”?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Infer character from dialogue, actions, and reactions.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.11 · RI.7.1

Lesson 1.11: Inference in Informational Text

I can draw inferences from an informational text and support them with evidence.

GET READY

Why might Dickens have thought a story could change more minds than a report?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Why Dickens Wrote A Christmas Carol

An original informational text based on historical accounts

1 Early in 1843, the British government published a report on children working in mines, mills, and workshops. It described children as young as five or six working twelve hours a day. Charles Dickens read it and was horrified. He told a friend he planned to write a pamphlet, an appeal on behalf of “the poor man's child.”

2 That autumn he visited a ragged school, a free school run by volunteers for the poorest children in London. He saw children who were hungry, dirty, and had never been taught to read. A few weeks later, speaking to a crowd in Manchester, he argued that education was the best hope for children like these.

3 Dickens never wrote the pamphlet. Instead, he decided that a story would strike a much harder blow, because readers who would ignore a report might be moved by characters they cared about. Within about six weeks he had written A Christmas Carol.

4 Dickens also remembered his own childhood. When he was twelve, his father was imprisoned for debt, and Charles was sent to work in a factory, pasting labels on pots of boot polish. Many readers believe that this experience is one reason his story takes the side of poor children so fiercely.

MODEL · INFER

Why did Dickens decide to write a story instead of a pamphlet?

1. Evidence: readers “who would ignore a report might be moved by characters they cared about.”
2. Reasoning: people feel more for a person than for a statistic.

Model answer: Dickens believed a story would make readers feel for poor children and act.

KEY IDEA

Connect several facts to infer what the author implies but doesn't state.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What was a ragged school?
2. What report did Dickens read in 1843?
3. How long did it take Dickens to write the story?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Connect facts to infer implied ideas.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.12 · W.7.9a, W.7.1b

Lesson 1.12: Writing a Claim-Evidence-Reasoning Paragraph

I can write an analytical paragraph with a claim, multiple pieces of evidence, and reasoning.

WORDS TO KNOW

claim	An arguable statement that answers the question.
reasoning	Explanation of how the evidence supports the claim.

GET READY

What separates a summary from an analysis?

An analytical paragraph makes a claim, supports it with two or three pieces of evidence, and explains each with reasoning. It ends with a concluding sentence that connects back to the claim.

MODEL · CER PARAGRAPH

How does Dickens present Scrooge in Stave One?

1. Claim: Scrooge is presented as a man whose greed has cut him off from everyone.
2. Evidence 1 + reasoning: “solitary as an oyster.”
3. Evidence 2 + reasoning: his words about the poor.
4. Conclusion.

Model answer: In Stave One, Dickens presents Scrooge as a man whose greed has cut him off from other people. The narrator calls him “solitary as an oyster,” a creature shut tight inside a hard shell. When the gentlemen ask him to help the poor, he answers that if they would rather die, they should “decrease the surplus population,” showing that he sees suffering people as numbers. Dickens creates a character so cold that readers wonder whether anything could ever change him.

KEY IDEA

Claim → evidence → reasoning (repeat) → concluding sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Is “Scrooge lives in London” a claim?
2. What follows each piece of evidence?
3. What does the concluding sentence do?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Claim, multiple evidence, reasoning, conclusion.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.13 · RL.7.2

Lesson 1.13: Theme and Its Development

I can determine a theme and analyze how it develops over the course of a text.

WORDS TO KNOW

theme	A message about life or human nature that a text explores.
motif	A repeated image, idea, or symbol that supports a theme.

GET READY

What ideas keep coming up in A Christmas Carol so far?

READ IN YOUR READER

A Christmas Carol Reader · Stave Three (first section)

As you read: What does the Ghost of Christmas Present show Scrooge? How do the Cratchits celebrate with so little?

Grade 7 readers track how a theme develops: how it is introduced, how events and characters complicate it, and how it is resolved. Recurring motifs (cold and warmth, chains, money, light) point to themes.

Possible theme topic	Evidence so far (Staves 1–3)
generosity vs greed	Scrooge refuses to give; Fezziwig and Fred give freely; the Cratchits share a small dinner joyfully
isolation	“solitary as an oyster”; Scrooge alone at school; Belle leaves him
the chance to change	Marley warns Scrooge he still has “a chance and hope”; Scrooge weeps and wishes he had been kinder

MODEL · DEVELOP A THEME STATEMENT

Topic: greed

1 Introduced: Scrooge's coldness and Marley's chain.

2 Repeated: Belle says money has become Scrooge's idol.

3 Complicated: the poor Cratchits, with almost nothing, are happier than rich Scrooge.

Model answer: Theme: Greed cuts people off from the love and joy that make life worth living.

KEY IDEA

Track a theme through introduction, repetition, and complication; state it as a full sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a motif?

2. How does Stave Three develop the greed theme?

3. Write a theme about generosity.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Themes develop through introduction, repetition, and complication.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.14 · RI.7.2

Lesson 1.14: Central Ideas in Informational Text

I can determine two or more central ideas and analyze their development.

WORDS TO KNOW

central idea	A main idea that the author develops in a text.

GET READY

Can an article have more than one main idea?

Longer informational texts often develop two or more central ideas. Identify each and trace how details develop it.

MODEL · TWO CENTRAL IDEAS

"Why Dickens Wrote A Christmas Carol"

1 Central idea 1: Dickens was moved by the suffering of poor children in 1843 (paragraphs 1–2).

2 Central idea 2: He chose to answer that suffering with a story, shaped by his own childhood (paragraphs 3–4).

Model answer: The article develops both the problem Dickens saw and the way he chose to respond.

KEY IDEA

Name each central idea; trace the details that develop it.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which paragraphs describe what Dickens saw?
2. Which paragraph connects to his childhood?
3. Central idea of "Christmas in Dickens's London"

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Identify and trace multiple central ideas.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.15 · RL.7.2, RI.7.2

Lesson 1.15: Writing an Objective Summary

I can write an objective summary of a text.

WORDS TO KNOW

objective	Neutral; without personal opinions or judgments.

GET READY

What's the difference between "Scrooge is a horrible man who hates the poor" and "Scrooge refuses to give money to help the poor"?

An objective summary states the central idea or theme and key events in your own words, in order, without opinions, judgments, or minor details.

MODEL · OBJECTIVE VS SUBJECTIVE

Stave Two summary

1. Subjective: The wonderful Ghost shows heartless Scrooge his sad, lonely past...
2. Objective: The Ghost of Christmas Past shows Scrooge scenes from his life: his lonely boyhood, his sister Fan, Fezziwig's party, and Belle ending their engagement because he loves money more.

Model answer: Objective summaries report; they don't judge.

KEY IDEA

Objective = neutral, concise, central idea + key events, own words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Objective or not: "Fezziwig throws an amazing party."
2. Should an objective summary include "I think"?
3. What goes first?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Objective summaries are neutral and concise.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.16 · RL.7.3

Lesson 1.16: How Setting Shapes Characters and Plot

I can analyze how elements of a story interact, such as how setting shapes characters and plot.

GET READY

Why does it matter that A Christmas Carol takes place in a cold, foggy London on Christmas Eve?

Setting can create conflict, limit choices, and reveal character. Dickens's London is full of fog, cold, and poverty, but also of bright shops and warm homes. Christmas is the one time of year when Scrooge's coldness stands out most.

MODEL · ANALYZE INTERACTION

How does the setting shape the story?

1. Time: Christmas Eve, when everyone else is celebrating, makes Scrooge's meanness obvious.
2. Place: the foggy, freezing counting-house matches Scrooge's cold heart, while the Cratchits' small, warm home matches their love.
3. Effect: the contrast between cold and warm places shows what Scrooge is missing.

Model answer: The Christmas setting and the contrast between cold and warm places reveal Scrooge's character and set up his journey.

KEY IDEA

Analyze how setting creates conflict, limits choices, and reveals character.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How does Christmas Eve affect the way readers see Scrooge?
2. How is the Cratchits' home different from Scrooge's office?
3. How did London's poverty shape Dickens's purpose?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Setting creates conflict, limits choices, and reveals character.

UNIT 1 REVIEW

Unit 1 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
1.1	Read aloud, translate old words, break long sentences into parts.
1.2	Roots and affixes unlock meaning; confirm with context.
1.3	Use sentence, paragraph, and passage context.
1.4	References confirm meaning, pronunciation, part of speech, and origin.
1.5	Connotation shapes feeling beyond the dictionary meaning.
1.6	Device → comparison → effect.
1.7	Name the relationship; match it.
1.8	Sound devices create mood and reveal character.
1.9	Several, varied pieces of evidence build strong analysis.
1.10	Infer character from dialogue, actions, and reactions.
1.11	Connect facts to infer implied ideas.
1.12	Claim, multiple evidence, reasoning, conclusion.
1.13	Themes develop through introduction, repetition, and complication.
1.14	Identify and trace multiple central ideas.
1.15	Objective summaries are neutral and concise.
1.16	Setting creates conflict, limits choices, and reveals character.

UNIT 2

Long Passages and the Power of Nouns

Multiple plotlines, close reading, scene analysis, text vs performance, noun forms and functions, and the literary analysis essay, with A Christmas Carol, Stave Three–Stave Five.

As Scrooge's journey reaches its climax, you'll analyze long passages and famous speeches, see how each scene fits the whole story, and compare the book with stage and film versions. You'll also master nouns, the words that name everything from Marley's chain to generosity itself, and write a full literary analysis essay.

In this unit you will...

- Track plotlines; close read speeches; analyze how scenes contribute to the whole.
- Infer across long informational texts; compare text and performance.
- Identify kinds and functions of nouns; use appositives and possessives correctly.
- Write multi-paragraph responses and a literary analysis essay with integrated evidence.

WHY IT MATTERS

Integrating evidence, analyzing a scene's purpose, and choosing precise words are the same skills used in reviews, reports, and persuasive writing.

UNIT VOCABULARY

subplot	A secondary plotline.
close reading	Careful analysis of a short passage.
abstract noun	Names an idea.
appositive	Renames a noun.
thesis	An essay's central claim.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
2.1	Tracking Multiple Plotlines

Lesson	Title
2.2	Close Reading a Speech
2.3	Inference Across a Long Informational Text
2.4	Writing a Multi-Paragraph Evidence Response
2.5	How a Scene Contributes to the Whole
2.6	Analyzing a Famous Speech
2.7	Comparing Text and Performance
2.8	Writing a Scene Analysis
2.9	Kinds of Nouns
2.10	Noun Functions in Sentences
2.11	Appositives
2.12	Forming Nouns from Other Words
2.13	Precise Nouns for Vivid Writing
2.14	Possessive Nouns and Clear Reference
2.15	Writing a Literary Analysis Essay
2.16	Revising the Essay for Precision

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.1 · RL.7.3, RL.7.5

Lesson 2.1: Tracking Multiple Plotlines

I can track several plotlines and explain how they connect.

WORDS TO KNOW

plotline	A sequence of events involving one group of characters.
subplot	A secondary plotline that supports or mirrors the main plot.

GET READY

How many different Christmases does the Ghost of Christmas Present show Scrooge?

READ IN YOUR READER

A Christmas Carol Reader · Stave Three (second section)

As you read: Follow each group the Spirit shows Scrooge: the miners, the lighthouse keepers, the sailors, Fred's party, and the two children under the Spirit's robe.

A Christmas Carol follows Scrooge, but the Spirits also show him other people's stories. Each plotline develops separately, but they mirror Scrooge's story and connect to it.

Plotline	Characters	What happens in Stave Three	Connection
The Cratchits	Bob, Mrs. Cratchit, Tiny Tim, and the children	a joyful dinner; Tiny Tim is ill; Bob toasts Scrooge	Scrooge learns that his clerk's son may die
Fred's party	Fred, his wife, and their guests	games, music, and a toast to “Uncle Scrooge”	the family Scrooge refused still welcomes him
Strangers	miners, lighthouse keepers, sailors	people in lonely, hard places still keep Christmas	shows that joy does not depend on money

KEY IDEA

Track each plotline separately, then ask how it mirrors or connects to the main character's story.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a subplot?

2. What game does Fred's party play about Scrooge?
3. Who is guiding Scrooge through all of these scenes?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Track plotlines separately; analyze how they mirror the main story.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.2 · RL.7.4, RL.7.1

Lesson 2.2: Close Reading a Speech

I can analyze a speech closely for word choice, imagery, and what it reveals about a character.

WORDS TO KNOW

symbol	A person, object, or event that stands for a larger idea.
close reading	Careful, repeated reading of a short passage to analyze its meaning and craft.

GET READY

Why would Dickens give two starving children the names Ignorance and Want?

NOVELLA EXCERPT

The Ghost of Christmas Present, Stave Three (original text, excerpt)

Charles Dickens, A Christmas Carol. Public domain.

"They are Man's," said the Spirit, looking down upon them. "And they cling to me, appealing from their fathers. This boy is Ignorance. This girl is Want. Beware them both, and all of their degree, but most of all beware this boy, for on his brow I see that written which is Doom, unless the writing be erased."

"Have they no refuge or resource?" cried Scrooge.

"Are there no prisons?" said the Spirit, turning on him for the last time with his own words. "Are there no workhouses?"

At the end of Stave Three, the Ghost reveals two children hiding under his robe. Close reading asks: What does it say? How does it say it? Why does it matter?

MODEL · CLOSE READ

"This boy is Ignorance. This girl is Want. Beware them both… but most of all beware this boy."

1 What: the Spirit names the children as symbols of society's problems.

2 How: short, blunt sentences; warning words (beware, Doom).

3 Why: the children belong to all of "Man," so everyone, including Scrooge, is responsible for them.

Model answer: The Ghost turns two children into symbols to warn that ignoring poverty and lack of education will bring disaster.

KEY IDEA

What does it say? How does it say it? Why does it matter for character or theme?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does "Want" mean here?
2. Why must Scrooge "most of all beware this boy"?
3. Whose words does the Spirit repeat?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Close reading: what, how, why.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.3 · RI.7.1, RI.7.3

Lesson 2.3: Inference Across a Long Informational Text

I can make and support inferences across a long informational text.

WORDS TO KNOW

reformer	A person who works to improve society.
ragged school	A free school for the poorest children in Victorian Britain.

GET READY

Why might some people in 1843 have opposed helping poor children?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Ignorance and Want in 1843

An original informational text based on historical facts

1 When the Ghost of Christmas Present reveals two starving children named Ignorance and Want, Dickens was not inventing a fantasy. In 1843, thousands of children in London never went to school. Many worked from the age of six or seven, sweeping chimneys, selling matches, or sorting rags. Others had no work and no home at all.

2 Some reformers tried to help. Volunteers opened ragged schools, so called because the children who came were dressed in rags. The schools were free and met in whatever rooms could be found, often in the poorest streets. Teachers taught reading, writing, arithmetic, and religion, and some schools gave out bread and clothing.

3 Dickens visited one of these schools in September 1843. He wrote to a wealthy friend, Angela Burdett-Coutts, who gave large sums to charity, describing the crowded room and the children's hunger, and asking her to support the school. He believed that a child who was never taught anything would grow up with no choices except crime or the workhouse.

4 Not everyone agreed. Many comfortable people argued that the poor would only become idle if they were helped, and that prisons and workhouses were enough. Dickens put those very words in Scrooge's mouth, and then had the Ghost throw them back at him.

5 Over the next decades, Britain slowly changed. Laws limited children's working hours, and in 1870 Parliament began creating schools for every child. Dickens did not live to see all of these changes, but his story helped persuade a generation of readers that the poor were not a “surplus population” but neighbors.

MODEL · INFER ACROSS PARAGRAPHS

What can you infer about why Dickens included Ignorance and Want in his story?

1 Paragraph 1: many real children had no school and no home.

2 Paragraph 3: Dickens had just seen a ragged school and believed uneducated children had no future.

3 Paragraph 4: he used his story to answer people who refused to help.

Model answer: Dickens included the two children to make readers face a real problem he had seen himself.

KEY IDEA

Connect details from several paragraphs to draw well-supported inferences.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why were ragged schools given that name?
2. Who was Angela Burdett-Coutts?
3. What happened in 1870?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Connect several paragraphs for strong inferences.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.4 · W.7.9a, W.7.2

Lesson 2.4: Writing a Multi-Paragraph Evidence Response

I can write a multi-paragraph response that integrates evidence from a long text.

WORDS TO KNOW

integrate — Weave quotations smoothly into your own sentences.

GET READY

How can you include a quotation so it sounds like part of your own sentence?

Integrate quotations instead of dropping them in. Use a lead-in, a short quote, and analysis.

Dropped quote (weak)	Integrated quote (strong)
The Spirit is angry. “Are there no prisons?” This is Scrooge's line.	When the Spirit asks, “Are there no prisons?”, he throws Scrooge's own cruel words back at him, forcing Scrooge to hear how they sound.

MODEL · RESPONSE STRUCTURE

Prompt: How does the Ghost of Christmas Present change the way Scrooge sees the poor?

1. Paragraph 1: claim: the Ghost shows Scrooge that the poor are real people, not a “surplus population.”
2. Paragraph 2: the Cratchits and Tiny Tim (evidence + analysis).
3. Paragraph 3: Ignorance and Want (evidence + analysis).
4. Short conclusion.

Model answer: A three- or four-paragraph response with integrated evidence.

KEY IDEA

Lead-in + short quote + analysis. Organize paragraphs by idea.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a lead-in?
2. Why keep quotes short?

3. What follows a quote?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Integrate quotations with lead-ins and analysis.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.5 · RL.7.5

Lesson 2.5: How a Scene Contributes to the Whole

I can analyze how a scene contributes to a story's structure, theme, and characters.

WORDS TO KNOW

suspense	A feeling of tense uncertainty about what will happen.
structure	How a text is organized into parts.

GET READY

Why would Dickens show strangers selling a dead man's belongings?

READ IN YOUR READER

A Christmas Carol Reader · Stave Four

As you read: Who is the dead man? How do people react to his death? What does Scrooge beg the Spirit at the end?

Each scene has a job: advancing plot, developing character, building theme, or creating mood and suspense. Ask: What would be lost if this scene were removed?

MODEL · ANALYZE THE SCENE AT OLD JOE'S SHOP

What does it contribute?

1 Plot: shows how the dead man is treated once he is gone.

2 Theme: no one mourns him; his greed left him with no one who cared.

3 Suspense: readers suspect who the man is long before Scrooge admits it.

Model answer: The shop scene shows the lonely end of a greedy life and builds suspense about the dead man's name.

KEY IDEA

Ask what a scene contributes to plot, character, theme, and mood, and what would be lost without it.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is suspense?
2. What do the visitors bring to old Joe?
3. Which theme does the scene reflect?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Scenes advance plot, develop character, build theme, and create suspense.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.6 · RL.7.4, RL.7.2

Lesson 2.6: Analyzing a Famous Speech

I can analyze how figurative language and structure create meaning in a famous speech.

GET READY

Can the future be changed, or is it already written?

NOVELLA EXCERPT

Scrooge, Stave Four (original text, excerpt)

Charles Dickens, A Christmas Carol. Public domain.

“Men’s courses will foreshadow certain ends, to which, if persevered in, they must lead,” said Scrooge. “But if the courses be departed from, the ends will change. Say it is thus with what you show me!”

“Spirit!” he cried, tight clutching at its robe, “hear me! I am not the man I was. I will not be the man I must have been but for this intercourse. Why show me this, if I am past all hope!”

MODEL · ANALYZE

"Men's courses will foreshadow certain ends, to which, if persevered in, they must lead. But if the courses be departed from, the ends will change."

1 Metaphor: a person's life is a course, or path, that leads to an end, or destination.

2 Structure: two balanced sentences, the second turning on "But."

3 Connection: Scrooge argues that the future the Spirit shows can still change if he changes his path.

Model answer: Scrooge turns the image of a path into an argument for hope: change the road, and you change where it ends.

KEY IDEA

Identify the figurative language, explain it, then connect it to the story's larger meaning.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does "courses" mean here?
2. What does "I am not the man I was" show?
3. What is the speech's larger message?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Figurative language in a speech can express the story's biggest ideas.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.7 · RL.7.7

Lesson 2.7: Comparing Text and Performance

I can compare a written story to a staged or filmed version and analyze the effects of the director's choices.

WORDS TO KNOW

director	The person who decides how a story is staged or filmed.
adaptation	A version of a story changed for a new medium, such as a play or film.

GET READY

If you staged the arrival of the last, silent Spirit, how would you make the audience feel Scrooge's fear?

A Christmas Carol has been adapted for the stage and screen hundreds of times; Dickens even performed it himself. Directors make choices about sets, lighting, sound, costumes, and acting. Each choice changes how the audience experiences the text.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Two Ways to Stage the Last Spirit

Original descriptions

Production A. The stage goes dark except for one cold spotlight. An actor on hidden stilts, wrapped in a tall black robe and hood, glides slowly toward Scrooge without a sound. The Spirit never speaks; it only points. The audience hears nothing but Scrooge's breathing.

Production B. A film version fills the screen with swirling black shadow. Deep, booming music swells, the Spirit's huge shape looms over the rooftops of London, and computer effects send Scrooge flying through the streets. The scenes move quickly, and some of Scrooge's lines are cut.

MODEL · ANALYZE CHOICES

Compare Productions A and B.

1 A: silent and simple; relies on the actor and the audience's imagination.

2 B: spectacular; overwhelming effects; some lines lost.

3 Effect: A makes the Spirit eerie and close; B makes it huge and terrifying.

Model answer: Each production highlights different parts of the scene.

KEY IDEA

Compare what the text says with what the production shows; analyze the effect of each choice.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which production is closer to Dickens's description of a silent Spirit?
2. What is lost in Production B?
3. What is gained in Production B?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Productions make choices that change the audience's experience.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.8 · W.7.9a, W.7.2

Lesson 2.8: Writing a Scene Analysis

I can write an analysis of how a scene contributes to a story.

GET READY

What is the single most important thing Stave Four does?

A scene analysis states the scene's purpose (claim), supports it with integrated evidence, and explains its effect on the story as a whole.

MODEL · TOPIC SENTENCE

Stave Four

1 Name the scene.

2 State its contribution.

Model answer: In Stave Four, Dickens shows the lonely, unmourned death of a greedy man so that Scrooge, and the reader, can see where his path is leading while there is still time to change it.

KEY IDEA

Claim about the scene's purpose → integrated evidence → effect on the whole story.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What must the topic sentence name?
2. What kind of evidence?
3. What does the analysis connect to?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Analyze a scene's purpose with evidence.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.9 · L.7.1

Lesson 2.9: Kinds of Nouns

I can identify concrete, abstract, collective, compound, and proper nouns.

WORDS TO KNOW

concrete noun	Names something you can perceive with the senses: chain, turkey.
abstract noun	Names an idea, quality, or feeling: greed, generosity.
collective noun	Names a group: family, crowd.
compound noun	Made of two or more words: counting-house, door-knocker, schoolboy.

GET READY

Which is easier to draw: “a chain” or “greed”? Why?

READ IN YOUR READER

A Christmas Carol Reader · Stave Five

As you read: How has Scrooge changed? What does he do first, and how do other people react?

Kind	Examples from A Christmas Carol
concrete	chain, crutch, turkey, gravestone, fire
abstract	greed, charity, fear, joy, hope
collective	family, crowd, party, flock
compound	counting-house, door-knocker, schoolboy
proper	Scrooge, London, Camden Town, Tiny Tim

Writers use abstract nouns to name big ideas (themes) and concrete nouns to make those ideas visible. Marley's chain (concrete) stands for the greed and selfishness (abstract) he forged “link by link” in life.

KEY IDEA

Concrete nouns can be sensed; abstract nouns name ideas. Writers use concrete nouns to symbolize abstract ones.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Concrete or abstract: generosity
2. Collective noun for a group of carol singers
3. What abstract idea does Marley's chain represent?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Concrete, abstract, collective, compound, and proper nouns.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.10 · L.7.1

Lesson 2.10: Noun Functions in Sentences

I can identify how nouns function in sentences: subject, direct object, indirect object, object of a preposition, and predicate noun.

WORDS TO KNOW

direct object	Receives the action of the verb.
indirect object	Tells to whom or for whom the action is done.
predicate noun	Follows a linking verb and renames the subject.

GET READY

In “Scrooge sent Bob a turkey,” who receives what?

Function	Example (function in bold)
subject	Scrooge bought a turkey.
direct object	Scrooge bought a turkey.
indirect object	Scrooge sent Bob a turkey.
object of preposition	The boy ran to the poulterer's.
predicate noun	Scrooge became a good friend.

MODEL · IDENTIFY FUNCTIONS

“Scrooge sent Bob a turkey.”

1 Subject: Scrooge (who sent?).

2 Direct object: turkey (sent what?).

3 Indirect object: Bob (sent to whom?).

Model answer: Scrooge = subject; turkey = direct object; Bob = indirect object

KEY IDEA

Ask who/what does it (subject), receives it (direct object), to/for whom (indirect object), after a preposition (object of preposition), or renames the subject after a linking verb (predicate noun).

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Function of “Scrooge” in “Fred invited Scrooge.”
2. Function of “clerk” in “Bob is the clerk.”
3. Function of “street” in “Scrooge walked along the street.”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Nouns function as subjects, objects, and predicate nouns.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.11 · L.7.1, L.7.2

Lesson 2.11: Appositives

I can use appositives to add information, punctuating them correctly.

WORDS TO KNOW

appositive	A noun or noun phrase that renames another noun right beside it.

GET READY

How can you tell readers who Fred is without writing a whole new sentence?

An appositive renames a noun: Fred, Scrooge's nephew, invites him to dinner. Use commas when the appositive adds extra (nonessential) information. No commas when it is essential to identify which one: Dickens's novella A Christmas Carol was published in 1843.

MODEL · COMBINE WITH AN APPOSITIVE

Bob Cratchit works in the counting-house. Bob Cratchit is Scrooge's clerk.

1 Find the renaming phrase: Scrooge's clerk.

2 Place it beside Bob Cratchit with commas.

Model answer: Bob Cratchit, Scrooge's clerk, works in the counting-house.

KEY IDEA

Appositives rename nouns. Use commas for extra information.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Find the appositive: Fezziwig, a kind old merchant, threw a Christmas party.
2. Combine: Fan is Scrooge's sister. Fan brings him home from school.

3. Do appositives that add extra information need commas?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Appositives rename nouns; commas set off extra information.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.12 · L.7.4b, L.7.1

Lesson 2.12: Forming Nouns from Other Words

I can form nouns with suffixes and use them to write about ideas.

WORDS TO KNOW

nominalization	Turning a verb or adjective into a noun, such as generous → generosity.

GET READY

How can you turn the adjective “generous” into a word that names the idea?

Suffix	Base word	Noun
-ness	kind, happy	kindness, happiness
-tion / -sion	transform, decide	transformation, decision
-ment	punish, astonish	punishment, astonishment
-ity	generous, charitable	generosity, charity
-ance / -ence	repent / obey	repentance, obedience
-dom	free, wise	freedom, wisdom

Analytical writing often uses abstract nouns: Scrooge's transformation replaces greed with generosity.

KEY IDEA

Suffixes turn verbs and adjectives into nouns that name ideas, which are essential for writing about themes.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Noun form of free
2. Noun form of punish
3. Noun form of generous

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Suffixes form abstract nouns for writing about ideas.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.13 · L.7.3a, W.7.3d

Lesson 2.13: Precise Nouns for Vivid Writing

I can replace vague nouns with precise ones.

WORDS TO KNOW

vague	Not clear or specific.

GET READY

Which paints a clearer picture: “The person carried a thing” or “The clerk carried a crutch”?

Vague nouns (thing, stuff, person, place) leave readers guessing. Precise nouns create images and save words.

Vague	Precise
a person	a clerk, a miser, a poulterer
a thing	a ledger, a crutch, a door-knocker
a place	a counting-house, a garret, a churchyard
a feeling	dread, remorse, relief

KEY IDEA

Replace vague nouns with precise nouns that create a clear image or name an exact idea.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Precise noun for “a building where grain is kept”
2. Revise: A person in the office wrote stuff.

3. Precise abstract noun for “feeling bad about what you did”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Precise nouns create clear images and ideas.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.14 · L.7.2, L.7.1

Lesson 2.14: Possessive Nouns and Clear Reference

I can form possessives correctly, including plural, irregular, and joint possession.

WORDS TO KNOW

joint possession — Two or more people owning the same thing: Bob and Mrs. Cratchit's home.

GET READY

Is it “Bob's and Mrs. Cratchit's home” or “Bob and Mrs. Cratchit's home”?

Rule	Example
singular: 's	the clerk's desk; Marley's chain
singular ending in s: 's (usually)	Dickens's novel; James's book
plural ending in s: '	the Cratchits' dinner
irregular plural: 's	the children's games; the men's hats
joint possession: 's on the last name only	Bob and Mrs. Cratchit's home
separate possession: 's on each name	Scrooge's and Fred's houses

KEY IDEA

Choose the possessive form by number (singular/plural), regularity, and whether ownership is joint or separate.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. The home shared by Bob and Mrs. Cratchit
2. The separate houses of Scrooge and Fred

3. The dinner belonging to the Cratchits

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Possessives depend on number, regularity, and joint or separate ownership.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.15 · W.7.2, W.7.9a

Lesson 2.15: Writing a Literary Analysis Essay

I can write a literary analysis essay about a theme in a novel or novella.

WORDS TO KNOW

thesis	The central claim of an essay.

GET READY

Can a person really change? What does A Christmas Carol suggest?

NOVELLA EXCERPT

Scrooge's Promise, Stave Four (original text, excerpt)

Charles Dickens, A Christmas Carol. Public domain.

"I will honour Christmas in my heart, and try to keep it all the year. I will live in the Past, the Present, and the Future. The Spirits of all Three shall strive within me. I will not shut out the lessons that they teach."

A literary analysis essay has an introduction (hook, context, thesis), body paragraphs (topic sentence, integrated evidence, analysis), and a conclusion (restated thesis and significance).

MODEL · THESIS

Prompt: What does A Christmas Carol suggest about whether people can change?

1 Take a position.

2 Preview reasons.

Model answer: Although Scrooge begins the story as "solitary as an oyster," A Christmas Carol suggests that anyone can change when he or she truly sees how choices affect other people.

KEY IDEA

Thesis → body paragraphs with integrated evidence and analysis → conclusion with significance.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What three parts are in an introduction?
2. What does a conclusion add besides restating?
3. Name a key quote for change.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Literary analysis: thesis, evidence, analysis, significance.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.16 · W.7.5, L.7.3a

Lesson 2.16: Revising the Essay for Precision

I can revise my essay for precise nouns, integrated evidence, and correct conventions.

GET READY

What one change would make your essay most convincing?

Revision checklist	✓
Thesis takes a clear position.	
Each quotation is integrated with a lead-in and analysis.	
Vague nouns are replaced with precise ones.	
Appositives add useful information with correct commas.	
Possessives are correct.	
Conclusion explains significance.	

KEY IDEA

Revise for argument and evidence first, then precision and conventions.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What should you revise first?
2. Name a convention to check.
3. Why replace vague nouns?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise argument and evidence, then precision and conventions.

UNIT 2 REVIEW

Unit 2 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember...
2.1	Track plotlines separately; analyze how they mirror the main story.
2.2	Close reading: what, how, why.
2.3	Connect several paragraphs for strong inferences.
2.4	Integrate quotations with lead-ins and analysis.
2.5	Scenes advance plot, develop character, build theme, and create suspense.
2.6	Figurative language in a speech can express the story's biggest ideas.
2.7	Productions make choices that change the audience's experience.
2.8	Analyze a scene's purpose with evidence.
2.9	Concrete, abstract, collective, compound, and proper nouns.
2.10	Nouns function as subjects, objects, and predicate nouns.
2.11	Appositives rename nouns; commas set off extra information.
2.12	Suffixes form abstract nouns for writing about ideas.
2.13	Precise nouns create clear images and ideas.
2.14	Possessives depend on number, regularity, and joint or separate ownership.
2.15	Literary analysis: thesis, evidence, analysis, significance.
2.16	Revise argument and evidence, then precision and conventions.

UNIT 3

Mystery and Grammar

Mystery structure and characterization, pronouns, verb tense, voice, and mood, with Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde, Chapters 1–4.

Fog-filled London streets, a sinister stranger, and a respectable doctor with a secret: Stevenson's Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde is one of the most famous mysteries ever written. As you investigate alongside Mr. Utterson, you'll also investigate how grammar works: how pronouns keep meaning clear and how verbs control time, focus, and attitude.

In this unit you will...

- Analyze mystery structure, frame narratives, characterization, clues, and foreshadowing.
- Use pronoun case, clear reference, and agreement correctly.
- Use and analyze verb tenses, active and passive voice, and moods.
- Avoid shifts; write and edit an objective news report.

WHY IT MATTERS

Clear pronouns and consistent verbs matter in every report, email, and essay, and noticing passive voice helps you see when someone is avoiding responsibility.

UNIT VOCABULARY

frame narrative	A story within a story.
antecedent	The noun a pronoun refers to.
passive voice	The subject receives the action.
subjunctive	The mood for wishes and contrary-to-fact ideas.
foreshadowing	Hints about later events.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
3.1	The Mystery Genre and Frame Narratives

Lesson	Title
3.2	Pronoun Case
3.3	Clear Pronoun Reference
3.4	Characterization Through Description
3.5	Building Suspense Through Pursuit
3.6	Pronoun-Antecedent Agreement and Indefinite Pronouns
3.7	Reflexive, Intensive, and Relative Pronouns: Who and Whom
3.8	Writing a Character Analysis with Clear Pronouns
3.9	Verb Tenses: Simple, Perfect, and Progressive
3.10	Active and Passive Voice
3.11	Verb Moods
3.12	Analyzing Voice and Mood for Effect
3.13	Clues, Red Herrings, and Foreshadowing
3.14	Avoiding Shifts in Tense, Voice, and Mood
3.15	Writing a News Report
3.16	Editing for Pronouns and Verbs

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.1 · RL.7.5, RL.7.3

Lesson 3.1: The Mystery Genre and Frame Narratives

I can analyze how a mystery is structured, including stories told within stories.

WORDS TO KNOW

mystery	A genre built around a puzzle or crime that characters try to solve.
frame narrative	A story that contains another story told by a character.
Gothic	A style of fiction with dark settings, mystery, and a mood of horror or dread.

GET READY

What makes a mystery story hard to put down?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapter 1: Story of the Door

As you read: What story does Mr. Enfield tell? Why does it disturb Mr. Utterson?

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde (1886) is a Gothic mystery. Stevenson withholds the truth until the very end. Much of the story reaches us secondhand: in Chapter 1, Mr. Enfield tells Mr. Utterson a story within the story, a frame narrative.

Mystery element	In Chapter 1
a puzzle	Why would respectable Dr. Jekyll's name be on a cheque given by the brutal Mr. Hyde?
clues	the door, the cheque, Hyde's strange appearance
an investigator	Mr. Utterson, the lawyer
withheld information	Enfield refuses to name the signer at first

CLASSIC NOVEL EXCERPT

From Chapter 1, "Story of the Door" (original 1886 text)

Robert Louis Stevenson, Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde (1886). Public domain.

Mr. Utterson the lawyer was a man of a rugged countenance that was never lighted by a smile; cold, scanty and embarrassed in discourse; backward in sentiment; lean, long, dusty, dreary and yet somehow lovable.

MODEL · ANALYZE CHARACTERIZATION

What kind of investigator is Utterson?

1 “never lighted by a smile”; “cold, scanty and embarrassed in discourse”: reserved, serious.

2 “and yet somehow lovable”: loyal, trustworthy.

Model answer: Utterson is a reserved, serious man whom readers can trust to pursue the truth.

KEY IDEA

Mysteries withhold information and plant clues; frame narratives filter events through a character's telling.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Who tells the story of the door?
2. What crime does Hyde commit in Enfield's story?
3. What is the central puzzle?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Mysteries withhold truth and plant clues; frames filter what we know.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.2 · L.7.1

Lesson 3.2: Pronoun Case

I can use subjective, objective, and possessive pronouns correctly.

WORDS TO KNOW

pronoun case	The form a pronoun takes depending on its job: subjective, objective, or possessive.

GET READY

Which is correct: “Enfield and him walked” or “Enfield and he walked”?

Case	Pronouns	Used as
subjective	I, you, he, she, it, we, they, who	subjects; predicate pronouns
objective	me, you, him, her, it, us, them, whom	objects of verbs and prepositions
possessive	my/mine, your/yours, his, her/hers, its, our/ours, their/theirs, whose	ownership

MODEL · COMPOUND SUBJECTS AND OBJECTS

Enfield and (he/him) walked down the street.

1 Remove “Enfield and”: him walked? He walked.

2 Subject → subjective case.

Model answer: Enfield and he walked down the street.

MODEL · AFTER A PREPOSITION

The secret stayed between Jekyll and (I/me).

1 “between” is a preposition → objective case.

Model answer: between Jekyll and me

KEY IDEA

Drop the other noun to test compound pronouns. Prepositions take objective pronouns.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Utterson and (I/me) read the will.
2. The lawyer warned Lanyon and (she/her).
3. This secret is (theirs/their's).

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Subjective for subjects, objective for objects, possessive for ownership.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.3 · L.7.1, L.6.1d

Lesson 3.3: Clear Pronoun Reference

I can identify and fix vague or ambiguous pronouns.

WORDS TO KNOW

antecedent	The noun a pronoun refers to.
ambiguous	Having more than one possible meaning.

GET READY

In “Utterson told Enfield that he was worried,” who was worried?

A pronoun must clearly point to one antecedent. Ambiguous pronouns could refer to two people. Vague pronouns (it, this, they) refer to no specific noun.

Problem	Example	Fix
ambiguous	Utterson told Enfield that he was worried.	Utterson told Enfield, “I am worried.” / Utterson was worried, and he told Enfield.
vague “they”	In the newspaper, they said Hyde fled.	The newspaper reported that Hyde fled.
vague “this”	Hyde trampled the child and paid money. This upset Enfield.	Hyde's cruelty upset Enfield.

KEY IDEA

Every pronoun needs one clear antecedent. If it could mean two people or no one, rewrite.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fix: When Jekyll met Utterson, he smiled.
2. Fix: They say Hyde is dangerous.
3. What is an antecedent?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Each pronoun needs one clear antecedent.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.4 · RL.7.3, RL.7.4

Lesson 3.4: Characterization Through Description

I can analyze how an author's description and characters' reactions develop a character.

WORDS TO KNOW

direct characterization	The author tells us what a character is like.
indirect characterization	The author shows character through actions, speech, appearance, and others' reactions.

GET READY

Why might a reader find Hyde more frightening if no one can describe him clearly?

CLASSIC NOVEL EXCERPT

Enfield Describes Hyde, Chapter 1 (original text, excerpt)

Robert Louis Stevenson, Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde. Public domain.

"There is something wrong with his appearance; something displeasing, something down-right detestable. I never saw a man I so disliked, and yet I scarce know why."

MODEL · ANALYZE

What does Enfield's description reveal?

1 He can't say what is wrong: "I scarce know why."
2 Repeated "something" words build unease.
3 Effect: Hyde is frightening because he cannot be explained.

Model answer: Stevenson makes Hyde terrifying through vagueness and others' reactions rather than a clear description.

KEY IDEA

Analyze both what the author says directly and what is shown through reactions and details.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does “detestable” mean?
2. Why does Enfield repeat “something”?
3. Is this direct or indirect characterization?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Characters develop through description and others' reactions.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.5 · RL.7.3, RL.7.1

Lesson 3.5: Building Suspense Through Pursuit

I can analyze how an author builds suspense and develops a character's motivation.

WORDS TO KNOW

motivation	The reason a character acts.

GET READY

Why would a respectable lawyer stand in a dark doorway for nights on end?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapter 2: Search for Mr. Hyde

As you read: What does Utterson learn from Jekyll's will? What happens when he finally meets Hyde?

CLASSIC NOVEL EXCERPT

Utterson's Vow, Chapter 2 (original text, excerpt)

Robert Louis Stevenson, Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde. Public domain.

“If he be Mr. Hyde,” he had thought, “I shall be Mr. Seek.”

MODEL · ANALYZE MOTIVATION

Why does Utterson pursue Hyde?

1 Clue: Jekyll's will leaves everything to Hyde.

2 Fear: Utterson suspects Hyde has some hold over Jekyll.

3 Wordplay: Hyde/hide → Seek, showing his determination.

Model answer: Utterson's loyalty to Jekyll and fear for his safety motivate the pursuit.

KEY IDEA

Suspense grows as a character's motivation pushes him toward danger.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does Jekyll's will say?
2. Explain the pun “Mr. Seek.”
3. What is Utterson's motivation?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Motivation drives suspenseful pursuit.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.6 · L.7.1

Lesson 3.6: Pronoun-Antecedent Agreement and Indefinite Pronouns

I can make pronouns agree with their antecedents, including indefinite pronouns.

WORDS TO KNOW

indefinite pronoun	A pronoun that doesn't refer to a specific person or thing: everyone, each, someone, several.

GET READY

Which is correct: “Everyone took their seat” or “Everyone took his or her seat”?

Indefinite pronoun	Number	Example
each, everyone, everybody, someone, anyone, nobody, either, neither	singular	Each of the servants knows his or her duties.
both, few, many, several	plural	Several of the witnesses gave their accounts.
all, some, most, none, any	depends on the noun after “of”	Some of the money was missing. Some of the doors were locked.

In formal writing, singular indefinite pronouns take singular verbs. Many style guides now also accept singular they for a person whose gender is unknown; choose one approach and use it consistently. Rewriting with a plural noun often avoids the problem: All of the guests took their seats.

KEY IDEA

Match number: singular antecedents with singular pronouns and verbs; plural with plural.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Each of the lawyers (has/have) a key.
2. Several of the clerks lost (his/their) notes.
3. Most of the cake (was/were) eaten.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Match pronouns and verbs to their antecedents' number.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.7 · L.7.1

Lesson 3.7: Reflexive, Intensive, and Relative Pronouns: Who and Whom

I can use reflexive and intensive pronouns and choose between who and whom.

WORDS TO KNOW

reflexive pronoun	Ends in -self/-selves and refers back to the subject: He hurt himself.
intensive pronoun	Ends in -self/-selves and emphasizes a noun: Utterson himself went.

GET READY

Is it “Who did Utterson suspect?” or “Whom did Utterson suspect?”

Use	Example
reflexive (needed for meaning)	Jekyll locked himself in the laboratory.
intensive (adds emphasis; can be removed)	Utterson himself read the will.
error: -self as a subject	Myself and Utterson went. → Utterson and I went.
who = subject (he/she)	Who wrote the letter? (He wrote it.)
whom = object (him/her)	Whom did Utterson suspect? (He suspected him.)

KEY IDEA

Use -self pronouns only to reflect or intensify. Who = he; whom = him.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Reflexive or intensive: The maid herself saw the attack.
2. (Who/Whom) did the maid see?
3. Fix: Lanyon and myself disagreed.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Reflexive and intensive -self pronouns; who for subjects, whom for objects.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.8 · W.7.2, L.7.1

Lesson 3.8: Writing a Character Analysis with Clear Pronouns

I can write a character analysis that uses pronouns clearly and correctly.

GET READY

When writing about two male characters, how do you keep “he” clear?

When you analyze two characters of the same gender, repeat names or use descriptive phrases (the lawyer, the doctor) to keep pronouns clear.

MODEL · CLEAR REFERENCES

Weak: When Utterson met Hyde, he was rude to him, and he felt disgusted.

1 Who was rude? Who felt disgusted?

Model answer: When Utterson met Hyde, Hyde was rude to the lawyer, and Utterson felt disgusted.

KEY IDEA

Use names and descriptive phrases to keep pronouns clear when two characters share a gender.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Descriptive phrase for Utterson
2. Descriptive phrase for Lanyon
3. Why repeat names sometimes?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Clear pronouns keep analysis readable.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.9 · L.7.1

Lesson 3.9: Verb Tenses: Simple, Perfect, and Progressive

I can form and use simple, perfect, and progressive tenses to show time relationships.

WORDS TO KNOW

perfect tense	Uses has/have/had/will have + past participle to show completed action relative to another time.

GET READY

What's the difference between "Utterson read the will" and "Utterson had read the will before he met Hyde"?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapter 3: Dr. Jekyll Was Quite at Ease

As you read: How does Jekyll react when Utterson mentions Hyde?

Tense	Form	Example
simple past	verb + -ed / irregular	Utterson visited Jekyll.
past perfect	had + past participle	Utterson had read the will before the dinner.
present perfect	has/have + past participle	Jekyll has asked Utterson for a favor.
future perfect	will have + past participle	By midnight, the guests will have left.
past progressive	was/were + -ing	Jekyll was smiling, but his face changed.

MODEL · CHOOSE THE TENSE

By the time Utterson arrived, the other guests (left / had left).

1 Two past actions; the leaving happened first.

2 Earlier past action → past perfect.

Model answer: had left

KEY IDEA

Perfect tenses show which action happened first. Progressive tenses show ongoing action.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Past perfect of write (Jekyll)
2. Present perfect of see (I)
3. By next week, Utterson ___ (finish) the case.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Perfect tenses show order; progressive shows ongoing action.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.10 · L.7.1, L.7.3

Lesson 3.10: Active and Passive Voice

I can identify active and passive voice and explain the effect of each.

WORDS TO KNOW

active voice	The subject does the action: Hyde struck the man.
passive voice	The subject receives the action: The man was struck by Hyde.

GET READY

Which sounds more dramatic: “Hyde struck the man” or “The man was struck”?

NEWS WRITING

The Museum Robbery: Two Reports

Original examples

Report A. Last night, a thief broke a window at the city museum, climbed inside, and stole a gold necklace from the Egyptian exhibit. A guard spotted the thief and called the police.

Report B. Last night, a window at the city museum was broken, and a gold necklace was stolen from the Egyptian exhibit. The police were called after a suspicious figure was spotted.

MODEL · COMPARE

Report A vs Report B

1 A (active): a thief broke, climbed, stole; the actor is clear and vivid.

2 B (passive): was broken, was stolen; the actor is hidden.

3 Effect: B is vaguer; useful when the actor is unknown, but less vivid.

Model answer: Active voice is clearer and more direct; passive voice hides or downplays who acted.

- Form passive voice with a form of be + past participle: was stolen, were called.
- Use passive when the actor is unknown or unimportant, or to emphasize the receiver.
- Prefer active voice for clear, lively writing.

KEY IDEA

Active: subject acts. Passive: subject receives. Choose voice on purpose.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Active or passive: The will was signed by Jekyll.

2. Rewrite in active: The will was signed by Jekyll.

3. Why might a criminal prefer passive voice?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Active is direct; passive emphasizes the receiver or hides the actor.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.11 · L.7.1

Lesson 3.11: Verb Moods

I can identify and use indicative, imperative, interrogative, conditional, and subjunctive moods.

WORDS TO KNOW

mood	The form of a verb that shows the speaker's attitude: stating, commanding, asking, wishing, or imagining.

GET READY

How is “Find Mr. Hyde!” different from “If I were Utterson, I would find Mr. Hyde”?

Mood	Purpose	Example
indicative	states facts or opinions	Utterson visits Jekyll.
imperative	commands or requests	Promise me you will help him.
interrogative	asks questions	Did you see the man's face?
conditional	states what would happen under a condition	If Hyde returned, Utterson would follow him.
subjunctive	expresses wishes or contrary-to-fact ideas	I wish Jekyll were honest. If I were you, I would leave.

Notice the subjunctive were for all subjects in wishes and contrary-to-fact statements: If he were here… (not was). Stevenson's “If he be Mr. Hyde” is an older subjunctive form.

KEY IDEA

Mood shows attitude: state, command, ask, imagine, or wish. Use “were” in contrary-to-fact statements.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Mood: “Tell me the truth.”
2. Mood: “If I were Jekyll, I would confess.”
3. Fix: I wish Hyde was gone.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Moods: indicative, imperative, interrogative, conditional, subjunctive.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.12 · L.7.3, RL.7.4

Lesson 3.12: Analyzing Voice and Mood for Effect

I can explain how an author's choice of voice and mood creates effects such as suspense.

GET READY

How can a sentence's grammar make a scene feel mysterious?

MYSTERY

Fog over the City

An original story

1 By ten o'clock the fog had swallowed the city whole. Gas lamps glowed like dim orange moons, and the cobblestones gleamed with damp. Somewhere a church bell struck the hour, its sound muffled as if wrapped in wool.

2 Inspector Hale turned up his collar and listened. A door creaked. Footsteps hurried away. When he reached the alley, it was empty, except for a single silver button lying in a puddle, catching the lamplight.

3 Hale picked it up. It was engraved with two letters, so worn he could barely read them. Someone had left in a hurry. Someone, he suspected, who had very good reasons not to be seen.

MODEL · ANALYZE EFFECTS

“Someone had left in a hurry.”

1 Indefinite pronoun “someone”: the actor is unknown.

2 Past perfect: the event happened before Hale arrived.

3 Effect: suspense: we only see the aftermath.

Model answer: The grammar hides the culprit and places the action just out of reach.

KEY IDEA

Grammar choices (voice, mood, tense, pronouns) create effects like suspense, distance, or urgency.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Find a simile in paragraph 1.
2. What does the button suggest?
3. Which pronoun creates mystery?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Grammar choices create effects like suspense.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.13 · RL.7.3, RL.7.1

Lesson 3.13: Clues, Red Herrings, and Foreshadowing

I can analyze how an author plants clues and foreshadows events.

WORDS TO KNOW

foreshadowing	Hints about what will happen later.
red herring	A misleading clue.

GET READY

What clue in Chapter 4 points directly to Hyde?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapter 4: The Carew Murder Case

As you read: Who witnesses the crime? What evidence is found? What does Utterson recognize?

Mystery writers plant clues (and sometimes red herrings) and foreshadow later events. Careful readers track them and ask what they point to.

Clue in Chapter 4	What it suggests
a maid witnesses the attack and recognizes Hyde	Hyde is the murderer
half of a broken cane	a physical link to the killer
Utterson recognizes the cane	a link to Jekyll (Utterson had given it to him)
Hyde's rooms are ransacked; he has fled	Hyde had warning or planned escape

KEY IDEA

Track clues and foreshadowing; ask what each points to and whether it might mislead.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Who was murdered?
2. Why is the cane important?
3. What is a red herring?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Clues and foreshadowing point toward the solution.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.14 · L.7.1, L.8.1d

Lesson 3.14: Avoiding Shifts in Tense, Voice, and Mood

I can recognize and correct inappropriate shifts in verb tense, voice, and mood.

WORDS TO KNOW

shift	An unnecessary change in tense, voice, or mood within a sentence or paragraph.

GET READY

What's wrong with: “Utterson walks to the house and knocked on the door”?

Shift	Error	Fix
tense	Utterson walks to the house and knocked.	Utterson walked to the house and knocked.
voice	The maid saw the attack, and the police were called by her.	The maid saw the attack and called the police.
mood	Find the cane, and then you should call the inspector.	Find the cane, and then call the inspector.

When writing about literature, use the literary present consistently: Utterson visits Jekyll and asks about Hyde.

KEY IDEA

Keep tense, voice, and mood consistent unless meaning requires a change. Write about literature in the present tense.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fix: Hyde ran away and hides.
2. Fix: Jekyll wrote the letter, and it was signed by him.
3. Which tense is used to write about literature?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Keep tense, voice, and mood consistent; use literary present.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.15 · W.7.2, W.7.4

Lesson 3.15: Writing a News Report

I can write an objective news report with consistent verbs.

WORDS TO KNOW

lead	The first sentence of a news story; answers who, what, when, where, why, and how.
inverted pyramid	News structure that puts the most important information first.

GET READY

If you were a London reporter in 1886, how would you report the Carew murder?

News reports use the inverted pyramid: the most important facts first, details after. They are objective, use past tense consistently, and quote witnesses.

MODEL · WRITE A LEAD

The Carew murder

1 Who: Sir Danvers Carew.

2 What: was killed.

3 Where/when: a London street, late at night.

4 How: beaten with a cane; a maid witnessed it.

Model answer: Sir Danvers Carew, a respected member of Parliament, was beaten to death on a London street late last night, according to a maid who witnessed the attack from her window.

KEY IDEA

Lead with the 5 Ws and H, then add details in order of importance. Stay objective and consistent.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What goes in a lead?
2. Is a news report objective or subjective?
3. Why might a reporter use passive voice in the lead?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

News: lead with 5 Ws, inverted pyramid, objective, consistent.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.16 · L.7.1, W.7.5

Lesson 3.16: Editing for Pronouns and Verbs

I can edit writing for pronoun and verb errors.

GET READY

Which grammar error from this unit do you make most often?

Editing checklist	✓
Pronoun case correct (I/me, he/him, who/whom).	
Every pronoun has one clear antecedent.	
Pronouns agree with antecedents (each … his or her).	
No -self pronouns as subjects or objects.	
Tense is consistent; perfect tenses show order.	
No unnecessary shifts in voice or mood.	

KEY IDEA

Edit pronouns and verbs with a checklist, one item at a time.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fix: Him and me read the novel.
2. Fix: Everyone brought their own book. (formal)
3. Fix: If I was Jekyll, I would confess.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Edit pronouns and verbs with a checklist.

UNIT 3 REVIEW

Unit 3 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember...
3.1	Mysteries withhold truth and plant clues; frames filter what we know.
3.2	Subjective for subjects, objective for objects, possessive for ownership.
3.3	Each pronoun needs one clear antecedent.
3.4	Characters develop through description and others' reactions.
3.5	Motivation drives suspenseful pursuit.
3.6	Match pronouns and verbs to their antecedents' number.
3.7	Reflexive and intensive -self pronouns; who for subjects, whom for objects.
3.8	Clear pronouns keep analysis readable.
3.9	Perfect tenses show order; progressive shows ongoing action.
3.10	Active is direct; passive emphasizes the receiver or hides the actor.
3.11	Moods: indicative, imperative, interrogative, conditional, subjunctive.
3.12	Grammar choices create effects like suspense.
3.13	Clues and foreshadowing point toward the solution.
3.14	Keep tense, voice, and mood consistent; use literary present.
3.15	News: lead with 5 Ws, inverted pyramid, objective, consistent.
3.16	Edit pronouns and verbs with a checklist.

UNIT 4

Craft and Perspective

Word choice and tone, structure and delayed revelation, point of view and purpose, symbolism, and comparing fiction with history, with Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde, Chapters 5–10.

The mystery deepens, the truth is revealed, and Stevenson's craft comes into full view. You'll analyze how word choice creates tone, how documents and delays build suspense, how point of view controls what we know, and how symbols carry the novel's theme of duality. Then you'll compare Jekyll's fictional experiment with real scientists who experimented on themselves.

In this unit you will…

- Analyze diction, tone, and mood; analyze structure and pacing.
- Analyze point of view, dramatic irony, reliability, and arguments with counterclaims.
- Analyze symbols and theme development.
- Compare fiction with historical accounts; write craft and comparative analyses.

WHY IT MATTERS

Analyzing tone, perspective, and argument helps you read news, reviews, and debates critically, and the question of science's limits is debated today.

UNIT VOCABULARY

tone	The author's attitude.
dramatic irony	Readers know more than a character.
symbol	An object that represents an idea.
duality	Having two sides.
counterclaim	An opposing argument.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
4.1	Word Choice and Tone

Lesson	Title
4.2	Structure: Letters, Documents, and Delay
4.3	How Sections Build an Informational Text
4.4	Technical Vocabulary
4.5	Point of View and Dramatic Irony
4.6	Author's Purpose and Point of View in Arguments
4.7	Acknowledging Other Viewpoints
4.8	Retelling from a Different Point of View
4.9	Testimony and Reliability
4.10	Pacing and Sentence Structure at the Climax
4.11	Symbolism
4.12	Writing a Craft Analysis Paragraph
4.13	The Confession and the Theme of Duality
4.14	Comparing Narrators Across the Novel
4.15	Fiction and History: Self-Experimentation
4.16	Writing a Comparative Analysis

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.1 · RL.7.4, L.7.5c

Lesson 4.1: Word Choice and Tone

I can analyze how word choice creates tone and mood.

WORDS TO KNOW

tone	The author's attitude toward the subject or audience.
mood	The feeling a text creates in the reader.
diction	An author's choice of words.

GET READY

What words would you use to describe a house where something terrible has happened?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapters 5–6: Incident of the Letter; Remarkable Incident of Dr. Lanyon

As you read: What does Guest notice about the handwriting? What happens to Dr. Lanyon?

Stevenson's diction is precise and often dark: words like dreary, sinister, ghastly, loathing. Analyze how specific words build a tone of dread and a mood of suspense.

Word or phrase type	Example effect
dark adjectives	build dread: “dismal,” “ghastly”
weather and light	fog and darkness mirror secrecy
restrained narration	Utterson's calm voice makes horror feel more real
physical reactions	pallor, trembling, and fainting show fear without explaining it

MODEL · ANALYZE DICTION

Lanyon's change in Chapter 6

1 Details: Lanyon looks pale, aged, and frightened; he refuses to speak of Jekyll.

2 Effect: his sudden decline signals that he has seen something terrible.

Model answer: Stevenson uses Lanyon's physical collapse to suggest a horror too great to describe.

KEY IDEA

Diction creates tone and mood. Explain how specific words produce the effect.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Tone vs mood
2. What does Guest notice?
3. What mood does Lanyon's decline create?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Word choice creates tone (author's attitude) and mood (reader's feeling).

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.2 · RL.7.5

Lesson 4.2: Structure: Letters, Documents, and Delay

I can analyze how a novel's structure creates suspense.

WORDS TO KNOW

epistolary elements	Letters or documents included within a story.
delayed revelation	Withholding key information until late in a story.

GET READY

Why might an author give the reader sealed letters that can't be opened yet?

Stevenson builds his novel from documents: a will, letters, Lanyon's sealed narrative, and Jekyll's statement. Some documents must wait to be opened, which delays the revelation and makes readers impatient for the truth.

Document	Where	Effect on suspense
Jekyll's will	Ch. 2	raises the question of Hyde's hold on Jekyll
Hyde's letter and Jekyll's note	Ch. 5	the handwriting clue
Lanyon's sealed letter	Ch. 6	a secret promised but withheld
Lanyon's narrative and Jekyll's statement	Ch. 9–10	the final revelation

KEY IDEA

Documents and delayed revelations structure the mystery and build suspense.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does Lanyon's sealed letter instruct?
2. Why delay the revelation?
3. Which chapters reveal the truth?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Documents and delays create suspense.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.3 · RI.7.5, RI.7.3

Lesson 4.3: How Sections Build an Informational Text

I can analyze how sections of an informational text contribute to the whole and develop ideas.

WORDS TO KNOW

respectability	A reputation for proper, socially acceptable behavior.

GET READY

How might the setting of Victorian London have shaped Stevenson's story?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Fog and Gaslight: Victorian London

An original informational text

A City of Contrasts

In the 1880s, London was the largest city in the world, home to more than four million people. Its wealthy neighborhoods had grand squares and elegant houses. Only a short walk away, poor families crowded into narrow lanes and dark courtyards.

The Famous Fog

London's fogs were thick, yellow-brown, and sometimes deadly. Coal fires in homes and factories filled the damp air with smoke. On the worst days, people could not see their own hands, and travelers lost their way on familiar streets.

Light in the Darkness

Gas streetlamps lit the main roads at night. Lamplighters walked the streets each evening, lighting lamps one by one. But the light was dim, and alleys and back streets remained in deep shadow.

Respectability and Secrets

Victorian society placed great value on respectability, a reputation for proper behavior. Gentlemen were expected to control their emotions and hide any private weaknesses. Many historians believe this pressure to appear perfect is one reason stories about hidden second selves fascinated Victorian readers.

MODEL · ANALYZE SECTIONS

How does the final section connect to the rest?

1 Sections 1–3 describe contrasts, fog, and shadow.

2 Section 4 explains respectability and hidden selves.

3 Together: a city of light and darkness mirrors people with public and private sides.

Model answer: The sections build toward the idea that Victorian London's contrasts mirrored the double lives that fascinated readers.

KEY IDEA

Each section contributes; analyze how the sections build the central idea.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why was London's fog so thick?
2. What does respectability mean?
3. How does the setting mirror Jekyll and Hyde?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Sections build the central idea together.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.4 · RI.7.4, L.7.6

Lesson 4.4: Technical Vocabulary

I can determine the meaning of technical words in an informational text.

WORDS TO KNOW

forensic	Related to scientific methods used to investigate crimes.
exemplar	A known sample used for comparison.

GET READY

What clue does handwriting give Utterson in Chapter 5?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Handwriting as Evidence

An original informational text

1 When a document's author is in doubt, investigators may call on a forensic document examiner, an expert who analyzes handwriting, paper, and ink.

2 No two people write exactly alike. Examiners compare exemplars, samples known to be written by a person, with the questioned document. They look at letter shapes, spacing, slant, pen pressure, and the way letters connect.

3 A clever forger may copy the shapes of letters but often writes too slowly and carefully. The result can show shaky lines, blunt starts and stops, and unnatural pauses, which examiners call signs of hesitation.

4 Handwriting analysis cannot prove guilt by itself, but combined with other evidence it can be powerful. In Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde, a clerk's observation about two handwriting samples gives Mr. Utterson a chilling clue.

MODEL · USE CONTEXT

What is a questioned document?

1 Paragraph 2 contrasts it with exemplars (known samples).

2 So a questioned document is one whose author is unknown or disputed.

Model answer: a document whose author is in doubt

KEY IDEA

Technical words are often defined by context or contrast. Use them precisely in your own writing.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a forensic document examiner?
2. What are signs of hesitation?
3. What does Guest notice?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Context defines technical words; use them precisely.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.5 · RL.7.6

Lesson 4.5: Point of View and Dramatic Irony

I can analyze how differences in characters' and readers' knowledge create effects such as suspense.

WORDS TO KNOW

limited third-person	A narrator outside the story who follows one character's thoughts and knowledge.
dramatic irony	When readers know (or suspect) something a character doesn't.

GET READY

Why does Jekyll slam the window shut in Chapter 7?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapters 7–8: Incident at the Window; The Last Night

As you read: What do Utterson and Enfield see at the window? What do Utterson and Poole find when they break down the door?

The novel's narrator follows Utterson closely. We learn what he learns, when he learns it. Because many readers today already know the twist, they experience dramatic irony:

understanding clues that Utterson misreads.

MODEL · ANALYZE

The window scene

1 Utterson sees only Jekyll's face freeze in terror.

2 Readers may suspect a transformation beginning.

3 Effect: horror for readers; confusion for Utterson.

Model answer: The limited point of view keeps Utterson in the dark while readers sense the horror.

KEY IDEA

Point of view controls what characters and readers know; gaps create suspense or irony.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Whose perspective does the narrator follow?
2. What is dramatic irony?
3. What do they find in Chapter 8?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Limited POV controls knowledge; gaps create suspense and irony.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.6 · RI.7.6, RI.7.8

Lesson 4.6: Author's Purpose and Point of View in Arguments

I can determine an author's point of view and purpose in an argument.

WORDS TO KNOW

argument	Writing that states a claim and supports it with reasons and evidence.
position	The author's stance on an issue.

GET READY

What would Dr. Jekyll say about whether science should have limits?

ARGUMENT

Should Science Have Limits?

An original opinion essay

1 Scientific discoveries have given us vaccines, electricity, and the internet. Some people argue that science should never be restricted, because we cannot know which experiment will lead to the next great breakthrough.

2 I disagree. Science must have limits, especially when experiments involve human beings. History offers painful examples of researchers who harmed people in the name of progress, often people who never agreed to take part.

3 Of course, limits can slow discovery, and rules written by people who don't understand the research may block valuable work. These concerns are real. But careful review by independent experts, who weigh risks and benefits before an experiment begins, protects both the public and the trust that science depends on.

4 Freedom to explore is one of science's greatest strengths. Responsibility is another. A scientist who ignores the second may lose the first.

MODEL · IDENTIFY POSITION AND PURPOSE

"Should Science Have Limits?"

1 Position: "I disagree. Science must have limits."

2 Purpose: to persuade readers to support independent review of experiments.

3 Reasons: past harm to people; protects public trust.

Model answer: The author argues that science needs limits, especially for experiments on people.

KEY IDEA

Find the position (often signaled by I believe, I disagree, must) and the purpose (persuade, inform, explain).

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is the author's position?
2. What view does the author disagree with?
3. What solution does the author propose?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Identify the author's position, purpose, and reasons.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.7 · RI.7.6

Lesson 4.7: Acknowledging Other Viewpoints

I can analyze how an author acknowledges and responds to conflicting viewpoints.

WORDS TO KNOW

counterclaim	An opposing argument.
concession	Admitting that part of the opposing view is valid.
rebuttal	A response that shows why the counterclaim is weaker.

GET READY

Why might an author mention arguments against their own position?

MODEL · FIND CONCESSION AND REBUTTAL

Paragraph 3 of “Should Science Have Limits?”

1 Counterclaim: limits can slow discovery; rules may block valuable work.

2 Concession: “These concerns are real.”

3 Rebuttal: independent expert review weighs risks and protects trust.

Model answer: The author strengthens the argument by admitting valid concerns and then answering them.

Signal phrases
Counterclaim: Some argue… / Critics claim… / It is true that…
Concession: Admittedly… / Of course… / These concerns are real.
Rebuttal: However… / But… / Still, the evidence shows…

KEY IDEA

Strong arguments acknowledge counterclaims, concede what's valid, and rebut.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Find the concession phrase in paragraph 3.

2. Find the rebuttal signal.

3. Why include counterclaims?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Acknowledge, concede, rebut.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.8 · W.7.3, RL.7.6

Lesson 4.8: Retelling from a Different Point of View

I can write a narrative from a different character's point of view.

GET READY

How would Poole, the loyal butler, describe The Last Night?

Retelling a scene from another character's point of view requires using only what that character knows, sees, and feels, and giving them a believable voice.

MODEL · POOLE'S VOICE

Opening line

1 First person; Poole's worry and loyalty.

2 Formal speech of a Victorian butler.

Model answer: I have served Dr. Jekyll for twenty years, sir, and I never once feared to knock upon his door until this week.

KEY IDEA

Stay within the character's knowledge; give them a distinct voice; use dialogue and sensory detail.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What can Poole NOT know?

2. What point of view should you use?

3. Name a detail Poole would notice.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Stay inside one character's knowledge and voice.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.9 · RL.7.6, RL.7.1

Lesson 4.9: Testimony and Reliability

I can evaluate a first-person narrator's reliability.

WORDS TO KNOW

testimony	A formal statement of what someone witnessed.
reliable narrator	A narrator whose account readers can trust.

GET READY

Why would Stevenson let Lanyon, a rational scientist, describe the transformation?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapter 9: Dr. Lanyon's Narrative

As you read: What does Lanyon witness? How does it affect him?

Lanyon's narrative is written like testimony. Because he is a skeptical scientist who doubted Jekyll's theories, his shocked account is especially convincing.

MODEL · EVALUATE RELIABILITY

Is Lanyon reliable?

1 He is a respected doctor and skeptic.

2 He records specific details calmly.

3 His shock shows he didn't want to believe it.

Model answer: Yes; his skepticism makes his testimony more believable.

KEY IDEA

Consider the narrator's background, motives, and tone when judging reliability.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does Lanyon witness?

2. Why is a skeptic a good witness?
3. What happens to Lanyon afterward?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Judge reliability by background, motive, and tone.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.10 · RL.7.4, L.7.3

Lesson 4.10: Pacing and Sentence Structure at the Climax

I can analyze how sentence structure and pacing heighten a climax.

WORDS TO KNOW

pacing	The speed at which events unfold in a story.

GET READY

How can sentence length make your heart beat faster?

At a climax, authors often slow time down with detail or speed it up with short, sharp sentences. Long, building sentences create tension; a sudden short sentence delivers shock.

MODEL · ANALYZE PACING

"The house was silent. Wind pressed against the windows, and somewhere upstairs a floorboard creaked, slow and deliberate, as though someone heavy were shifting from one foot to the other, waiting. Then the lights went out."

1 The long middle sentence stretches time with sound details, building tension.
2 The final short sentence arrives suddenly.
3 Effect: the reader's tension breaks into shock.

Model answer: A long, building sentence followed by a short one creates a sudden shock at the climax.

KEY IDEA

Long sentences build; short sentences strike. Paragraph breaks control pace.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Effect of a one-sentence paragraph
2. Effect of detailed slow description at a climax
3. What is pacing?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Pacing and sentence length heighten climaxes.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.11 · RL.7.2, RL.7.4

Lesson 4.11: Symbolism

I can analyze symbols and explain how they develop a theme.

WORDS TO KNOW

symbol	An object, place, or person that stands for a larger idea.

GET READY

What might the door in Chapter 1 represent?

Symbol	Possible meaning
the shabby back door	Jekyll's hidden, secret self
Jekyll's respectable front entrance	his public reputation
fog	secrecy, confusion, moral murkiness
the potion	the temptation to escape responsibility
the mirror in Jekyll's cabinet	self-knowledge; facing one's true nature

MODEL · ANALYZE A SYMBOL

The two entrances to Jekyll's house

1 Front: elegant, respectable.

2 Back: neglected, used by Hyde.

3 Both lead to the same house.

Model answer: The two entrances symbolize Jekyll's divided self: one respectable face, one hidden, both belonging to the same man.

KEY IDEA

Symbols are concrete objects that stand for abstract ideas; connect them to themes.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does fog symbolize?
2. Why is it important that both doors lead to one house?
3. What is a symbol?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Symbols connect concrete details to abstract themes.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.12 · W.7.9a, W.7.2

Lesson 4.12: Writing a Craft Analysis Paragraph

I can write an analysis of how an author's craft creates meaning.

GET READY

Which of Stevenson's techniques is most effective?

A craft analysis names a technique, gives an example, and explains its effect on the reader and the meaning: Technique → Example → Effect.

MODEL · TEE PARAGRAPH

Technique: delayed revelation

1 Technique: Stevenson delays the truth through sealed documents.

2 Example: Lanyon's letter must not be opened until Jekyll's death.

3 Effect: readers share Utterson's frustration, heightening suspense.

Model answer: Stevenson builds suspense by delaying the truth through sealed documents. When Lanyon gives Utterson a letter that must not be opened until Jekyll's death or disappearance, readers, like Utterson, are forced to wait. This delay makes the final revelation in Chapters 9 and 10 far more shocking.

KEY IDEA

Technique → example → effect, connected to meaning.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does TEE stand for?
2. Name a Stevenson technique.
3. What must the effect connect to?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Technique, example, effect.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.13 · RL.7.2, RL.7.1

Lesson 4.13: The Confession and the Theme of Duality

I can analyze how the final chapter develops the novel's central theme.

WORDS TO KNOW

duality	Having two sides or natures.

GET READY

Is Hyde truly a different person from Jekyll?

READ IN YOUR READER

Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde Reader · Chapter 10: Henry Jekyll's Full Statement of the Case

As you read: What did Jekyll hope to achieve? Why did he lose control?

CLASSIC NOVEL EXCERPT

Jekyll's Statement, Chapter 10 (original text, excerpt)

Robert Louis Stevenson, Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde. Public domain.

"...man is not truly one, but truly two."

MODEL · ANALYZE THEME

What does Jekyll's statement reveal?

1 Jekyll believed he could separate his good and evil sides.

2 He enjoyed being Hyde, free of consequences.

3 Hyde grew stronger until Jekyll could no longer control the change.

Model answer: Theme: Every person has both good and evil within, and trying to escape responsibility for our darker side can destroy us.

KEY IDEA

The final chapter reveals and completes the theme of duality.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What did Jekyll want to separate?
2. Why did he lose control?
3. State the theme in your own words.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

The confession completes the theme of duality.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.14 · RL.7.6, RL.7.5

Lesson 4.14: Comparing Narrators Across the Novel

I can compare how different narrators reveal the story and why the author arranged them this way.

GET READY

Why does Stevenson save Jekyll's own voice for last?

Narrator / perspective	What they know	Effect
Enfield (Ch. 1)	an incident and a feeling of disgust	introduces the mystery
Utterson (limited 3rd)	clues, suspicions	builds suspense; reader as detective
Lanyon (Ch. 9)	the transformation, witnessed	shock and proof
Jekyll (Ch. 10)	everything, from inside	explanation and confession

KEY IDEA

Stevenson moves from outside to inside: from rumor, to investigation, to witness, to confession.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which narrator gives the inside view?
2. Why save Jekyll for last?
3. What role does the reader play during Utterson's sections?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Narrators move from outside to inside.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.15 · RL.7.9, RI.7.9

Lesson 4.15: Fiction and History: Self-Experimentation

I can compare a fictional portrayal with historical accounts.

WORDS TO KNOW

self-experimentation A scientist testing a procedure or substance on themselves.

GET READY

Did real scientists ever test dangerous ideas on themselves?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Scientists Who Experimented on Themselves

An original informational text based on historical facts

The Doctor Who Reached His Own Heart

In 1929, a young German doctor named Werner Forssmann believed a thin tube could be guided through a vein all the way to the heart, a procedure many experts considered deadly. When his supervisors refused permission, Forssmann numbed his own arm, inserted a tube into a vein, and pushed it toward his heart. Then he walked to the X-ray room to photograph the result.

Forssmann's colleagues were not impressed, and he was criticized for his reckless act. Decades later, however, the technique, called cardiac catheterization, became a standard part of medicine. In 1956, Forssmann shared the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine.

The Doctor Who Drank Bacteria

In the early 1980s, Australian doctors Barry Marshall and Robin Warren argued that many stomach ulcers were caused by bacteria, not stress. Other scientists doubted them. In 1984, Marshall drank a culture of the bacteria. Within days he became ill with stomach inflammation, supporting the doctors' claim. Marshall and Warren received the Nobel Prize in 2005.

A Risky Tradition

Self-experimentation has produced important discoveries, but it can also cause serious harm, and its results can be misleading because they involve only one person. Today, research involving people is reviewed by ethics committees designed to protect volunteers, including the scientists themselves.

	Jekyll (fiction)	Forssmann and Marshall (history)
Goal	to separate good and evil	to prove a medical idea
Method	a secret potion	a catheter; drinking bacteria
Result	loses control; destruction	risky but useful discoveries; Nobel Prizes
Shared idea	willingness to take personal risk	willingness to take personal risk

KEY IDEA

Compare how fiction and history portray a similar topic; notice what fiction exaggerates or changes for its purpose.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What did Forssmann do?
2. What did Marshall do?
3. What protects research volunteers today?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Fiction exaggerates and warns; history records outcomes.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.16 · W.7.2, W.7.9

Lesson 4.16: Writing a Comparative Analysis

I can write a comparative analysis of a fictional and an informational text.

GET READY

What can Jekyll's story teach us about real science?

A comparative analysis has a thesis that names both texts and the point of comparison, body paragraphs organized point by point, integrated evidence from both texts, and a conclusion about what the comparison reveals.

MODEL · THESIS

Compare Jekyll with Forssmann and Marshall.

1 Name both texts.

2 Point of comparison: risk and responsibility.

Model answer: Both Stevenson's Dr. Jekyll and the real doctors Forssmann and Marshall risked their own bodies for knowledge, but while their experiments advanced medicine, Jekyll's selfish secrecy shows how ambition without responsibility leads to ruin.

KEY IDEA

Name both texts, compare point by point, integrate evidence, and explain what the comparison reveals.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What must the thesis name?
2. Which structure works well?
3. What does the conclusion explain?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Comparative analysis: thesis, point by point, both texts, significance.

UNIT 4 REVIEW

Unit 4 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
4.1	Word choice creates tone (author's attitude) and mood (reader's feeling).
4.2	Documents and delays create suspense.
4.3	Sections build the central idea together.
4.4	Context defines technical words; use them precisely.
4.5	Limited POV controls knowledge; gaps create suspense and irony.
4.6	Identify the author's position, purpose, and reasons.
4.7	Acknowledge, concede, rebut.
4.8	Stay inside one character's knowledge and voice.
4.9	Judge reliability by background, motive, and tone.
4.10	Pacing and sentence length heighten climaxes.
4.11	Symbols connect concrete details to abstract themes.
4.12	Technique, example, effect.
4.13	The confession completes the theme of duality.
4.14	Narrators move from outside to inside.
4.15	Fiction exaggerates and warns; history records outcomes.
4.16	Comparative analysis: thesis, point by point, both texts, significance.

UNIT 5

Modifiers and Precise Description

Adjectives, adverbs, comparison, modifier placement, prepositions, interjections, conjunctions, and science-fiction writing, with The Time Machine, Chapters 1–4.

H. G. Wells imagined a machine that could travel through time, and he had to describe something no one had ever experienced. In this unit you'll study how writers use modifiers to make description vivid and precise, master the grammar of adjectives, adverbs, phrases, and clauses, and write your own science-fiction scene.

In this unit you will…

- Analyze science fiction, frame narratives, and descriptive craft.
- Use and punctuate adjectives and adverbs; form comparisons correctly.
- Place modifiers correctly; use prepositions, interjections, and conjunctions.
- Write and revise a vivid, concise science-fiction scene.

WHY IT MATTERS

Precise, concise language makes everything from product descriptions to science reports clearer, and GPS really does depend on Einstein's ideas about time.

UNIT VOCABULARY

coordinate adjectives	Equal adjectives separated by a comma.
dangling modifier	A modifier with no clear word to describe.
comparative	Compares two.
interjection	Expresses sudden emotion.
redundancy	Saying the same thing twice.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
5.1	Science Fiction and the Frame Narrative

Lesson	Title
5.2	Adjectives: Proper, Compound, and Coordinate
5.3	Adverbs and Their Placement
5.4	How Modifiers Create Description
5.5	Comparative and Superlative Forms
5.6	Phrases and Clauses as Modifiers
5.7	Misplaced and Dangling Modifiers
5.8	Precise Modifiers in Scientific Writing
5.9	Prepositions and Prepositional Phrases
5.10	Interjections and Tone in Dialogue
5.11	Conjunctions: Coordinating, Subordinating, and Correlative
5.12	Parts of Speech in Context
5.13	Analyzing Descriptive Writing
5.14	Planning a Science-Fiction Scene
5.15	Drafting with Precise Modifiers and Concise Language
5.16	Revising and Editing the Scene

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.1 · RL.7.3, RL.7.5

Lesson 5.1: Science Fiction and the Frame Narrative

I can analyze the elements of science fiction and how a frame narrative shapes a story.

WORDS TO KNOW

science fiction	Fiction that imagines how science and technology might change the world.
narrator	The voice telling the story.

GET READY

If you could travel in time, would you go to the past or the future? Why?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapter 1: The Inventor

As you read: What does the Time Traveller explain to his guests? How do they react?

The Time Machine (1895) by H. G. Wells helped invent modern science fiction. Like Jekyll and Hyde, it uses a frame: an unnamed narrator describes the Time Traveller's dinner guests and then retells the Traveller's own story.

CLASSIC NOVEL EXCERPT

From The Time Machine, Chapter 1 (original 1895 text)

H. G. Wells, The Time Machine (1895). Public domain.

The Time Traveller (for so it will be convenient to speak of him) was expounding a recondite matter to us. His grey eyes shone and twinkled, and his usually pale face was flushed and animated.

MODEL · ANALYZE THE OPENING

What do we learn in the first two sentences?

1. The narrator doesn't name the Time Traveller.
2. “Recondite” means obscure or difficult.
3. Shining eyes and flushed face show excitement.

Model answer: The Traveller is an enthusiastic, brilliant scientist explaining a difficult idea to his guests.

KEY IDEA

Science fiction imagines scientific possibilities; a frame narrator filters the Traveller's story through a listener.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does “recondite” mean?
2. Why might the narrator not name the Time Traveller?
3. How do the guests react to his ideas?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Science fiction imagines scientific possibilities; the frame filters the story.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.2 · L.7.2a, L.7.1

Lesson 5.2: Adjectives: Proper, Compound, and Coordinate

I can use proper, compound, and coordinate adjectives with correct punctuation.

WORDS TO KNOW

coordinate adjectives	Two or more adjectives that equally describe a noun; separated by a comma.
compound adjective	Two or more words joined to act as one adjective, often hyphenated.

GET READY

Should there be a comma in “a dusty enormous telescope”?

Type	Example	Rule
proper adjective	a Victorian house, an English scientist	capitalize
compound adjective before a noun	a well-known inventor, a time-traveling machine	hyphenate
coordinate adjectives	a cold, dark night	comma (could use “and”; order can switch)
cumulative adjectives	a large brass lever	no comma (can't use “and”; order fixed)

MODEL · COMMA TEST

a dusty enormous telescope

1 Test 1: a dusty and enormous telescope? Sounds fine.

2 Test 2: an enormous, dusty telescope? Sounds fine.

3 Both pass → coordinate → comma.

Model answer: a dusty, enormous telescope

KEY IDEA

If you can add “and” or switch the order, use a comma. Hyphenate compound adjectives before nouns. Capitalize proper adjectives.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Comma? “a bright shiny lever”

2. Comma? “three old books”

3. Fix: a well known scientist

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Comma for coordinate adjectives; hyphens for compound adjectives; capitals for proper adjectives.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.3 · L.7.1

Lesson 5.3: Adverbs and Their Placement

I can use adverbs to modify verbs, adjectives, and other adverbs and place them for clarity.

WORDS TO KNOW

adverb	A word that modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb, telling how, when, where, or to what extent.

GET READY

What's the difference between “She only touched the lever” and “Only she touched the lever”?

Modifies	Example
a verb	The machine hummed softly.
an adjective	The laboratory was extremely quiet.
another adverb	She pulled the lever very gently.

MODEL · PLACEMENT CHANGES MEANING

only

1 Only she touched the lever. (no one else did)

2 She only touched the lever. (she didn't pull it)

3 She touched only the lever. (nothing else)

Model answer: Place limiting adverbs (only, just, almost, nearly) right before what they modify.

KEY IDEA

Adverbs tell how, when, where, or to what extent. Place limiting adverbs carefully.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Adverb in “The guests laughed nervously.”
2. What does “very” modify in “very gently”?
3. Meaning: “I almost read the whole book.”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Adverbs tell how, when, where, extent; placement matters.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.4 · RL.7.4, L.7.3

Lesson 5.4: How Modifiers Create Description

I can analyze how an author's modifiers create vivid description and tone.

GET READY

What do “shone and twinkled” and “flushed and animated” tell you about the Time Traveller?

Modifiers do the heavy lifting in description. Ask: Which modifiers stand out? What image or feeling do they create? How do they shape the reader's view of the character or scene?

MODEL · ANALYZE WELLS'S MODIFIERS

“His grey eyes shone and twinkled, and his usually pale face was flushed and animated.”

1 “usually pale”: the adverb tells us this is unusual excitement.

2 “flushed and animated”: pairs of adjectives show energy.

3 “shone and twinkled”: verbs pair with light imagery.

Model answer: Wells's modifiers show a normally quiet scientist made radiant by excitement about his idea.

KEY IDEA

Analyze specific modifiers: what image, what feeling, what effect on the reader.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does “usually” tell us?
2. What tone do the modifiers create?
3. Name a modifier that is an adverb.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Modifiers create images and tone.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.5 · L.7.1

Lesson 5.5: Comparative and Superlative Forms

I can use comparative and superlative forms correctly, including irregular forms and fewer/less.

WORDS TO KNOW

comparative	Compares two things: faster, more careful.
superlative	Compares three or more: fastest, most careful.

GET READY

Is the Time Machine "more faster" than a train?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapter 2: The Machine

As you read: What happens to the small model machine? How do the guests explain it?

Rule	Comparative	Superlative
one syllable: -er, -est	faster	fastest
most two+ syllables: more, most	more careful	most careful
two syllables ending in -y: -ier, -iest	happier	happiest
irregular good/well	better	best
irregular bad/badly	worse	worst
irregular many/much	more	most

Fewer is for things you can count (fewer guests); less is for amounts you can't count (less time). Never double up: more faster is incorrect.

KEY IDEA

Comparative for two, superlative for three or more; no double comparisons; fewer for countable, less for uncountable.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Correct: The model was (smaller/smallest) of the two machines.
2. Correct: (Fewer/Less) people believed him.
3. Correct: This is the (baddest/worst) storm.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Comparatives for two, superlatives for more; fewer vs less.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.6 · L.7.1a, L.7.1b

Lesson 5.6: Phrases and Clauses as Modifiers

I can use adjective and adverb clauses and phrases to add precise detail.

WORDS TO KNOW

adjective clause	A dependent clause that modifies a noun, often beginning with who, which, or that.
adverb clause	A dependent clause that modifies a verb, telling when, why, or how, often beginning with because, when, although, if.

GET READY

How can you add detail to “The machine vanished”?

Modifier	Example
adjective phrase	The machine with the brass lever vanished.
adjective clause	The machine, which the Traveller had built, vanished.
adverb phrase	The machine vanished in an instant.
adverb clause	When he pressed the lever, the machine vanished.

Use commas around adjective clauses that add extra (nonessential) information; no commas when the clause is essential to identify the noun. Put a comma after an introductory adverb clause.

KEY IDEA

Phrases and clauses add precise detail; punctuate essential and nonessential clauses correctly.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Identify: The guest who doubted him was the Psychologist.
2. Identify: Because the model vanished, the guests argued.
3. Comma needed after an introductory adverb clause?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Phrases and clauses modify; punctuate correctly.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.7 · L.7.1c

Lesson 5.7: Misplaced and Dangling Modifiers

I can recognize and correct misplaced and dangling modifiers.

WORDS TO KNOW

misplaced modifier	A modifier placed too far from the word it describes, causing confusion.
dangling modifier	A modifier with no clear word in the sentence to describe.

GET READY

What's funny about: “Covered in dust, the Traveller found the model”?

Problem	Example	Fix
misplaced	The guests watched the machine vanish with wide eyes.	With wide eyes, the guests watched the machine vanish.
misplaced	She found a book in the library that was falling apart.	In the library, she found a book that was falling apart.
dangling	Pushing the lever, the room began to shake.	As Mara pushed the lever, the room began to shake.
dangling	After eating dinner, the machine was demonstrated.	After eating dinner, the Traveller demonstrated the machine.

KEY IDEA

Put modifiers next to what they modify. An opening phrase must describe the subject that follows it.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fix: Hungry and tired, the dinner looked delicious to the Traveller.
2. Fix: I saw a strange bird walking to school.
3. What must an opening phrase describe?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Place modifiers next to what they modify.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.8 · RI.7.4, RI.7.3

Lesson 5.8: Precise Modifiers in Scientific Writing

I can analyze how precise language communicates scientific ideas.

WORDS TO KNOW

dimension	A measurable extent, such as length, width, height, or time.
spacetime	Space and time combined into a single four-dimensional framework.

GET READY

How would you explain the “fourth dimension” to a ten-year-old?

SCIENCE TEXT

What Is the Fourth Dimension?

An original informational text

1 We usually describe space with three dimensions: length, width, and height. A shoebox, for example, is a certain number of inches long, wide, and tall. To find any point inside it, you need exactly three measurements.

2 But objects also exist in time. A shoebox that sits on a shelf for ten years has a past and a future as well as a size. Scientists and writers have long wondered whether time might be thought of as a fourth dimension, one that we move through steadily in one direction.

3 In 1895, H. G. Wells imagined a machine that could travel along this fourth dimension as easily as a train travels along a track. Ten years later, the physicist Albert Einstein published his theory of special relativity, which treats space and time as closely connected, and which soon led scientists to describe the universe as four-dimensional "spacetime."

4 Einstein's work showed that time is not the same for everyone: a clock moving very fast ticks more slowly than one at rest. This effect is tiny at everyday speeds but measurable. Satellites in the GPS system must correct their clocks for it, or the maps on our phones would quickly become inaccurate.

MODEL · ANALYZE PRECISION

"a clock moving very fast ticks more slowly than one at rest"

1 Comparative "more slowly" compares two clocks precisely.

2 "very fast" and "at rest" define the conditions.

Model answer: Precise modifiers make a surprising scientific claim clear and specific.

KEY IDEA

Scientific writers use precise modifiers and comparisons to explain complex ideas clearly.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What are the three spatial dimensions?
2. Who published the theory of special relativity, and when?
3. Why must GPS correct its clocks?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Precise modifiers and comparisons explain science clearly.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.9 · L.7.1

Lesson 5.9: Prepositions and Prepositional Phrases

I can identify prepositional phrases and explain whether they act as adjectives or adverbs.

WORDS TO KNOW

preposition	A word showing a relationship between a noun and another word: in, on, through, during, beneath.
object of the preposition	The noun or pronoun that ends a prepositional phrase.

GET READY

How do prepositions help readers picture where and when things happen?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapter 3: The Time Traveller Returns

As you read: What condition is the Traveller in when he returns? How do the guests react?

Function	Example	Answers
adjective phrase	the man with the limp	which man?
adverb phrase	He limped into the room.	where?
adverb phrase	He returned after a week.	when?

MODEL · IDENTIFY

"The Traveller stood in the doorway with dust on his coat."

1 in the doorway → where he stood (adverb).

2 with dust → describes the Traveller (adjective).

3 on his coat → where the dust was (adjective modifying dust).

Model answer: Three prepositional phrases adding place and detail.

KEY IDEA

Prepositional phrases act as adjectives (which one?) or adverbs (where, when, how?).

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Find the prepositional phrase: The guests sat around the table.
2. Function of “around the table”
3. Object of the preposition in “after dinner”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Prepositional phrases act as adjectives or adverbs.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.10 · L.7.1, L.7.3

Lesson 5.10: Interjections and Tone in Dialogue

I can use interjections and punctuation to convey emotion and tone.

WORDS TO KNOW

interjection	A word or phrase that expresses sudden emotion: Wow! Oh no! Hey, well, alas.

GET READY

What does “Oh!” add to a character's line?

Interjections show emotion. Strong ones take an exclamation point; mild ones take a comma: Wow! It worked. / Well, I suppose so. Use them sparingly in formal writing; they're most at home in dialogue.

SCIENCE FICTION

The First Jump

An original science-fiction story

1 Mara gripped the brass lever with both hands. The machine hummed softly, then louder, until the whole laboratory trembled. She took a long breath and pushed.

2 Instantly, the room dissolved. Sunlight and darkness flickered across the walls faster than she could blink, day and night racing like the pages of a book flipped by an impatient thumb. The plant on the windowsill shot upward, bloomed, withered, and crumbled into dust. Outside, buildings rose like mushrooms after rain, then sagged, then vanished.

3 Her stomach lurched. Wow! she thought, half terrified and half thrilled. She pulled the lever back, gently, carefully, and the flickering slowed to a dizzy blur.

MODEL · ANALYZE AN INTERJECTION

"Wow! she thought, half terrified and half thrilled."

1 "Wow!" bursts with sudden emotion.

2 The phrase "half terrified and half thrilled" explains the mixed feeling.

Model answer: The interjection captures Mara's shock in a single word.

KEY IDEA

Interjections convey sudden emotion; use exclamation points for strong feeling, commas for mild.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Punctuate: well I suppose you're right
2. Punctuate: ouch that hurt
3. Where do interjections belong most?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Interjections express emotion; punctuate by strength.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.11 · L.7.1b

Lesson 5.11: Conjunctions: Coordinating, Subordinating, and Correlative

I can use conjunctions to show relationships between ideas.

WORDS TO KNOW

coordinating conjunction	Joins equal parts: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so.
subordinating conjunction	Begins a dependent clause: because, although, when, if, since, while.
correlative conjunctions	Work in pairs: either…or, neither…nor, both…and, not only…but also.

GET READY

How is “The Traveller returned, but he was injured” different from “Although the Traveller returned, he was injured”?

Type	Example	Relationship
coordinating	The machine shook, but it held together.	contrast (equal ideas)
subordinating	Because the lever stuck, Mara panicked.	cause
subordinating	Although he was exhausted, he told his story.	concession
correlative	Not only was he hungry, but he was also hurt.	addition (paired)

Correlative conjunctions need parallel structure: either to the past or to the future (not either to the past or the future travel).

KEY IDEA

Choose conjunctions that show the exact relationship: addition, contrast, cause, time, or condition.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Relationship shown by “although”

2. Complete: Neither the Psychologist ___ the Doctor believed him.

3. Coordinating or subordinating: because

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Conjunctions show relationships between ideas.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.12 · L.7.1, L.7.4c

Lesson 5.12: Parts of Speech in Context

I can determine a word's part of speech by how it functions in a sentence.

GET READY

Is “light” a noun, verb, or adjective?

Many words can function as more than one part of speech. Decide by asking how the word works in this sentence.

Sentence	Word	Part of speech
The light flickered.	light	noun
Light the lamp.	light	verb
The model was light enough to hold.	light	adjective
She traveled far.	far	adverb
The far future was strange.	far	adjective
He walked down the stairs.	down	preposition
She looked down.	down	adverb

KEY IDEA

Function determines part of speech: name it (noun), act (verb), describe a noun (adjective), modify a verb/adjective/adverb (adverb), relate (preposition).

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. “Time flies.” Part of speech of “flies”

2. “The time machine” Part of speech of “time”

3. “She looked up.” Part of speech of “up”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Function determines part of speech.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.13 · RL.7.4, RL.7.3

Lesson 5.13: Analyzing Descriptive Writing

I can analyze how an author describes an extraordinary experience.

WORDS TO KNOW

sensory details	Details that appeal to sight, sound, touch, taste, or smell.

GET READY

How would you describe something no one has ever experienced?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapter 4: Time Travelling

As you read: How does the Traveller describe the feeling of traveling through time? What does he see?

Wells had to describe something impossible: traveling through time. He relies on comparisons to familiar things, sensory details, and the Traveller's physical and emotional reactions.

Technique	What to look for in Chapter 4
comparison	time passing compared to familiar things
sensory detail	light flickering, sound, motion, sickness
physical reaction	dizziness, nausea, fear
accelerated change	the sun and seasons racing past

KEY IDEA

Authors make the impossible vivid with comparisons, sensory details, and characters' reactions.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why compare an impossible experience to familiar things?
2. Name a sensory detail from Chapter 4.
3. How does the Traveller feel?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Comparisons, senses, and reactions make the impossible vivid.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.14 · W.7.3a

Lesson 5.14: Planning a Science-Fiction Scene

I can plan a science-fiction scene with a clear setting, conflict, and point of view.

WORDS TO KNOW

conflict	A struggle between opposing forces.

GET READY

If you invented a machine, what would go wrong?

Your scene: a character uses an invention or arrives in a future or past world. Plan the setting (time, place, technology), character, conflict, point of view, and the sensory details you'll use.

Plan element	Questions
Setting	When and where? What technology exists?
Character	Who? What do they want?
Conflict	What goes wrong or stands in the way?
Point of view	First person or third person limited?
Sensory details	What will the reader see, hear, feel?
Ending	How is the moment resolved, or left on a cliffhanger?

KEY IDEA

Plan setting, character, conflict, point of view, sensory details, and ending before drafting.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is conflict?
2. Name two points of view you could use.
3. Why plan sensory details?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Plan setting, character, conflict, POV, details, ending.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.15 · W.7.3d, L.7.3a

Lesson 5.15: Drafting with Precise Modifiers and Concise Language

I can draft a scene using precise modifiers while eliminating wordiness and redundancy.

WORDS TO KNOW

redundancy	Saying the same thing twice: “past history,” “completely finished.”
wordiness	Using more words than needed.

GET READY

Which is better: “The machine was very, very, extremely fast” or “The machine was blindingly fast”?

Wordy or redundant	Concise
due to the fact that	because
at this point in time	now
completely finished	finished
return back	return
very scared	terrified
She moved quickly and fast.	She darted.

Choose one precise modifier instead of several weak ones. Cut redundant words. Use strong verbs so you need fewer adverbs.

KEY IDEA

One precise word beats three vague ones. Cut redundancy and wordiness.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Concise: in the event that
2. Concise: very tired
3. Redundant phrase: “past history.” Fix.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Precise, concise language strengthens writing.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.16 · W.7.5, L.7.1c, L.7.2a

Lesson 5.16: Revising and Editing the Scene

I can revise and edit my scene for modifiers, punctuation, and clarity.

GET READY

Which sentence in your draft is the most vivid? Which is the weakest?

Checklist	✓
Coordinate adjectives have commas; compound adjectives have hyphens.	
No misplaced or dangling modifiers.	
Comparatives and superlatives are correct (no double comparisons; fewer/less).	
Interjections are punctuated correctly and used sparingly.	
Conjunctions show clear relationships; correlatives are parallel.	
Wordiness and redundancy are cut.	

KEY IDEA

Revise for vividness and clarity; edit for modifier rules and punctuation.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fix: Racing through time, the stars blurred.
2. Fix: a strange flickering light
3. Fix: less buildings

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise for vividness; edit modifiers and punctuation.

UNIT 5 REVIEW

Unit 5 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
5.1	Science fiction imagines scientific possibilities; the frame filters the story.
5.2	Comma for coordinate adjectives; hyphens for compound adjectives; capitals for proper adjectives.
5.3	Adverbs tell how, when, where, extent; placement matters.
5.4	Modifiers create images and tone.
5.5	Comparatives for two, superlatives for more; fewer vs less.
5.6	Phrases and clauses modify; punctuate correctly.
5.7	Place modifiers next to what they modify.
5.8	Precise modifiers and comparisons explain science clearly.
5.9	Prepositional phrases act as adjectives or adverbs.
5.10	Interjections express emotion; punctuate by strength.
5.11	Conjunctions show relationships between ideas.
5.12	Function determines part of speech.
5.13	Comparisons, senses, and reactions make the impossible vivid.
5.14	Plan setting, character, conflict, POV, details, ending.
5.15	Precise, concise language strengthens writing.
5.16	Revise for vividness; edit modifiers and punctuation.

UNIT 6

Sentence Craft

Clauses and sentence types, phrases, combining, variety, parallelism, and analytical writing, with The Time Machine, Chapters 5–12.

In the year 802,701, the Time Traveller discovers that a beautiful world hides a terrible secret. As you follow him into the darkness, you'll master the building blocks of strong sentences: clauses, phrases, and the four sentence types. You'll combine and vary sentences for clarity and power, and write an essay about Wells's warning to the future.

In this unit you will…

- Analyze utopia, dystopia, allegory, and symbolism.
- Identify clauses and write all four sentence types.
- Identify and use prepositional, appositive, participial, gerund, and infinitive phrases.
- Combine sentences precisely; vary sentences; use parallel structure; revise an analytical essay.

WHY IT MATTERS

Writers, lawyers, and leaders use sentence variety and parallelism to make arguments memorable, and dystopian stories still shape debates about technology and fairness.

UNIT VOCABULARY

independent clause	Can stand alone.
dependent clause	Cannot stand alone.
gerund	An -ing verb used as a noun.
allegory	A story representing larger ideas.
parallel structure	Same grammatical form in a series.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
6.1	Utopia or Dystopia?

Lesson	Title
6.2	Independent and Dependent Clauses
6.3	Four Sentence Types
6.4	Analyzing Sentence Structure for Effect
6.5	Revising a Hypothesis
6.6	Five Kinds of Phrases
6.7	Participial Phrases as Modifiers
6.8	Gerunds and Infinitives as Nouns
6.9	Allegory and Social Commentary
6.10	Combining with Conjunctions and Relative Clauses
6.11	Combining with Phrases
6.12	Precision vs. Over-Combining
6.13	Symbolism in the Palace and the Fire
6.14	Sentence Variety
6.15	Parallel Structure
6.16	Revising an Analytical Essay

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.1 · RL.7.2, RI.7.2

Lesson 6.1: Utopia or Dystopia?

I can analyze how an author's portrayal of a future society develops a theme.

WORDS TO KNOW

utopia	An imagined perfect society.
dystopia	An imagined society where something has gone terribly wrong.

GET READY

Would a world with no work, no war, and no disease be perfect?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapters 5–6: In the Golden Age; The Sunset

As you read: What are the Eloi like? What does the Traveller first conclude about their world?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Utopias and Dystopias

An original informational text

1 A utopia is an imagined perfect society, where everyone is happy and no one suffers. The word was coined in 1516 by the English writer Thomas More, who combined Greek roots meaning “no place,” a sly hint that such a perfect world may not exist.

2 A dystopia is the opposite: an imagined society in which something has gone terribly wrong, often hidden behind a surface that looks peaceful or orderly. Dystopian stories usually exaggerate a problem in the writer's own time to warn readers about where it might lead.

3 When the Time Traveller first arrives in the year 802,701, he believes he has found a utopia. The Eloi live in a garden-like world without work, war, or disease. But as he explores, he discovers that the beautiful surface hides a disturbing truth. Many readers see The Time Machine as an early dystopian warning about the growing divide between the wealthy and the working poor in Victorian England.

MODEL · ANALYZE THE FIRST IMPRESSION

What does the Traveller first believe?

1 He sees gardens, peace, and no labor.

2 He concludes humanity has achieved an easy, comfortable life.

Model answer: He believes the future is a kind of utopia, though readers sense something is missing.

KEY IDEA

Utopias and dystopias comment on the author's own time. Look beneath the surface.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What do the roots of “utopia” mean?
2. What are the Eloi like?
3. What might the Eloi's world warn about?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Utopias and dystopias comment on real societies.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.2 · L.7.1a, L.7.1b

Lesson 6.2: Independent and Dependent Clauses

I can identify independent and dependent clauses.

WORDS TO KNOW

clause	A group of words with a subject and a verb.
independent clause	A clause that can stand alone as a sentence.
dependent clause	A clause that cannot stand alone; it begins with a subordinating word.

GET READY

Why is “Because the Traveller lost his machine” not a complete sentence?

Clause	Example	Can it stand alone?
independent	The Traveller lost his machine.	yes
dependent (adverb)	because the Traveller lost his machine	no
dependent (adjective)	which had vanished overnight	no
dependent (noun)	that the Eloi were afraid of the dark	no

MODEL · IDENTIFY CLAUSES

When night fell, the Eloi hid in their great halls.

1 "When night fell": subordinating word → dependent.

2 "the Eloi hid in their great halls": independent.

Model answer: one dependent + one independent clause

KEY IDEA

Every clause has a subject and verb. Dependent clauses begin with subordinating words and need an independent clause.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Independent or dependent: although they were gentle

2. Independent or dependent: The Eloi feared the dark.

3. Find the dependent clause: The machine that he built was gone.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Independent clauses stand alone; dependent clauses don't.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.3 · L.7.1b

Lesson 6.3: Four Sentence Types

I can write simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences to signal relationships among ideas.

WORDS TO KNOW

compound-complex sentence	Two or more independent clauses and at least one dependent clause.

GET READY

How can one idea be written four different ways?

Type	Structure	Example
simple	one independent clause	The machine vanished.
compound	two independent clauses	The machine vanished, and the Traveller panicked.
complex	independent + dependent	When the machine vanished, the Traveller panicked.
compound-complex	two independent + one or more dependent	When the machine vanished, the Traveller panicked, but he soon began to search.

KEY IDEA

Choose sentence types to show relationships: equal ideas (compound), cause/time/contrast (complex), both (compound-complex).

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Type: The Eloi laughed, but the Traveller worried.
2. Type: Because Weena feared the dark, she clung to him.
3. Type: The sun set.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Simple, compound, complex, compound-complex.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.4 · L.7.3, RL.7.4

Lesson 6.4: Analyzing Sentence Structure for Effect

I can analyze how sentence structures create rhythm, emphasis, and meaning.

GET READY

Why might an author follow a long sentence with a very short one?

DESCRIPTIVE WRITING

The Lighthouse at Dawn

An original passage

1 The storm ended. Gray light crept over the water, and the waves, which had roared all night, settled into a slow, tired rhythm. Because the beam had stayed lit through the darkness, every boat had found the harbor.

2 Exhausted but proud, the keeper climbed down the tower. She had not slept, she had not eaten, and she had not once doubted that the light mattered.

MODEL · ANALYZE

"The storm ended."

1 Simple, three words, the first sentence.

2 Effect: a sudden calm after the chaos; emphasis on relief.

Model answer: The short sentence enacts the sudden stillness.

MODEL · ANALYZE REPETITION

"She had not slept, she had not eaten, and she had not once doubted…"

1 Compound sentence with repeated structure.

2 Builds to the most important clause.

Model answer: The repetition builds to a climax: her faith in the light.

KEY IDEA

Short sentences emphasize; long sentences build; repeated structures create rhythm and climax.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Sentence type: “The storm ended.”
2. Find the complex sentence that begins with “Because.”
3. What does the repetition in paragraph 2 emphasize?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Sentence structure creates emphasis and rhythm.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.5 · RL.7.3, RL.7.1

Lesson 6.5: Revising a Hypothesis

I can analyze how a character's reasoning changes as new evidence appears.

WORDS TO KNOW

hypothesis	A proposed explanation that can be tested.

GET READY

What does a good scientist do when the evidence doesn't fit the theory?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapters 7–8: A Sudden Shock; Explanation

As you read: What happens to the machine? What new creatures does the Traveller glimpse? How does his explanation change?

The Traveller thinks like a scientist. He forms a hypothesis about the future, then revises it when new evidence appears. Tracking these revisions shows how Wells builds suspense and develops theme.

Evidence	Traveller's explanation
peaceful gardens, no labor (Ch. 5–6)	humanity has reached a comfortable, easy life
machine stolen; strange wells; pale creatures at night (Ch. 7–8)	another species lives underground
Morlocks' behavior (later)	the two species descend from divided social classes

KEY IDEA

Track how a character's theory changes with evidence; each revision deepens the theme.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a hypothesis?
2. What evidence challenges the Traveller's first theory?
3. Why does revising a hypothesis build suspense?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Characters revise hypotheses as evidence changes.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.6 · L.7.1a

Lesson 6.6: Five Kinds of Phrases

I can identify prepositional, appositive, participial, gerund, and infinitive phrases and their functions.

WORDS TO KNOW

phrase	A group of related words without both a subject and a verb.

GET READY

In "Searching for the machine, the Traveller pried at the sphinx," what does "Searching for the machine" describe?

Phrase	Starts with	Function	Example
prepositional	a preposition	adjective/adverb	under the sphinx
appositive	a noun	renames a noun	Weena, an Eloi girl, ...
participial	-ing or -ed verb form	adjective	Exhausted by the search, he rested.
gerund	-ing verb form	noun	Finding the machine was his goal.
infinitive	to + verb	noun, adjective, or adverb	He wanted to escape.

MODEL · PARTICIPIAL VS GERUND

"Searching for the machine" in two sentences

1 Searching for the machine, the Traveller pried at the sphinx. → describes the Traveller → participial.

2 Searching for the machine took days. → acts as the subject → gerund.

Model answer: Same words, different functions.

KEY IDEA

Identify a phrase by its first word and its job in the sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Phrase type: to find Weena

2. Phrase type: Frightened by the dark, Weena trembled.

3. Phrase type: Lighting matches kept the Morlocks away.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Prepositional, appositive, participial, gerund, infinitive.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.7 · L.7.1a, L.7.1c

Lesson 6.7: Participial Phrases as Modifiers

I can use participial phrases to add detail and punctuate them correctly.

WORDS TO KNOW

participle	A verb form used as an adjective: frightened, glowing.

GET READY

How can you combine "Weena was frightened" and "Weena clung to him" into one smooth sentence?

Participial phrases add action and detail. An introductory participial phrase is followed by a comma, and it must describe the subject right after the comma (or it dangles).

MODEL · COMBINE

Weena was frightened by the dark. She clung to the Traveller.

1 Turn the first sentence into a participial phrase.

2 Place it next to "she."

Model answer: Frightened by the dark, Weena clung to the Traveller.

KEY IDEA

Use participial phrases to combine and add detail; place them next to the noun they describe.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Combine: The Traveller was exhausted. He fell asleep.
2. Fix: Glowing in the dark, the Traveller saw their eyes.
3. Comma after an introductory participial phrase?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Participial phrases add detail; place them next to the subject.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.8 · L.7.1a

Lesson 6.8: Gerunds and Infinitives as Nouns

I can use gerund and infinitive phrases as subjects and objects.

WORDS TO KNOW

gerund	An -ing verb form used as a noun.
infinitive	To + a verb, used as a noun, adjective, or adverb.

GET READY

What is the subject of "Finding the machine became his only goal"?

Function	Gerund	Infinitive
subject	Exploring the ruins was risky.	To explore the ruins was risky.
direct object	He enjoyed studying the stars.	He wanted to study the stars.
predicate noun	His goal was finding the machine.	His goal was to find the machine.

KEY IDEA

Gerund and infinitive phrases can act as nouns: subjects, objects, and predicate nouns.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Function of "to warn his friends" in "He decided to warn his friends."
2. Function of "Escaping the Morlocks" in "Escaping the Morlocks required fire."
3. Gerund in "Weena loved collecting flowers."

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Gerund and infinitive phrases can act as nouns.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.9 · RL.7.2, RL.7.6

Lesson 6.9: Allegory and Social Commentary

I can analyze how a story functions as an allegory or social commentary.

WORDS TO KNOW

allegory	A story in which characters and events represent larger ideas.
social commentary	Writing that criticizes or comments on society.

GET READY

Why might the Eloi live above ground and the Morlocks below?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapters 9–10: Morlocks; Night

As you read: What does the Traveller discover underground? What is the relationship between the Eloi and the Morlocks?

The Traveller concludes that the Eloi descended from the leisured upper class and the Morlocks from the laboring class who worked underground. Over time, the divide became so extreme that humanity split into two species. Many readers see this as Wells's social commentary on class inequality in Victorian England.

Story element	May represent
Eloi above ground in gardens	the wealthy who don't work
Morlocks underground with machines	industrial workers
Morlocks preying on Eloi	the danger of extreme inequality
Eloi helplessness	comfort without effort leading to weakness

KEY IDEA

Allegories use characters and events to comment on real ideas or society.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is an allegory?

2. What might the Morlocks represent?

3. What is Wells warning about?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Allegory uses story to comment on society.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.10 · L.7.1b, L.7.3a

Lesson 6.10: Combining with Conjunctions and Relative Clauses

I can combine sentences with conjunctions and relative clauses to show precise relationships.

GET READY

How can three short sentences become one clear sentence?

MODEL · COMBINE

The Morlocks lived underground. They were pale. They feared light.

1 Use a relative clause for one detail.

2 Join actions with and.

Model answer: The Morlocks, who lived underground, were pale and feared light.

Relationship	Tool	Example
addition	and, also; relative clause	Weena, who was gentle, followed him.
contrast	but, although, while	Although the Eloi were beautiful, they were helpless.
cause	because, since, so	Because the Morlocks feared light, he lit matches.
time	when, after, before, until	When night fell, the Eloi huddled together.

KEY IDEA

Combine to show the exact relationship; use relative clauses for extra detail.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Combine: Weena was small. She was brave.
2. Combine: The fire spread. The Morlocks fled. (cause)
3. Combine with a relative clause: The palace was a museum. It was ruined.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Combine to show exact relationships.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.11 · L.7.1a, L.7.3a

Lesson 6.11: Combining with Phrases

I can combine sentences using appositive, participial, and prepositional phrases.

GET READY

What's the shortest clear way to say the Traveller, a scientist, lit a match?

MODEL · COMBINE WITH PHRASES

The Traveller was a scientist. He studied the Morlocks. He hid behind a pillar.

1 Appositive: a scientist.

2 Participial: Hiding behind a pillar.

3 Main clause: the Traveller studied the Morlocks.

Model answer: Hiding behind a pillar, the Traveller, a scientist, studied the Morlocks.

KEY IDEA

Phrases combine sentences more tightly than conjunctions; check for clarity and correct punctuation.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Combine with an appositive: Weena was an Eloi girl. She gave him flowers.
2. Combine with a participial phrase: He carried a lever. He walked into the dark.
3. Combine with a prepositional phrase: He slept. He was by the fire.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Phrases combine sentences tightly.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.12 · L.7.3a, W.7.5

Lesson 6.12: Precision vs. Over-Combining

I can judge when combining improves clarity and when it creates confusing sentences.

GET READY

Is a longer sentence always better?

Combining can make writing smoother, but over-combined sentences pile up clauses until readers get lost. Aim for clarity: each sentence should have one main idea and clear relationships.

MODEL · OVER-COMBINED

The Traveller, who was exhausted after the long night, which had been terrifying because the Morlocks, who feared light, had surrounded him, finally reached the sphinx, which was open.

1 Too many nested clauses.

2 Split into two or three clear sentences.

Model answer: After a terrifying night surrounded by Morlocks, the exhausted Traveller finally reached the sphinx. To his surprise, its doors were open.

KEY IDEA

Combine for clarity, not length. If a sentence needs rereading, split it.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. When should you split a sentence?
2. What should each sentence have?
3. Is a longer sentence always better?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Combine for clarity, not length.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.13 · RL.7.2, RL.7.4

Lesson 6.13: Symbolism in the Palace and the Fire

I can analyze symbols and how they develop the novel's themes.

GET READY

What might a ruined museum full of forgotten machines symbolize?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapters 11–12: The Palace of Green Porcelain; In the Darkness

As you read: What does the Traveller find in the museum? What happens in the forest?

Symbol	Possible meaning
the ruined museum	lost human knowledge and achievement
rotting books	the decay of learning and curiosity
matches and fire	human ingenuity; also its danger when uncontrolled
the dark forest	fear, danger, the unknown
Weena's flowers	kindness and humanity in a fallen world

KEY IDEA

Symbols connect objects to themes; explain how each develops the novel's warning.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does the ruined museum suggest?
2. How is fire both helpful and harmful?
3. What theme do these symbols develop?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Symbols develop the novel's warning.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.14 · L.7.3, W.7.5

Lesson 6.14: Sentence Variety

I can vary sentence beginnings, lengths, and types to improve flow and emphasis.

GET READY

What happens when every sentence starts with “The”?

Strategy	Example
begin with a prepositional phrase	In the dark forest, the Traveller lit a fire.
begin with a participial phrase	Clutching Weena's hand, he ran.
begin with an adverb	Suddenly, the Morlocks appeared.
begin with a dependent clause	When the fire spread, chaos followed.
mix lengths	Long build-up sentences, then a short one. Like this.
mix types	simple, compound, complex, compound-complex

KEY IDEA

Vary beginnings, lengths, and types; use short sentences for emphasis.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Vary the start: The Traveller ran through the forest.
2. Strategy: Suddenly, the fire roared.
3. Why vary sentences?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Vary beginnings, lengths, and types.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.15 · L.7.1, L.7.3

Lesson 6.15: Parallel Structure

I can use parallel structure in lists, comparisons, and paired ideas.

WORDS TO KNOW

parallel structure — Using the same grammatical form for items in a list or pair.

GET READY

What sounds wrong in "The Eloi liked singing, to dance, and they played"?

Not parallel	Parallel
The Eloi liked singing, to dance, and they played.	The Eloi liked singing, dancing, and playing.
He was tired, hungry, and feeling afraid.	He was tired, hungry, and afraid.
Not only did he lose the machine but also Weena.	He lost not only the machine but also Weena.
The Morlocks worked underground, and the Eloi were living above.	The Morlocks worked underground, and the Eloi lived above.

KEY IDEA

Match forms in lists, pairs, and correlative constructions: nouns with nouns, -ing with -ing, clauses with clauses.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Make parallel: to read, writing, and to explore
2. Make parallel: He wanted fame, money, and to be respected.
3. Why use parallel structure?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Match grammatical forms in lists and pairs.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.16 · W.7.2, W.7.5, L.7.3

Lesson 6.16: Revising an Analytical Essay

I can write and revise an analytical essay using varied, clear, and parallel sentences.

GET READY

What is The Time Machine warning us about?

Write an analytical essay: What warning does Wells give through the Eloi and the Morlocks? Then revise using this unit's sentence skills.

Revision checklist	✓
Thesis states the warning clearly.	
Body paragraphs integrate evidence from Chapters 5–12.	
Sentences vary in beginnings, lengths, and types.	
Choppy sentences are combined; over-combined sentences are split.	
Lists and pairs use parallel structure.	
No dangling participles; phrases are punctuated correctly.	

KEY IDEA

Revise sentences for variety, clarity, and parallelism after the ideas are solid.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What should the thesis state?
2. Name a sentence revision strategy.
3. When do you revise sentences?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Strong ideas, then varied, clear, parallel sentences.

UNIT 6 REVIEW

Unit 6 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember...
6.1	Utopias and dystopias comment on real societies.
6.2	Independent clauses stand alone; dependent clauses don't.
6.3	Simple, compound, complex, compound-complex.
6.4	Sentence structure creates emphasis and rhythm.
6.5	Characters revise hypotheses as evidence changes.
6.6	Prepositional, appositive, participial, gerund, infinitive.
6.7	Participial phrases add detail; place them next to the subject.
6.8	Gerund and infinitive phrases can act as nouns.
6.9	Allegory uses story to comment on society.
6.10	Combine to show exact relationships.
6.11	Phrases combine sentences tightly.
6.12	Combine for clarity, not length.
6.13	Symbols develop the novel's warning.
6.14	Vary beginnings, lengths, and types.
6.15	Match grammatical forms in lists and pairs.
6.16	Strong ideas, then varied, clear, parallel sentences.

UNIT 7

Voices of the Harlem Renaissance

Historical context, poetry analysis, comparing sources and claims, evaluating evidence, integrating and citing sources, research, and synthesis.

In the 1920s, Harlem became the heart of a cultural rebirth that transformed American literature and music. In this unit you'll study the movement's history and voices, from Paul Laurence Dunbar's “We Wear the Mask” to the Great Migration, the Black press, and Alain Locke's The New Negro, and you'll learn the research skills of comparing, evaluating, integrating, and citing sources.

In this unit you will…

- Build historical context and discuss historical language respectfully.
- Analyze poetry and compare how sources shape information and claims.
- Evaluate reasons, evidence, and data; write arguments with counterclaims.
- Quote, paraphrase, and cite; assess credibility; develop research questions; write a synthesis essay.

WHY IT MATTERS

Evaluating sources, avoiding plagiarism, and synthesizing evidence are the foundation of every research project, and the Harlem Renaissance still shapes American music, poetry, and art.

UNIT VOCABULARY

renaissance	Rebirth.
Great Migration	The movement of millions of Black Southerners to other regions.
extended metaphor	A metaphor developed throughout a work.
plagiarism	Using others' words or ideas as your own.
synthesis	Combining ideas from several sources.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
7.1	Entering the Harlem Renaissance
7.2	Analyzing a Poem: Dunbar's “We Wear the Mask”
7.3	Comparing Sources: How Authors Shape Information
7.4	Comparing Claims Across Sources
7.5	The Great Migration: Causes and Effects
7.6	Evaluating Reasons and Evidence
7.7	Comparing Text and Data
7.8	Writing an Argument with Strong Evidence
7.9	The Black Press and Long-Passage Analysis
7.10	Quoting, Paraphrasing, and Citing Sources
7.11	Credibility and Accuracy of Sources
7.12	Research Questions
7.13	Locke's Argument
7.14	Planning a Synthesis Essay
7.15	Drafting the Synthesis Essay
7.16	Revising, Citing, and Publishing

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.1 · RI.7.2, RI.7.3

Lesson 7.1: Entering the Harlem Renaissance

I can explain the historical context of the Harlem Renaissance and discuss historical language respectfully.

WORDS TO KNOW

renaissance	A rebirth or revival, especially of art and learning.
historical context	The time, place, and events surrounding a text.

GET READY

What do you already know about jazz, Harlem, or the 1920s?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · Language of race (historical language in context) and the introduction

As you read: Why does the Reader begin with a note about language? What was Harlem like in the 1920s?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Harlem Renaissance

An original informational text

1 In the 1920s and early 1930s, the New York City neighborhood of Harlem became the center of an extraordinary flowering of African American art, music, literature, and ideas. This movement is now called the Harlem Renaissance. Renaissance means "rebirth."

2 Writers such as Langston Hughes, Zora Neale Hurston, Claude McKay, Countee Cullen, and Georgia Douglas Johnson published poems, stories, and novels that celebrated Black life and challenged racism. Musicians such as Duke Ellington and Louis Armstrong helped make jazz one of the most important art forms in America. Painters such as Aaron Douglas created bold images inspired by African art and modern design.

3 The movement grew out of the Great Migration, as hundreds of thousands of Black Southerners moved to Northern cities in search of opportunity. In Harlem, writers, thinkers, and artists found one another, and magazines and newspapers gave them places to publish.

4 The Harlem Renaissance did not end racism or segregation. But it changed how many Americans saw Black artists and how Black Americans expressed their own identity, and its influence can still be heard and read today.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

A Note on Historical Language

An original note for readers

1 Texts from the early 1900s, including titles such as The New Negro, use the word Negro. At that time, it was the respectful, standard term, and Black writers and organizations used it themselves; it was often capitalized as a sign of dignity. Today it is considered outdated, and most people say Black or African American.

2 When you quote or name historical works, use their original titles and words exactly. When you write in your own voice, use current, respectful terms. Understanding why language changes is part of understanding history.

KEY IDEA

Understand the historical context before analyzing texts; quote historical language accurately and write in current, respectful terms.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does renaissance mean?
2. Name two writers and one musician of the movement.
3. What movement helped create the Harlem Renaissance?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Context first; quote historical language accurately, write respectfully.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.2 · RL.7.4, RL.7.5, RL.7.2

Lesson 7.2: Analyzing a Poem: Dunbar's "We Wear the Mask"

I can analyze how a poem's form, imagery, and figurative language develop its meaning.

WORDS TO KNOW

extended metaphor	A metaphor developed throughout a work.
refrain	A repeated line or phrase in a poem.
rondeau	A French poetic form with fifteen lines, two rhymes, and a refrain.

GET READY

Have you ever smiled when you didn't feel like smiling? Why?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · Literary tradition and Paul Laurence Dunbar

As you read: What did Dunbar write about? How did later writers view him?

POEM

We Wear the Mask

Paul Laurence Dunbar (1895). Public domain.

We wear the mask that grins and lies,
It hides our cheeks and shades our eyes,—
This debt we pay to human guile;
With torn and bleeding hearts we smile,
And mouth with myriad subtleties.

Why should the world be over-wise,
In counting all our tears and sighs?
Nay, let them only see us, while
We wear the mask.

We smile, but, O great Christ, we cry
To thee from tortured souls arise.
We sing, but oh the clay is vile
Beneath our feet, and long the mile;
But let the world dream otherwise,
We wear the mask!

MODEL · ANALYZE THE EXTENDED METAPHOR

What is "the mask"?

1 Literal: a face covering.

2 Figurative: the cheerful appearance Black Americans were forced to show to survive racism.

3 Evidence: "grins and lies," "torn and bleeding hearts we smile."

Model answer: The mask is an extended metaphor for hiding pain behind a smile in a hostile society.

Dunbar uses the rondeau, a strict European form, with the refrain "We wear the mask." Some readers see the controlled form itself as another mask over intense emotion.

KEY IDEA

Analyze extended metaphors, refrains, and form to understand a poem's meaning.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does "guile" mean?
2. What is the refrain?
3. Why does the speaker say the world should not be "over-wise"?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Extended metaphor, refrain, and form create meaning.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.3 · RI.7.9, RI.7.6

Lesson 7.3: Comparing Sources: How Authors Shape Information

I can analyze how two authors writing about the same topic emphasize different evidence or interpretations.

WORDS TO KNOW

interpretation	An explanation of what facts mean.

GET READY

Can two accurate sources give different impressions of the same person?

SOURCE A

Source A: A Voice Ahead of His Time

An original informational text

Paul Laurence Dunbar (1872–1906), the son of formerly enslaved parents, became one of the first African American poets to win national fame. Though he is often remembered for poems written in dialect, much of his most powerful work, such as “We Wear the Mask” and “Sympathy,” is written in standard English and expresses the pain of living under racism. Many Harlem Renaissance writers saw Dunbar as an important forerunner.

SOURCE B

Source B: Fame and Its Limits

An original informational text

During his lifetime, Paul Laurence Dunbar's popularity with white audiences rested largely on his dialect poems, which some readers enjoyed as humorous portraits of plantation life. Dunbar himself was frustrated that critics praised these poems while overlooking his serious work. Some later writers criticized dialect poetry for reinforcing stereotypes, while others argued that Dunbar used it with skill and affection for Black speech.

	Source A	Source B
Focus	Dunbar's serious standard-English poems	his popularity and the dialect poems
Interpretation	a pioneering, powerful voice	a poet whose fame was limited by audience expectations
Shared facts	Dunbar became famous; wrote dialect and standard poems	Dunbar became famous; wrote dialect and standard poems

KEY IDEA

Accurate sources can differ in focus and interpretation; compare what each emphasizes and why.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does Source A emphasize?
2. What does Source B emphasize?
3. Do the sources contradict each other?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Sources can share facts but differ in focus and interpretation.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.4 · RI.7.8, RI.7.9

Lesson 7.4: Comparing Claims Across Sources

I can trace and compare claims across sources and decide which is better supported.

GET READY

If two sources disagree, how do you decide which to trust?

To compare claims: identify each claim, list the evidence for each, and evaluate whether the evidence is relevant and sufficient. Consider the author's purpose and expertise.

MODEL · COMPARE CLAIMS

Claim 1: Dialect poems reinforced stereotypes. Claim 2: Dunbar used dialect with skill and affection.

1 Both appear in Source B as views held by different critics.

2 Evidence needed: examples of the poems, Dunbar's own statements, audience responses.

3 Conclusion: both views have supporters; more evidence is needed to decide.

Model answer: A careful reader notes that the source reports a debate rather than settling it.

KEY IDEA

Identify claims, weigh evidence, consider authors, and acknowledge debates that sources don't settle.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What two claims about dialect does Source B report?
2. What evidence would help decide?
3. Should you choose a side without enough evidence?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Weigh claims by evidence; acknowledge unsettled debates.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.5 · RI.7.3, RI.7.1

Lesson 7.5: The Great Migration: Causes and Effects

I can analyze the causes and effects of a historical movement using evidence.

WORDS TO KNOW

push factor	A reason that drives people away from a place.
pull factor	A reason that attracts people to a place.
Jim Crow laws	Laws that enforced racial segregation in the South.

GET READY

What would make a family leave everything behind to move hundreds of miles?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · The Great Migration and Charles S. Johnson

As you read: Why did people leave the South? How did Johnson help writers?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Great Migration

An original informational text based on historical facts

1 Between about 1910 and 1970, roughly six million African Americans left the rural South and moved to cities in the North, Midwest, and West. Historians call this movement the Great Migration. In its first wave, from about 1910 to 1940, more than a million and a half people made the journey.

2 People left for many reasons. In the South, Jim Crow laws enforced segregation and denied Black citizens the right to vote. Violence, including lynching, terrorized communities. Many families worked as sharecroppers, renting land and paying with a share of their crops, a system that often kept them in debt. Around 1915, an insect called the boll weevil destroyed cotton crops across the region.

3 At the same time, Northern cities offered new possibilities. When World War I began, factories needed workers, and immigration from Europe slowed. Black newspapers such as the Chicago Defender published job listings and encouraged readers to come north.

4 Life in the North was not free of racism. Migrants faced discrimination in housing and jobs, and some cities saw violent attacks. Still, many found better wages, better schools for their children, and the chance to vote. In neighborhoods like Harlem in New York and the South Side of Chicago, new communities formed, and their energy helped fuel the Harlem Renaissance.

Push factors (South)	Pull factors (North)
Jim Crow segregation; denied voting	factory jobs (World War I)
violence and lynching	better wages
sharecropping debt	better schools; right to vote
boll weevil destroyed cotton	Black newspapers encouraging migration

KEY IDEA

Historical movements have multiple causes (push and pull) and multiple effects.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. About how many people moved in the whole Great Migration?
2. What is sharecropping?
3. Name one effect on Northern cities.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Push and pull factors; multiple causes and effects.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.6 · RI.7.8

Lesson 7.6: Evaluating Reasons and Evidence

I can evaluate whether an author's reasoning is sound and evidence is relevant and sufficient.

WORDS TO KNOW

sound reasoning	Logic that clearly connects evidence to a claim.
anecdote	A brief personal story used as evidence.

GET READY

Is "everyone I know loves jazz" good evidence?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Charles S. Johnson: Building a Movement

An original informational text based on historical facts

1 Charles S. Johnson was a sociologist, a scientist who studies how societies work. In 1923 he became the founding editor of Opportunity, the magazine of the National Urban League. Johnson believed that art and literature could change how Americans thought about race, and he used Opportunity to publish young Black writers and to award prizes for their work.

2 In 1924, Johnson organized a dinner at the Civic Club in New York, bringing together Black writers and white editors and publishers. Many historians see this event as a turning point: within a year, major magazines and publishing houses were seeking out Black writers. Johnson later became the first Black president of Fisk University, in 1946.

MODEL · EVALUATE A CLAIM

Claim: Charles S. Johnson helped launch the Harlem Renaissance.

1 Evidence 1: founded and edited Opportunity; published young writers; gave prizes. (relevant)

2 Evidence 2: organized the 1924 Civic Club dinner; publishers sought Black writers within a year. (relevant, specific)

3 Reasoning: connecting writers to publishers expanded their audience. (sound)

Model answer: The claim is well supported by relevant, specific evidence and sound reasoning.

Strong evidence	Weak evidence
specific facts, dates, statistics	vague generalizations
expert sources	unsupported opinions
relevant to the claim	off-topic details
enough to convince	a single anecdote

KEY IDEA

Evaluate relevance, sufficiency, and reasoning; watch for vague or unsupported evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What magazine did Johnson edit?
2. Why was the Civic Club dinner important?
3. Is “everyone I know loves jazz” strong evidence?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Evidence must be relevant, sufficient, and soundly connected.

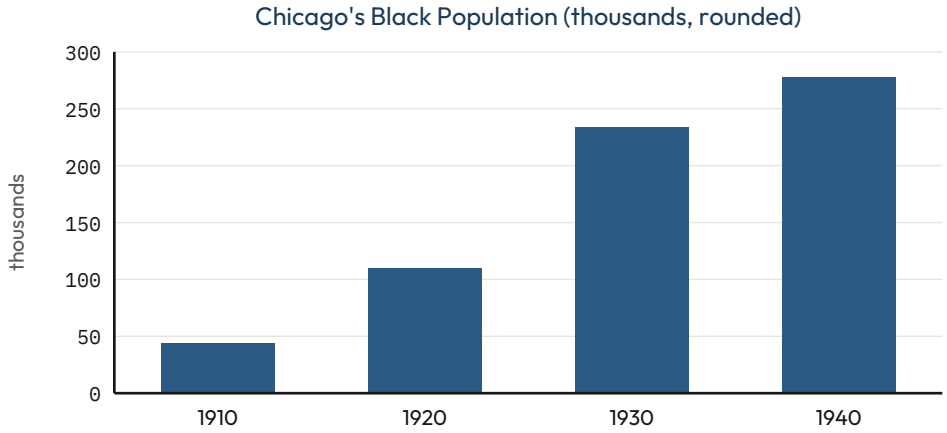
UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.7 · RI.7.7

Lesson 7.7: Comparing Text and Data

I can compare information in a text with information in a chart or graph.

GET READY

What can numbers show that words can't?



Approximate figures from U.S. Census counts, rounded to the nearest thousand.

MODEL · COMPARE TEXT AND GRAPH

How does the graph support "The Great Migration"?

1 Text: more than a million and a half people moved in the first wave.

2 Graph: Chicago's Black population grew from about 44,000 to about 278,000 between 1910 and 1940.

Model answer: The graph shows one city's dramatic growth, making the text's general claim concrete.

KEY IDEA

Compare what a text says with what data shows; explain how each adds to understanding.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. About how much did the population grow from 1910 to 1940?

2. Which decade saw the biggest increase?

3. What does the graph add to the text?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Data makes general claims concrete; text explains why.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.8 · W.7.1a, W.7.1b

Lesson 7.8: Writing an Argument with Strong Evidence

I can write an argument paragraph supported by relevant, sufficient evidence and sound reasoning.

GET READY

What was the most important cause of the Great Migration?

An argument states a claim, supports it with relevant, sufficient evidence from credible sources, explains with sound reasoning, and acknowledges a counterclaim.

MODEL · ARGUMENT PARAGRAPH

Claim: Economic opportunity was the strongest pull factor.

1 Evidence: wartime factories needed workers; better wages.

2 Data: Chicago's population grew fivefold.

3 Counterclaim: escaping violence and Jim Crow mattered greatly too.

4 Rebuttal: these pushed people out, but jobs determined where they went.

Model answer: A paragraph that weighs causes and supports a claim with evidence.

KEY IDEA

Claim, relevant and sufficient evidence, reasoning, and a counterclaim with rebuttal.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name the four parts.
2. Why include a counterclaim?
3. Where can evidence come from in this unit?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Argue with evaluated evidence and a counterclaim.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.9 · RI.7.2, RI.7.3

Lesson 7.9: The Black Press and Long-Passage Analysis

I can analyze how a long informational text develops central ideas through key individuals and events.

WORDS TO KNOW

mainstream	Belonging to the dominant or most widely accepted group.

GET READY

Why would a community build its own newspapers?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · Harlem, the Black press, and J. A. Rogers

As you read: What role did newspapers and magazines play? What did J. A. Rogers write about?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Black Press

An original informational text based on historical facts

1 In the early twentieth century, mainstream newspapers often ignored or misrepresented Black communities. In response, Black journalists built their own press.

2 The Chicago Defender, founded by Robert S. Abbott in 1905, became one of the most widely read Black newspapers in the country. Railroad porters carried copies south, where they were passed from hand to hand. The Crisis, the magazine of the NAACP edited by W. E. B. Du Bois, began in 1910 and published essays, news, and poetry, including early work by Langston Hughes.

3 Journalists such as J. A. Rogers, a Jamaican-born writer who wrote for the Pittsburgh Courier, researched and published the achievements of people of African descent throughout history, challenging claims that Black people had no history worth studying.

4 The Black press informed readers, organized communities, and gave Harlem Renaissance writers a place to be heard. Without it, the movement might never have reached a national audience.

MODEL · TRACE IDEAS THROUGH INDIVIDUALS

How do the individuals develop the central idea?

1 Abbott: built a national newspaper that spread news and encouraged migration.

2 Du Bois: published essays and poetry, including Hughes.

3 Rogers: researched and published Black history.

Model answer: Each individual shows a different way the Black press gave Black Americans a voice.

KEY IDEA

Trace how key individuals and events develop central ideas across a long text.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Who founded the Chicago Defender?
2. Who edited The Crisis?
3. What did J. A. Rogers challenge?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Key individuals develop central ideas.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.10 · W.7.8

Lesson 7.10: Quoting, Paraphrasing, and Citing Sources

I can quote and paraphrase sources accurately and cite them to avoid plagiarism.

WORDS TO KNOW

plagiarism	Presenting someone else's words or ideas as your own.
citation	Information that identifies a source.

GET READY

Is changing a few words in someone's sentence enough to make it yours?

When you use a source: quote exact words in quotation marks, or paraphrase completely in your own words and sentence structure. Either way, cite the source.

	Example
Original	"The Black press informed readers, organized communities, and gave Harlem Renaissance writers a place to be heard."
Plagiarism (patchwriting)	The Black press informed readers, organized people, and gave writers a place to be heard.
Paraphrase + citation	By publishing news and new writing, Black newspapers built communities and helped writers find readers ("The Black Press").
Quotation + citation	One historian notes that the Black press gave writers "a place to be heard" ("The Black Press").

For a works cited list, include the author (if known), title, publication, and date. Example: "The Black Press." Grade 7 ELA Textbook, VenvLearning, 2027.

KEY IDEA

Quote exactly or paraphrase completely, and always cite.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is patchwriting?
2. What goes in quotation marks?

3. Does a paraphrase need a citation?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Quote exactly, paraphrase completely, cite always.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.11 · W.7.8

Lesson 7.11: Credibility and Accuracy of Sources

I can assess the credibility and accuracy of print and digital sources.

WORDS TO KNOW

credible	Trustworthy and believable.
bias	A one-sided view that may affect fairness.

GET READY

Would you trust a website about jazz history with no author and lots of ads?

Question	Look for
Who created it?	named author or organization with expertise
When?	date of publication or update
Why?	purpose: inform, persuade, sell
Where does it get information?	cited sources, primary documents
Does it agree with other reliable sources?	corroboration
Is there bias?	one-sided language, missing perspectives

MODEL · EVALUATE

A museum website on Harlem Renaissance art vs an anonymous fan blog

1 Museum: experts, cited sources, educational purpose.

2 Blog: no author, no sources, mixed opinion.

Model answer: The museum site is more credible; the blog might be a starting point but needs checking.

KEY IDEA

Assess author, date, purpose, sources, corroboration, and bias.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. More credible: a university library page or a social media post?
2. Why check other sources?
3. What is bias?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Check author, date, purpose, sources, corroboration, bias.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.12 · W.7.7

Lesson 7.12: Research Questions

I can develop a focused research question and generate additional related questions.

GET READY

What about the Harlem Renaissance do you still wonder about?

A good research question is focused, open-ended, and researchable. As you learn, new questions appear; good researchers follow them.

Too broad	Focused
What was the Harlem Renaissance?	How did magazines like Opportunity and The Crisis help Harlem Renaissance writers reach readers?
Tell about jazz.	How did the Great Migration spread jazz from New Orleans to Chicago and New York?
Who was Zora Neale Hurston?	How did Hurston's work as a folklore collector shape her fiction?

KEY IDEA

Focused, open-ended, researchable questions; let new questions guide further research.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Broad or focused: “Music”
2. What makes a question researchable?
3. Why generate more questions?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Focused, open-ended, researchable questions.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.13 · RI.7.8, RI.7.6

Lesson 7.13: Locke's Argument

I can trace an author's argument and analyze how others responded to it.

GET READY

Can art change how people see themselves and others?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · The New Negro: Locke and Kellogg

As you read: What did Locke argue? Why was the book important?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Alain Locke and The New Negro

An original informational text based on historical facts

1 In March 1925, the magazine Survey Graphic, edited by Paul Kellogg, published a special issue devoted to Harlem. Its guest editor was Alain Locke, a philosopher at Howard University and the first African American Rhodes Scholar.

2 Later that year, Locke expanded the issue into a book, The New Negro: An Interpretation. It gathered essays, fiction, poetry, and art by many of the movement's leading figures.

3 In his essays, Locke argued that a new spirit of pride, self-respect, and creativity was rising among Black Americans, especially young people in cities. He believed that through art and literature, Black Americans could define themselves rather than be defined by others' stereotypes.

4 Not everyone agreed with Locke's emphasis on art. Some leaders argued that political and economic action, such as fighting for voting rights and better jobs, mattered more. The debate itself shows how many voices the Harlem Renaissance included.

MODEL · TRACE THE ARGUMENT

Locke's claim

1 Claim: a new spirit of pride and creativity was rising among Black Americans.

2 Reasoning: through art, Black Americans could define themselves instead of being defined by stereotypes.

3 Counterview: some leaders argued political and economic action mattered more.

Model answer: Locke argued for art's power; the debate shows the movement's many voices.

KEY IDEA

Trace the claim, reasoning, and responses; recognize that historical movements include debate.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Who edited Survey Graphic?
2. What was Locke's main claim?
3. What was the counterview?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Trace the argument and the debate around it.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.14 · W.7.2, W.7.9, W.7.8

Lesson 7.14: Planning a Synthesis Essay

I can plan a synthesis essay that combines evidence from multiple sources to answer a question.

GET READY

How did the Harlem Renaissance change the way Black Americans were seen and saw themselves?

A synthesis essay combines ideas from several sources into one argument. Organize by idea, not by source: each body paragraph makes one point and uses two or more sources.

Body paragraph idea	Possible sources
Art expressed truths hidden behind "the mask"	Dunbar poem; Sources A and B on Dunbar; Locke
New communities and institutions gave artists a voice	Great Migration; Black press; Johnson
Artists defined themselves despite criticism	Locke; Hughes sources (if researched); Reader

KEY IDEA

Organize by idea; each paragraph synthesizes two or more sources.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Organize by idea or by source?
2. How many sources per body paragraph?
3. What goes at the end?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Organize by idea; synthesize sources in each paragraph.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.15 · W.7.2, W.7.8, W.7.9

Lesson 7.15: Drafting the Synthesis Essay

I can draft a synthesis essay that integrates and cites multiple sources.

GET READY

How do you move between sources inside one paragraph?

MODEL · SYNTHESIS PARAGRAPH

Idea: Art expressed truths hidden behind “the mask.”

1 Topic sentence.

2 Source 1: Dunbar's poem: “With torn and bleeding hearts we smile.”

3 Source 2: Locke argued art let Black Americans define themselves.

4 Analysis connecting both.

Model answer: Harlem Renaissance artists used their work to reveal truths that had long been hidden. Decades earlier, Paul Laurence Dunbar described smiling “with torn and bleeding hearts,” capturing the pain behind a forced appearance. Alain Locke later argued that through art, Black Americans could “define themselves” rather than be defined by stereotypes (“Alain Locke and The New Negro”). Together, these voices show art moving from hiding pain to claiming identity.

KEY IDEA

Use transitions between sources, cite each, and explain how they connect.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Transition between sources
2. What follows evidence from two sources?
3. How do you cite in-text?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Integrate and connect sources with transitions and citations.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.16 · W.7.5, W.7.8

Lesson 7.16: Revising, Citing, and Publishing

I can revise my synthesis essay and prepare a works cited list.

WORDS TO KNOW

works cited — An alphabetical list of sources at the end of an essay.

GET READY

How can a reader check your sources?

Checklist	✓
Thesis answers the question.	
Each body paragraph synthesizes two or more sources.	
Quotations are exact; paraphrases are fully in my own words.	
Every source is cited in the text.	
Historical terms are quoted accurately; my own words are current and respectful.	
Works cited list is alphabetical and complete.	

KEY IDEA

Revise for synthesis and accuracy; complete the works cited list.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How is a works cited list ordered?
2. What must every paraphrase have?
3. Why cite?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise for synthesis; cite completely.

UNIT 7 REVIEW

Unit 7 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
7.1	Context first; quote historical language accurately, write respectfully.
7.2	Extended metaphor, refrain, and form create meaning.
7.3	Sources can share facts but differ in focus and interpretation.
7.4	Weigh claims by evidence; acknowledge unsettled debates.
7.5	Push and pull factors; multiple causes and effects.
7.6	Evidence must be relevant, sufficient, and soundly connected.
7.7	Data makes general claims concrete; text explains why.
7.8	Argue with evaluated evidence and a counterclaim.
7.9	Key individuals develop central ideas.
7.10	Quote exactly, paraphrase completely, cite always.
7.11	Check author, date, purpose, sources, corroboration, bias.
7.12	Focused, open-ended, researchable questions.
7.13	Trace the argument and the debate around it.
7.14	Organize by idea; synthesize sources in each paragraph.
7.15	Integrate and connect sources with transitions and citations.
7.16	Revise for synthesis; cite completely.

UNIT 8

Conventions and Word Choice

Commas, semicolons, colons, dashes, quotation and title punctuation, editing, roots, confusing words, spelling, and precise formal style, with The Time Machine, Chapters 13–15 and Epilogue.

The Time Traveller escapes the Morlocks, glimpses the end of the world, and returns home to skeptical friends. As his story ends, you'll sharpen the conventions that make writing clear and credible: advanced punctuation, careful editing, word roots and confusing words, spelling rules, and precise, formal style.

In this unit you will...

- Analyze the novel's climax, imagery, evidence, and open ending.
- Use commas, semicolons, colons, dashes, parentheses, ellipses, and capitalization correctly.
- Punctuate quotations and titles; edit for splices, fragments, and agreement in context.
- Use roots, confusable words, spelling rules, references, and formal concise style.

WHY IT MATTERS

Polished conventions make applications, emails, and reports credible; a single misplaced comma can change meaning.

UNIT VOCABULARY

semicolon	Joins related independent clauses.
colon	Introduces after a complete sentence.
comma splice	Two sentences joined by only a comma.
nuance	A subtle difference in meaning.
formal style	Academic language without slang.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
8.1	The Climax: The Trap of the White Sphinx

Lesson	Title
8.2	Comma Rules
8.3	Semicolons and Colons
8.4	Dashes, Parentheses, Ellipses, and Advanced Capitalization
8.5	Imagery and Mood in the Far Future
8.6	Quotations and Titles
8.7	Common Errors: Splices, Run-Ons, Fragments, and Agreement
8.8	Editing a Passage in Context
8.9	Evidence, Belief, and the Narrator
8.10	Greek and Latin Roots Review
8.11	Commonly Confused Words
8.12	Spelling Rules and Patterns
8.13	Open Endings and Symbols
8.14	Using Reference Tools for Precise Word Choice
8.15	Concise, Formal Style
8.16	Final Edit of a Portfolio Piece

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.1 · RL.7.3, RL.7.5

Lesson 8.1: The Climax: The Trap of the White Sphinx

I can analyze how an author builds and resolves a climax.

WORDS TO KNOW

climax	The point of greatest tension in a story.
resolution	How the central conflict is resolved.

GET READY

Why might the open doors of the sphinx be a bad sign?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapter 13: The Trap of the White Sphinx

As you read: Why are the sphinx's doors open? How does the Traveller escape?

The climax brings the central conflict, the Traveller vs the Morlocks and his struggle to recover the machine, to its highest point. Wells uses darkness, confinement, and physical struggle to make it intense.

MODEL · ANALYZE THE CLIMAX

Chapter 13

1. Setup: the doors are open; the machine is inside.
2. Twist: it's a trap; the doors close.
3. Struggle: in darkness, with no matches that will light, he fights off the Morlocks.
4. Resolution: he escapes on the machine.

Model answer: Wells builds tension through false hope, darkness, and close combat, then resolves it with a narrow escape.

KEY IDEA

Analyze how setup, twist, and struggle build to a climax, and how it is resolved.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why are the doors open?
2. Why can't he light his matches?

3. How is the conflict resolved?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Setup, twist, and struggle build the climax; the escape resolves it.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.2 · L.7.2a, L.7.2

Lesson 8.2: Comma Rules

I can use commas correctly in all common situations.

GET READY

Read aloud: “Let's eat Grandma!” vs “Let's eat, Grandma!” Why does the comma matter?

Rule	Example
introductory words, phrases, clauses	However, the machine was gone. / When night fell, the Morlocks came.
series of three or more	He carried matches, camphor, and a lever.
compound sentence (before FANBOYS)	The doors were open, but it was a trap.
nonessential (nonrestrictive) elements	Weena, who was frightened, clung to him.
coordinate adjectives	a dark, narrow tunnel
direct address	Tell us, Traveller, what you saw.
dates and places	On June 3, 2027, in Dayton, Ohio, ...
dialogue tags	“I'm back,” he said.

KEY IDEA

Commas mark introductions, series, compound sentences, nonessential elements, coordinate adjectives, direct address, dates and places, and dialogue.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Add commas: After the escape the Traveller rested.
2. Add commas: Wells who wrote the novel lived in England.
3. Add commas: Look Weena the stars!

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Know the comma rules and their purposes.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.3 · L.7.2

Lesson 8.3: Semicolons and Colons

I can use semicolons and colons correctly.

WORDS TO KNOW

semicolon	Joins two closely related independent clauses, or separates items in a complex list.
colon	Introduces a list, explanation, or quotation after a complete sentence.

GET READY

What's the difference between “He had one goal: escape.” and “He had one goal; escape”?

Mark	Use	Example
semicolon	join related independent clauses	The doors were open; the machine was inside.
semicolon	before a transition joining clauses	He struck a match; however, it wouldn't light.
semicolon	list items that contain commas	He visited London, England; Paris, France; and the year 802,701.
colon	after a complete sentence to introduce a list	He packed three things: matches, a camera, and a bag.
colon	after a complete sentence to introduce an explanation	He had one goal: escape.

WATCH OUT

A colon must follow a complete sentence. Wrong: “He packed: matches and a camera.” Right: “He packed two things: matches and a camera.”

KEY IDEA

Semicolons join related independent clauses; colons introduce after a complete sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Punctuate: The fire spread the Morlocks fled.

2. Correct? “He needed: light.”

3. Punctuate: It was dark however he kept going.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Semicolons join; colons introduce.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.4 · L.7.2, L.8.2a

Lesson 8.4: Dashes, Parentheses, Ellipses, and Advanced Capitalization

I can use dashes, parentheses, and ellipses for effect and apply advanced capitalization rules.

WORDS TO KNOW

dash	A mark (—) that sets off information dramatically or shows an interruption.
ellipsis	Three dots (...) that show omitted words or a pause.

GET READY

How does punctuation change the voice of a sentence?

Mark	Effect	Example
dash —	dramatic emphasis or interruption	The doors were open — a trap.
parentheses ( )	quiet, extra information	The Time Traveller (as we called him) smiled.
ellipsis ...	omission in a quote or a trailing pause	“I'll tell you everything, but first...”

Capitalize	Don't capitalize
regions: the South, the Midwest	directions: drive south
titles before names: Doctor Lanyon	titles used generally: the doctor
family words used as names: Is Grandma here?	with possessives: my grandma
specific courses: Algebra I, English	general subjects: math, science

KEY IDEA

Dashes emphasize, parentheses whisper, ellipses omit or pause. Capitalize specific names, not general words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which mark adds dramatic emphasis?
2. Capitalize? “We moved to the south.” (region)
3. Capitalize? “my uncle” vs “Uncle Ray”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Dashes emphasize, parentheses whisper, ellipses omit; capitalize specifics.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.5 · RL.7.4, RL.7.2

Lesson 8.5: Imagery and Mood in the Far Future

I can analyze how imagery creates mood and develops theme.

GET READY

What would the end of the world look like?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapter 14: The Further Vision

As you read: What does the Traveller see millions of years in the future? How does it make him feel?

In Chapter 14, the Traveller journeys to a distant future: a dim red sun, a cold beach, giant crab-like creatures, and finally an eerie darkness. Wells uses imagery of cold, silence, and fading light to create a mood of desolation.

Image	Mood / idea
huge red sun	the aging, dying solar system
cold, silent beach	loneliness, the end of life
giant crab creatures	menace; life reduced to strange forms
growing darkness	the end of everything

KEY IDEA

Imagery creates mood and suggests theme: here, the impermanence of humanity and life itself.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What color is the sun?
2. What mood does the far future create?
3. What theme does it suggest?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Imagery creates mood and suggests theme.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.6 · L.7.2

Lesson 8.6: Quotations and Titles

I can punctuate quotations and titles correctly.

GET READY

Is it The Time Machine or "The Time Machine"?

Italicize (underline by hand)	Quotation marks
books: The Time Machine	chapters: "The Further Vision"
novellas: A Christmas Carol	short stories: "The Translator"
magazines and newspapers: The Crisis	poems: "We Wear the Mask"
movies, albums, ships: Sea Venture	articles, songs, episodes

Quotation rule	Example
commas and periods inside	"I'm tired," he said. She called it a "fairy tale."
question/exclamation inside if part of the quote	"Where were you?" asked the Editor.
question/exclamation outside if not part of the quote	Did he really say "I traveled in time"?
quotation within a quotation: single marks	"He told me, 'The future is dark,'" said the narrator.

KEY IDEA

Long works: italics. Short works: quotation marks. Commas and periods go inside quotation marks.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Format: the poem Sympathy
2. Format: the novel Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde
3. Punctuate: Did you really call the story a fairy tale

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Italics for long works, quotation marks for short; punctuation inside.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.7 · L.7.1, L.7.2

Lesson 8.7: Common Errors: Splices, Run-Ons, Fragments, and Agreement

I can find and fix comma splices, run-ons, fragments, and agreement errors in context.

WORDS TO KNOW

comma splice	Two independent clauses joined only by a comma.

GET READY

What's wrong with “The Traveller returned, he was exhausted”?

Error	Example	Fixes
comma splice	He returned, he was exhausted.	He returned. He was exhausted. / He returned; he was exhausted. / He returned, and he was exhausted. / When he returned, he was exhausted.
run-on	He returned he was exhausted.	same fixes as above
fragment	Because the doors were open.	Because the doors were open, he went inside.
agreement	The box of matches were empty.	The box of matches was empty.

KEY IDEA

Fix splices and run-ons with a period, semicolon, comma + FANBOYS, or subordination. Complete fragments. Match subjects and verbs.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fix: Weena was lost, he searched.
2. Fix: After the fire.
3. Fix: Each of the guests were doubtful.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Fix splices, run-ons, fragments, and agreement.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.8 · L.7.1, L.7.2, W.7.5

Lesson 8.8: Editing a Passage in Context

I can edit a passage for multiple kinds of errors.

GET READY

How many errors can you find in a single paragraph?

EDITING PASSAGE

Edit Me: The Return

A passage with errors for editing

1 on a cold evening in march the time traveller limped into his dining room his guests stared at him his coat was torn and dusty and his face was pale

2 “what happened to you” asked the editor. the traveller didnt answer right away, he poured himself a glass of water drank it slowly and then he said “ill tell you everything but first i must eat”

Edit in passes: (1) sentence boundaries, (2) capitalization, (3) commas and other punctuation, (4) quotation marks and dialogue, (5) spelling, contractions, and confused words.

MODEL · EDIT PARAGRAPH 1

on a cold evening in march the time traveller limped into his dining room his guests stared at him his coat was torn and dusty and his face was pale

1 Sentence boundaries: three sentences.

2 Capitals: On, March, Time Traveller, His.

3 Commas: after March (introductory phrase); before and (compound).

Model answer: On a cold evening in March, the Time Traveller limped into his dining room. His guests stared at him. His coat was torn and dusty, and his face was pale.

KEY IDEA

Edit in passes; each pass catches a different kind of error.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Edit paragraph 2
2. How many sentences in paragraph 1?
3. Which pass catches “didnt”?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Edit in five passes.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.9 · RL.7.6, RI.7.8

Lesson 8.9: Evidence, Belief, and the Narrator

I can analyze how characters respond to evidence and how the narrator shapes the ending.

WORDS TO KNOW

skeptic	A person who doubts claims until there is evidence.

GET READY

If a friend told you they had traveled in time, what proof would you want?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Chapter 15 and After the Story

As you read: How do the guests react to the story? What evidence does the Traveller offer?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Evidence and Belief

An original informational commentary

1 When the Time Traveller finishes his story, most of his guests do not believe him. The Medical Man examines the strange white flowers the Traveller brought back and admits he cannot identify them, yet he still doubts the tale. The Editor jokes that it is a pity the Traveller is not a writer of stories.

2 Their reaction raises an old question: what kind of evidence is enough to believe something extraordinary? Many scientists follow a principle often summed up as “extraordinary claims require extraordinary evidence.” Two unusual flowers and a battered machine are intriguing, but they are not proof.

3 Yet the narrator is not so sure. He returns the next day and sees the Traveller preparing to leave again, carrying a small camera and a knapsack, perhaps to bring back the proof his friends demanded.

KEY IDEA

Compare how characters weigh evidence; notice how the narrator's view differs from the skeptics'.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What evidence does the Traveller show?
2. How does the Editor respond to the story?
3. How does the narrator differ from the other guests?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Weigh evidence; the narrator leaves the question open.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.10 · L.7.4b

Lesson 8.10: Greek and Latin Roots Review

I can use Greek and Latin roots to determine the meanings of academic and scientific words.

GET READY

What do chronology, synchronize, and chronic share?

Root	Meaning	Examples
chron	time	chronology, chronic, synchronize
temp / tempor	time	temporary, contemporary, tempo
scope	look, see	telescope, microscope, periscope
phon	sound	telephone, symphony, phonetic
vid / vis	see	evidence, visible, revise
cred	believe	credible, incredible, credentials
dict	say	predict, contradict, dictionary
bio	life	biology, biography, antibiotic
geo	earth	geology, geography
-logy	study of	biology, chronology

MODEL · ANALYZE

incredible

1 in- = not.

2 cred = believe.

3 -ible = able to be.

Model answer: not able to be believed

KEY IDEA

Roots unlock academic and scientific vocabulary; combine prefix + root + suffix.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. contemporary
2. evidence
3. chronology

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Roots unlock academic and scientific words.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.11 · L.7.1, L.7.2b

Lesson 8.11: Commonly Confused Words

I can correctly use commonly confused words.

GET READY

Does the story “affect” or “effect” you?

Words	Meaning	Example
affect / effect	verb: influence / noun: result	The story affected me. Its effect was strong.
accept / except	receive / excluding	He accepted the flowers. Everyone except the narrator doubted.
than / then	comparison / time	Bigger than a house. Then he left.
lose / loose	misplace / not tight	Don't lose the key. The bolt was loose.
principal / principle	school head or main / rule or belief	the principal reason; a scientific principle
complement / compliment	completes / praise	The colors complement each other. She gave a compliment.
their / there / they're	possessive / place / they are	They're putting their coats over there.
its / it's	possessive / it is	It's late; the machine lost its lever.

KEY IDEA

Learn the meaning of each confusable; test contractions by expanding them.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. The fire had a terrible (affect/effect).
2. Everyone (accept/except) the narrator laughed.
3. The machine was faster (than/then) light. (in the story)

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Know the meanings of confusable words.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.12 · L.7.2b

Lesson 8.12: Spelling Rules and Patterns

I can spell correctly by applying spelling rules for prefixes and suffixes.

GET READY

Why is it “beginning” but “opening”?

Rule	Examples
Double the final consonant (one-syllable or stressed last syllable, short vowel + one consonant) before a vowel suffix	stop → stopped; begin → beginning; but open → opening (stress not on last syllable)
Drop silent e before a vowel suffix; keep it before a consonant suffix	hope → hoping; hope → hopeful
Change y to i (consonant + y) except before -ing	carry → carried; carry → carrying
Adding a prefix doesn't change the base spelling	mis + spell → misspell; un + necessary → unnecessary
-able vs -ible: -able usually follows a complete word	comfortable, readable vs visible, credible

KEY IDEA

Apply doubling, drop-e, y-to-i, and prefix rules; check uncertain words in a dictionary.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Add -ing: refer
2. Add -ness: happy

3. Prefix: dis + satisfied

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Apply spelling rules; check with a dictionary.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.13 · RL.7.2, RL.7.5

Lesson 8.13: Open Endings and Symbols

I can analyze an open ending and the symbolism of a final image.

WORDS TO KNOW

open ending	An ending that leaves important questions unanswered.

GET READY

Why might an author choose not to tell readers what happened to the main character?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Time Machine Reader · Epilogue

As you read: What happens to the Time Traveller? What does the narrator keep?

The Traveller leaves on another journey and never returns. The narrator keeps two strange white flowers, shriveled now, and reflects that even when intelligence and strength are gone, gratitude and tenderness lived on in a human heart.

MODEL · ANALYZE THE FINAL SYMBOL

The flowers

1 They came from Weena, a gift of affection.

2 They are evidence the narrator can't explain.

3 They suggest kindness survives even in a decaying world.

Model answer: The flowers symbolize hope and human tenderness that outlast even civilization's decline.

KEY IDEA

Open endings invite readers to think; final images often carry the theme.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What happens to the Traveller?
2. What does the narrator keep?
3. What do the flowers symbolize?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Open endings invite thought; final symbols carry theme.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.14 · L.7.4c, L.7.4d, L.7.5c

Lesson 8.14: Using Reference Tools for Precise Word Choice

I can use a dictionary and thesaurus to choose words with precise meanings and connotations.

WORDS TO KNOW

nuance	A subtle difference in meaning or feeling.

GET READY

Why might a thesaurus suggestion be the wrong word?

A thesaurus offers synonyms, but synonyms differ in nuance and connotation. After choosing a synonym, check its dictionary definition and example sentences to be sure it fits.

MODEL · CHOOSE PRECISELY

The guests were ___ about the story. (thesaurus for “doubtful”: skeptical, suspicious, cynical, dubious)

1 skeptical: wanting evidence before believing (fits).

2 suspicious: thinking someone is guilty or dishonest (too strong).

3 cynical: believing people act only selfishly (wrong idea).

Model answer: skeptical

KEY IDEA

Thesaurus for options; dictionary for precision; context for the final choice.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which fits a scientist who wants proof: skeptical or cynical?
2. Why check the dictionary after the thesaurus?
3. What is nuance?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Thesaurus for options, dictionary for precision.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.15 · W.7.1d, W.7.2e, L.7.3a

Lesson 8.15: Concise, Formal Style

I can write concisely in a formal style appropriate to academic writing.

WORDS TO KNOW

formal style	Language without slang, contractions, or casual phrases, suited to academic writing.

GET READY

Would you write a school essay the way you text a friend?

Informal or wordy	Formal and concise
Wells's book is super creepy and kind of sad.	Wells's novel is unsettling and melancholy.
The reason why is because the Morlocks are scary.	The Morlocks are frightening.
In my opinion, I think the ending is good.	The ending is effective because...
The Traveller doesn't really get along with the guests.	The Traveller struggles to persuade his skeptical guests.
At this point in time	now

KEY IDEA

Formal academic writing: no slang, fewer contractions, precise words, no padding.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Formal: kind of sad

2. Concise: The reason why is because

3. Remove: In my opinion, I think

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Formal, concise, precise academic style.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.16 · W.7.5, L.7.1–3

Lesson 8.16: Final Edit of a Portfolio Piece

I can edit a complete piece of writing for conventions and style.

GET READY

Which piece from this year deserves a final polish?

Final edit checklist	✓
Sentence boundaries: no splices, run-ons, or fragments.	
Commas, semicolons, colons, and dashes are correct.	
Titles and quotations are punctuated correctly.	
Capitalization is correct.	
Confused words and spelling are correct.	
Words are precise; style is formal and concise.	

KEY IDEA

A final edit checks every convention and sharpens style.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name one item on the checklist.

2. Why edit in passes?

3. What does formal style avoid?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Final edit: conventions and style.

UNIT 8 REVIEW

Unit 8 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
8.1	Setup, twist, and struggle build the climax; the escape resolves it.
8.2	Know the comma rules and their purposes.
8.3	Semicolons join; colons introduce.
8.4	Dashes emphasize, parentheses whisper, ellipses omit; capitalize specifics.
8.5	Imagery creates mood and suggests theme.
8.6	Italics for long works, quotation marks for short; punctuation inside.
8.7	Fix splices, run-ons, fragments, and agreement.
8.8	Edit in five passes.
8.9	Weigh evidence; the narrator leaves the question open.
8.10	Roots unlock academic and scientific words.
8.11	Know the meanings of confusable words.
8.12	Apply spelling rules; check with a dictionary.
8.13	Open endings invite thought; final symbols carry theme.
8.14	Thesaurus for options, dictionary for precision.
8.15	Formal, concise, precise academic style.
8.16	Final edit: conventions and style.

UNIT 9

Capstone: Style, Revision, and Reflection

Style and tone, transitions and organization, revising arguments, and a portfolio review, with The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader.

In this final unit, you'll study how Langston Hughes, Georgia Douglas Johnson, and Elise Johnson McDougald shaped their words, and you'll shape your own: developing voice, organizing ideas, and revising an argument. You'll finish by gathering your best work, reflecting on how far you've come, and showing what you know on the Year-End Test.

In this unit you will...

- Analyze style, tone, and mood, and compare styles across time.
- Use transitions and text structures to write cohesive paragraphs.
- Revise arguments for claims, counterclaims, and cited evidence.
- Assemble, reflect on, and present a writing portfolio.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every strong writer revises; reflecting on your growth helps you set goals for next year.

UNIT VOCABULARY

style	A writer's distinctive use of language.
tone	The writer's attitude.
mood	The reader's feeling.
transition	A word showing how ideas connect.
rebuttal	A response to a counterclaim.
portfolio	A collection of best work with reflections.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
9.1	Langston Hughes and the Sound of a Poem

Lesson	Title
9.2	Tone and Mood
9.3	Developing Your Own Voice
9.4	Comparing Styles Across Time
9.5	Georgia Douglas Johnson: Building a Community
9.6	Transitions That Show Relationships
9.7	Text Structures
9.8	Cohesive Paragraphs
9.9	Elise Johnson McDougald: An Argument from Evidence
9.10	Revising Claims and Counterclaims
9.11	Revising Evidence and Citations
9.12	Revision Workshop
9.13	Dreams and Masks: A Conversation Across Generations
9.14	Year in Review: Reading Literature and Information
9.15	Year in Review: Language and Conventions
9.16	Portfolio Reflection and Presentation

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.1 · RL.7.4, RL.7.5

Lesson 9.1: Langston Hughes and the Sound of a Poem

I can analyze how a poet's choices about rhythm, repetition, and word choice create a distinctive style.

WORDS TO KNOW

style	The distinctive way a writer uses words, sentences, and sound.
refrain	A line or phrase repeated in a poem or song.

GET READY

Can a poem sound like music? How?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · Langston Hughes

As you read: What did Hughes write about? What makes his poems sound like music?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Langston Hughes: Poet of the People

An original informational text

1 Langston Hughes (1901–1967) was one of the most important voices of the Harlem Renaissance. He grew up mostly in the Midwest, and as a young man he worked many jobs, including as a sailor and a busboy, while he wrote poetry. His first book of poems, The Weary Blues, appeared in 1926.

2 Hughes wanted his poems to sound like the people he knew. He borrowed the rhythms of jazz and the blues, repeated lines the way a singer repeats a chorus, and used everyday words instead of fancy ones. His tone could be proud, playful, sorrowful, or defiant, sometimes all in a single poem.

3 Some critics of his time thought that poetry should be formal and elevated. Hughes disagreed. He believed that the lives, speech, and music of ordinary Black Americans were worthy subjects for art, and generations of later writers followed his lead.

Style element	What to look for	Possible effect
rhythm	a steady beat; lines that swing like a song	musical, energetic
repetition / refrain	words or lines that return	emphasis; a chorus feeling
diction	everyday or formal words	conversational or elevated
line length	short, broken lines or long flowing ones	pauses, emphasis, speed

KEY IDEA

Style is the sum of a writer's choices: rhythm, repetition, diction, and line shape. Name the choice, then explain its effect.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What musical forms influenced Hughes?
2. What is a refrain?
3. Why did Hughes use everyday words?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Style = rhythm, repetition, diction, and line shape; explain effects.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.2 · RL.7.4, L.7.5

Lesson 9.2: Tone and Mood

I can identify tone and mood and explain how word choice creates them.

WORDS TO KNOW

tone	The writer's attitude toward the subject.
mood	The feeling a text creates in the reader.

GET READY

Can the same event be described in a happy way and a bored way?

PAIRED TEXTS

Two Reviews of the Same Concert

Original texts

Review A. The trumpets blazed. For two hours the band tore through song after song, and the crowd could not sit still. When the final note rang out, the whole hall rose to its feet, roaring. I walked home humming, my heart still keeping time.

Review B. The concert lasted two hours. The band played fourteen songs, mostly fast ones, and the trumpets were loud. At the end, the audience stood and applauded. Tickets were twenty dollars.

Tone words	
positive	joyful, admiring, hopeful, playful, nostalgic, celebratory
negative	bitter, mocking, gloomy, defiant, resentful, anxious
neutral	objective, matter-of-fact, informative, detached

MODEL · COMPARE TONE

Reviews A and B

1 A: “blazed,” “tore through,” “roaring,” “heart still keeping time.”

2 B: plain facts: numbers, “loud,” “applauded.”

Model answer: A's tone is enthusiastic and celebratory; B's is matter-of-fact and detached.

KEY IDEA

Tone is the writer's attitude; mood is the reader's feeling. Both are built from word choice and detail.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Tone of Review B
2. Which words in A create excitement?
3. Tone vs mood?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Tone = attitude; mood = feeling; both come from word choice.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.3 · W.7.3d, L.7.3

Lesson 9.3: Developing Your Own Voice

I can make deliberate style choices to create a consistent voice and tone in my writing.

WORDS TO KNOW

voice	The personality of a writer that comes through on the page.

GET READY

If someone read your writing without your name, would they know it was yours?

Voice comes from the same tools as style: diction, sentence length and rhythm, figurative language, and details you choose to notice. A strong voice is consistent: the tone does not wander by accident.

Choice	Plain version	With voice
specific detail	It was hot.	The sidewalk could have fried an egg, and the dog refused to leave the shade.
sentence rhythm	I ran. I was late. The bus left.	I ran, backpack thumping, as the bus coughed and pulled away without me.
figurative language	The room was quiet.	The room was as quiet as a held breath.

KEY IDEA

Choose details, rhythm, and diction on purpose, and keep the tone consistent.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name two tools that create voice.
2. What makes a voice consistent?
3. Add voice: The food was good.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Voice comes from purposeful, consistent choices.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.4 · RL.7.9, RL.7.4

Lesson 9.4: Comparing Styles Across Time

I can compare how two poets from different times address a similar theme with different styles.

GET READY

How might a poet in 1895 and a poet in 1925 write differently about the same struggle?

POEM

We Wear the Mask

Paul Laurence Dunbar (1895). Public domain.

We wear the mask that grins and lies,
It hides our cheeks and shades our eyes,—
This debt we pay to human guile;
With torn and bleeding hearts we smile,
And mouth with myriad subtleties.

Why should the world be over-wise,
In counting all our tears and sighs?
Nay, let them only see us, while
We wear the mask.

We smile, but, O great Christ, we cry
To thee from tortured souls arise.
We sing, but oh the clay is vile
Beneath our feet, and long the mile;
But let the world dream otherwise,
We wear the mask!

Dunbar wrote “We Wear the Mask” in 1895 using a formal rhyme scheme, elevated diction, and a refrain. Thirty years later, Hughes often wrote in free or blues-shaped verse with everyday speech. Both poets address the experience of Black Americans facing racism, but their tones and styles differ.

	Dunbar, “We Wear the Mask”	Hughes (poem from your Reader)
form	rhymed, regular stanzas	
diction	formal, elevated (“myriad subtleties”)	
tone	sorrowful, bitter, hidden pain	
theme	hiding pain to survive	

KEY IDEA

Compare form, diction, and tone, then explain how each poet's style shapes the theme.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does “the mask” stand for?
2. Describe Dunbar's diction.
3. One way Hughes's style differs

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Compare form, diction, and tone to show how style shapes theme.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.5 · RI.7.2, RI.7.3

Lesson 9.5: Georgia Douglas Johnson: Building a Community

I can determine central ideas and analyze how an informational text develops them.

WORDS TO KNOW

salon	A regular gathering of writers, artists, and thinkers to share work and ideas.

GET READY

Why might writers need each other?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · Georgia Douglas Johnson

As you read: What did Johnson write? Why was her home important?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Georgia Douglas Johnson and the S Street Salon

An original informational text based on historical facts

1 Georgia Douglas Johnson (1880–1966) was a poet, playwright, and teacher who lived in Washington, D.C. Her first book of poems, The Heart of a Woman, was published in 1918, and she went on to publish several more collections and to write many plays.

2 Johnson is also remembered as a host. For years, on Saturday evenings, writers and artists gathered at her home on S Street to read their work aloud, trade ideas, and encourage one another. Young writers such as Langston Hughes and Jean Toomer were among the visitors. As a result, her home became one of the meeting places that connected the Harlem Renaissance to Washington.

3 In contrast to some writers who became famous quickly, Johnson spent much of her life balancing her writing with work and family. Nevertheless, she kept writing, and her support for other artists helped the movement grow.

MODEL · FIND THE CENTRAL IDEA

"Georgia Douglas Johnson and the S Street Salon"

1 ¶1: she was a poet and playwright.

2 ¶2: her home became a gathering place for writers.

3 ¶3: she kept writing and supported others despite challenges.

Model answer: Johnson contributed to the Harlem Renaissance both through her own writing and by building a community that supported other artists.

KEY IDEA

Trace how each paragraph adds to the central idea.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where did Johnson live?
2. What happened at her home?
3. Name a visitor.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Trace each paragraph's contribution to the central idea.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.6 · W.7.2c, W.7.1c

Lesson 9.6: Transitions That Show Relationships

I can use transitions to show precise relationships between ideas.

WORDS TO KNOW

transition A word or phrase that shows how ideas connect.

GET READY

What's the difference between “and then” and “as a result”?

Relationship	Transitions
addition	also, in addition, furthermore, moreover
contrast	however, in contrast, on the other hand, nevertheless
cause / effect	as a result, therefore, consequently, because of this
example	for example, for instance, such as
time / sequence	first, later, meanwhile, eventually, finally
conclusion	in conclusion, overall, ultimately

MODEL · FIND TRANSITIONS

“Georgia Douglas Johnson and the S Street Salon”

1 “As a result” (¶2): cause/effect.

2 “In contrast” (¶3): contrast.

3 “Nevertheless” (¶3): contrast (despite a challenge).

Model answer: Each transition tells the reader exactly how the ideas relate.

KEY IDEA

Choose the transition that names the exact relationship, not just “and” or “also.”

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Relationship of “consequently”

2. Transition for contrast

3. Join: It rained. The game was canceled.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Pick the transition that names the relationship.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.7 · RI.7.5, W.7.2a

Lesson 9.7: Text Structures

I can identify and use organizational structures that fit my purpose.

WORDS TO KNOW

text structure	The way a text is organized: chronological, compare/contrast, cause/effect, problem/solution.

GET READY

How would you organize an essay about why jazz spread?

Structure	Purpose	Signal words
chronological	tell events in time order	first, then, in 1925, later
compare / contrast	show similarities and differences	both, similarly, in contrast, unlike
cause / effect	explain why something happened	because, as a result, led to
problem / solution	present a problem and fixes	the problem is, one solution, to solve

MODEL · IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE

"Georgia Douglas Johnson and the S Street Salon," paragraph 2

1 Writers gathered at her home on Saturday evenings.

2 "As a result," her home became a meeting place for the movement.

Model answer: cause/effect

KEY IDEA

Match the structure to your purpose; use signal words so readers can follow it.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Structure for "How life changed after the Great Migration"

2. Structure for a biography
3. Signal words for problem/solution

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Match structure to purpose; signal it.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.8 · W.7.2a, W.7.2c

Lesson 9.8: Cohesive Paragraphs

I can write cohesive paragraphs with clear topic sentences, connected support, and concluding sentences.

WORDS TO KNOW

cohesion	The way sentences in a paragraph connect and stay focused.

GET READY

What makes a paragraph feel like it holds together?

Part	Job
topic sentence	states the paragraph's main point
support	evidence and explanation, connected by transitions
concluding sentence	wraps up or links to the next idea

MODEL · REVISE FOR COHESION

Johnson wrote poems. Hughes visited. She lived in D.C. People read their work.

1 Add a topic sentence.
2 Order the ideas logically.
3 Add transitions and a conclusion.

Model answer: Georgia Douglas Johnson's home was a hub for writers. She lived in Washington, D.C., where she hosted gatherings on Saturday evenings. At these meetings, writers such as Langston Hughes read their work aloud. As a result, her home helped connect a community of artists.

KEY IDEA

Topic sentence + connected support + concluding sentence = cohesion.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does a topic sentence do?
2. How do transitions help cohesion?
3. Concluding sentence job

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Topic sentence, connected support, concluding sentence.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.9 · RI.7.8, RI.7.6

Lesson 9.9: Elise Johnson McDougald: An Argument from Evidence

I can trace an author's argument and evaluate how well evidence supports the claims.

WORDS TO KNOW

double burden	Facing two kinds of unfair treatment at once.

GET READY

How can observation of real lives be evidence?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · Elise Johnson McDougald

As you read: What did McDougald argue? What kinds of evidence did she use?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Elise Johnson McDougald

An original informational text based on historical facts

[1] Elise Johnson McDougald (1885–1971) was an educator and writer in New York City. She worked to improve schools and job opportunities for Black children and women, and she became one of the first Black women to serve as a principal in the city's public schools.

[2] Her essay “The Task of Negro Womanhood” appeared in The New Negro (1925), the influential collection edited by Alain Locke. In it, she describes the many kinds of work Black women were doing in Harlem, from homes and factories to offices and professions, and argues that they faced the double burden of racism and sexism. She supports her claims with observations of real working lives rather than with stereotypes.

Remember the Unit 7 note on historical language: use the original title when you name McDougald's essay, and current terms when you write in your own voice.

KEY IDEA

Trace the claim, the evidence, and whether the evidence is relevant and sufficient.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where did McDougald's essay appear?
2. What was the “double burden”?
3. What kind of evidence did she use?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Trace the claim and evaluate the evidence.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.10 · W.7.1a, W.7.1b, W.7.5

Lesson 9.10: Revising Claims and Counterclaims

I can revise an argument to strengthen its claim and respond to a counterclaim.

WORDS TO KNOW

rebuttal	A response showing why a counterclaim is weaker or incomplete.

GET READY

What's wrong with answering an opposing argument with "That is wrong"?

DRAFT ARGUMENT

Student Draft: Every Student Should Learn an Instrument

An original student draft for revision

1 Every student should learn to play an instrument. Music is fun. Lots of people like music. My cousin plays drums.

2 Also learning music helps your brain. Also it teaches you to work hard. Also you can play in a band with friends and that is fun too.

3 Some people say music lessons cost too much. That is wrong. In conclusion, every student should learn an instrument.

Weak	Strong
Every student should learn an instrument. (no reasons)	Every student should learn an instrument because music strengthens the brain, builds discipline, and connects people.
That is wrong.	Some argue that lessons cost too much. However, many schools lend instruments and offer free group classes, so cost need not be a barrier.

KEY IDEA

A strong claim previews reasons. A fair counterclaim is acknowledged, then rebutted with evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Revise the claim
2. Why is “That is wrong” weak?
3. What is a rebuttal?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Strong claims preview reasons; rebut counterclaims with evidence.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.11 · W.7.1b, W.7.8

Lesson 9.11: Revising Evidence and Citations

I can revise an argument to add relevant evidence and cite sources correctly.

GET READY

Which is more convincing: “Music helps your brain” or a statistic from a study?

DRAFT ARGUMENT

Student Draft: Every Student Should Learn an Instrument

An original student draft for revision

1 Every student should learn to play an instrument. Music is fun. Lots of people like music. My cousin plays drums.

2 Also learning music helps your brain. Also it teaches you to work hard. Also you can play in a band with friends and that is fun too.

3 Some people say music lessons cost too much. That is wrong. In conclusion, every student should learn an instrument.

Revision move	Example
replace general statements with specific evidence	Researchers have found links between music training and memory skills (cite the source).
introduce evidence with a signal phrase	According to the National Association for Music Education, ...
explain how the evidence supports the claim	This suggests that practicing music may help students in other subjects too.
cite every borrowed idea	Use the source's author or organization and title; list it in Works Cited.

WATCH OUT

Never invent statistics. If you don't have a real source, say so and find one, or use reasoning instead.

KEY IDEA

Specific, cited evidence + explanation is stronger than general opinion.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a signal phrase?
2. Why explain evidence?
3. Can you invent a statistic?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use specific, cited evidence and explain it.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.12 · W.7.1, W.7.5

Lesson 9.12: Revision Workshop

I can revise a complete argument or research piece for claim, evidence, organization, and style.

GET READY

Which essay from this year could be even stronger?

Revision checklist	✓
Claim is clear and previews reasons.	
Each body paragraph has a topic sentence and relevant, cited evidence.	
Evidence is explained.	
Counterclaim is acknowledged and rebutted.	
Transitions show precise relationships.	
Style is formal, concise, and consistent.	
Conclusion follows from the argument.	

KEY IDEA

Revise for big ideas first (claim, evidence, organization), then style, then conventions.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What do you revise first?
2. Name one checklist item.
3. Revising vs editing?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise big ideas, then style, then conventions.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.13 · RL.7.9, RL.7.2

Lesson 9.13: Dreams and Masks: A Conversation Across Generations

I can analyze how later writers respond to and build on earlier writers.

GET READY

How do writers "talk" to the writers who came before them?

READ IN YOUR READER

The Genius of the Harlem Renaissance Reader · Paul Laurence Dunbar and Langston Hughes (review)

As you read: What does each writer want readers to see? Does Hughes's speaker hide his feelings or reveal them?

Dunbar's speakers often hide their pain behind a mask. Many Hughes poems, written a generation later, speak openly: proud, hopeful, or defiant. Reading them together shows a literary conversation, as later writers build on, answer, or push against earlier ones.

KEY IDEA

Compare what each writer reveals or hides, and how the change reflects its time.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does Dunbar's mask hide?
2. How do many Hughes poems differ?
3. What is a literary conversation?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Later writers answer earlier ones.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.14 · RL.7.1–6, RI.7.1–8

Lesson 9.14: Year in Review: Reading Literature and Information

I can apply this year's reading skills to new texts.

GET READY

Which reading skill from this year do you use most?

Skill	Ask yourself
cite evidence	Which exact words prove my answer?
theme / central idea	What is the message? How does it develop?
character and plot	How do setting, events, and characters shape each other?
word choice and tone	Which words create this feeling or attitude?
structure	How does this part fit the whole?
point of view	Whose view is this? What do they know or not know?
argument	What's the claim? Is the evidence relevant and sufficient?

KEY IDEA

Every reading skill begins with a question and ends with evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a theme?
2. What makes evidence sufficient?
3. Name our four anchor readers.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Every reading skill: question, then evidence.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.15 · L.7.1–6

Lesson 9.15: Year in Review: Language and Conventions

I can apply this year's grammar, usage, punctuation, and vocabulary skills.

GET READY

Which grammar rule finally "clicked" for you this year?

Topic	Remember
phrases and clauses	Independent clauses stand alone; dependent clauses need help.
sentence types	simple, compound, complex, compound-complex
modifiers	Place modifiers next to what they modify.
commas, semicolons, colons	Know each rule and its purpose.
pronouns and verbs	Clear antecedents; consistent tense.
vocabulary	context, roots, connotation, figurative language
style	precise, concise, formal when needed

KEY IDEA

Conventions and word choice make ideas clear and credible.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Sentence type: When the bell rang, we left, and the hall emptied.
2. Fix: Hanging on the wall, I saw the painting.
3. benevolent: bene =

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Clear conventions and precise words.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.16 · W.7.10, SL.7.4, SL.7.6

Lesson 9.16: Portfolio Reflection and Presentation

I can select, reflect on, and present my best work from the year.

WORDS TO KNOW

portfolio — A collection of a writer's best work with reflections.

GET READY

What piece of writing are you proudest of this year?

Portfolio	Include
best narrative or creative piece	final draft + one-sentence reflection
best analytical essay	final draft + what you revised
best argument or research piece	final draft + sources
growth piece	an early piece and a later one side by side
reflection letter	your growth, goals for Grade 8

Presentation: choose one piece to read aloud or summarize (3–5 minutes). Speak clearly, make eye contact, and explain why you chose it.

KEY IDEA

Reflection turns finished work into learning: what you did, how you grew, and what's next.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a portfolio?
2. Name one presentation skill.
3. Why include a growth piece?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Select, reflect, present.

UNIT 9 REVIEW

Unit 9 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember...
9.1	Style = rhythm, repetition, diction, and line shape; explain effects.
9.2	Tone = attitude; mood = feeling; both come from word choice.
9.3	Voice comes from purposeful, consistent choices.
9.4	Compare form, diction, and tone to show how style shapes theme.
9.5	Trace each paragraph's contribution to the central idea.
9.6	Pick the transition that names the relationship.
9.7	Match structure to purpose; signal it.
9.8	Topic sentence, connected support, concluding sentence.
9.9	Trace the claim and evaluate the evidence.
9.10	Strong claims preview reasons; rebut counterclaims with evidence.
9.11	Use specific, cited evidence and explain it.
9.12	Revise big ideas, then style, then conventions.
9.13	Later writers answer earlier ones.
9.14	Every reading skill: question, then evidence.
9.15	Clear conventions and precise words.
9.16	Select, reflect, present.

Glossary

abstract noun	Names an idea.
active voice	The subject does the action: Hyde struck the man.
adaptation	A version of a story changed for a new medium, such as a play or film.
adjective clause	A dependent clause that modifies a noun, often beginning with who, which, or that.
adverb	A word that modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb, telling how, when, where, or to what extent.
adverb clause	A dependent clause that modifies a verb, telling when, why, or how, often beginning with because, when, although, if.
affix	A prefix or suffix.
allegory	A story representing larger ideas.
alliteration	Repetition of beginning consonant sounds.
ambiguous	Having more than one possible meaning.
analogy	A comparison of two pairs of words that share the same relationship.
anecdote	A brief personal story used as evidence.
antecedent	The noun a pronoun refers to.
appositive	Renames a noun.
archaic	No longer in common use.
argument	Writing that states a claim and supports it with reasons and evidence.
bias	A one-sided view that may affect fairness.
central idea	A main idea that the author develops in a text.
citation	Information that identifies a source.
claim	An arguable statement that answers the question.
clause	A group of words with a subject and a verb.
climax	The point of greatest tension in a story.
close reading	Careful analysis of a short passage.
cohesion	The way sentences in a paragraph connect and stay focused.
collective noun	Names a group: family, crowd.
colon	Introduces after a complete sentence.

comma splice	Two sentences joined by only a comma.
comparative	Compares two.
compound adjective	Two or more words joined to act as one adjective, often hyphenated.
compound noun	Made of two or more words: counting-house, door-knocker, schoolboy.
compound-complex sentence	Two or more independent clauses and at least one dependent clause.
concession	Admitting that part of the opposing view is valid.
concrete noun	Names something you can perceive with the senses: chain, turkey.
conflict	A struggle between opposing forces.
connotation	The feeling a word carries.
coordinate adjectives	Equal adjectives separated by a comma.
coordinating conjunction	Joins equal parts: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so.
correlative conjunctions	Work in pairs: either…or, neither…nor, both…and, not only…but also.
counterclaim	An opposing argument.
credible	Trustworthy and believable.
dangling modifier	A modifier with no clear word to describe.
dash	A mark (—) that sets off information dramatically or shows an interruption.
delayed revelation	Withholding key information until late in a story.
denotation	A word's dictionary meaning.
dependent clause	Cannot stand alone.
diction	An author's choice of words.
dimension	A measurable extent, such as length, width, height, or time.
direct characterization	The author tells us what a character is like.
direct object	Receives the action of the verb.
director	The person who decides how a story is staged or filmed.
double burden	Facing two kinds of unfair treatment at once.
dramatic irony	Readers know more than a character.
duality	Having two sides.
dystopia	An imagined society where something has gone terribly wrong.
ellipsis	Three dots (…) that show omitted words or a pause.

epistolary elements	Letters or documents included within a story.
etymology	The origin and history of a word.
exemplar	A known sample used for comparison.
extended metaphor	A metaphor developed over several sentences.
forensic	Related to scientific methods used to investigate crimes.
foreshadowing	Hints about later events.
formal style	Academic language without slang.
frame narrative	A story within a story.
gerund	An -ing verb used as a noun.
glossary	A list of difficult words and their meanings, like the Words to Know boxes in your Reader.
Gothic	A style of fiction with dark settings, mystery, and a mood of horror or dread.
Great Migration	The movement of millions of Black Southerners to other regions.
historical context	The time, place, and events surrounding a text.
hyperbole	Deliberate exaggeration for effect.
hypothesis	A proposed explanation that can be tested.
indefinite pronoun	A pronoun that doesn't refer to a specific person or thing: everyone, each, someone, several.
independent clause	Can stand alone.
indirect characterization	The author shows character through actions, speech, appearance, and others' reactions.
indirect object	Tells to whom or for whom the action is done.
infinitive	To + a verb, used as a noun, adjective, or adverb.
integrate	Weave quotations smoothly into your own sentences.
intensive pronoun	Ends in -self/-selves and emphasizes a noun: Utterson himself went.
interjection	Expresses sudden emotion.
interpretation	An explanation of what facts mean.
inverted pyramid	News structure that puts the most important information first.
Jim Crow laws	Laws that enforced racial segregation in the South.
joint possession	Two or more people owning the same thing: Bob and Mrs. Cratchit's home.
lead	The first sentence of a news story; answers who, what, when, where, why, and how.

limited third-person	A narrator outside the story who follows one character's thoughts and knowledge.
mainstream	Belonging to the dominant or most widely accepted group.
misplaced modifier	A modifier placed too far from the word it describes, causing confusion.
mood	The form of a verb that shows the speaker's attitude: stating, commanding, asking, wishing, or imagining.
motif	A repeated image, idea, or symbol that supports a theme.
motivation	The reason a character acts.
mystery	A genre built around a puzzle or crime that characters try to solve.
narrator	The voice that tells a story. Dickens's narrator often speaks directly to the reader.
nominalization	Turning a verb or adjective into a noun, such as generous → generosity.
novella	A story longer than a short story but shorter than a novel.
nuance	A subtle difference in meaning.
object of the preposition	The noun or pronoun that ends a prepositional phrase.
objective	Neutral; without personal opinions or judgments.
objective summary	A neutral, concise retelling.
open ending	An ending that leaves important questions unanswered.
pacing	The speed at which events unfold in a story.
parallel structure	Same grammatical form in a series.
parallelism	Repeating a grammatical pattern.
participle	A verb form used as an adjective: frightened, glowing.
passive voice	The subject receives the action.
perfect tense	Uses has/have/had/will have + past participle to show completed action relative to another time.
phrase	A group of related words without both a subject and a verb.
plagiarism	Using others' words or ideas as your own.
plotline	A sequence of events involving one group of characters.
portfolio	A collection of best work with reflections.
position	The author's stance on an issue.
predicate noun	Follows a linking verb and renames the subject.

preposition	A word showing a relationship between a noun and another word: in, on, through, during, beneath.
pronoun case	The form a pronoun takes depending on its job: subjective, objective, or possessive.
pull factor	A reason that attracts people to a place.
push factor	A reason that drives people away from a place.
ragged school	A free school for the poorest children in Victorian Britain.
read-aloud prose	Prose written to be heard as well as read. Dickens performed this story on stage.
reasoning	Explanation of how the evidence supports the claim.
rebuttal	A response that shows why the counterclaim is weaker.
red herring	A misleading clue.
redundancy	Saying the same thing twice.
reflexive pronoun	Ends in -self/-selves and refers back to the subject: He hurt himself.
reformer	A person who works to improve society.
refrain	A repeated line or phrase in a poem.
reliable narrator	A narrator whose account readers can trust.
renaissance	Rebirth.
resolution	How the central conflict is resolved.
respectability	A reputation for proper, socially acceptable behavior.
rondeau	A French poetic form with fifteen lines, two rhymes, and a refrain.
root	A word part that carries the core meaning.
salon	A regular gathering of writers, artists, and thinkers to share work and ideas.
science fiction	Fiction that imagines how science and technology might change the world.
self-experimentation	A scientist testing a procedure or substance on themselves.
semicolon	Joins related independent clauses.
sensory details	Details that appeal to sight, sound, touch, taste, or smell.
shift	An unnecessary change in tense, voice, or mood within a sentence or paragraph.
simile	A comparison using like or as.
skeptic	A person who doubts claims until there is evidence.
social commentary	Writing that criticizes or comments on society.

sound reasoning	Logic that clearly connects evidence to a claim.
spacetime	Space and time combined into a single four-dimensional framework.
structure	How a text is organized into parts.
style	A writer's distinctive use of language.
subjunctive	The mood for wishes and contrary-to-fact ideas.
subordinating conjunction	Begins a dependent clause: because, although, when, if, since, while.
subplot	A secondary plotline.
subtext	The meaning beneath what a character actually says.
superlative	Compares three or more: fastest, most careful.
suspense	A feeling of tense uncertainty about what will happen.
symbol	A person, object, or event that stands for a larger idea.
synthesis	Combining ideas from several sources.
testimony	A formal statement of what someone witnessed.
text structure	The way a text is organized: chronological, compare/contrast, cause/effect, problem/solution.
textual evidence	Quotations or details from the text that support a claim.
theme	A message about life.
thesis	An essay's central claim.
tone	The author's attitude.
transition	A word showing how ideas connect.
utopia	An imagined perfect society.
vague	Not clear or specific.
voice	The personality of a writer that comes through on the page.
wordiness	Using more words than needed.
works cited	An alphabetical list of sources at the end of an essay.

Grade 7 English Language Arts

Student Textbook · 2026–2027

A full year of Grade 7 reading, writing, and language. Lessons pair the Core Knowledge Readers with close reading, vocabulary, grammar, and writing instruction, so students learn to read carefully, think deeply, and write with purpose.

This Student Textbook teaches every lesson: the big idea, key vocabulary, models and examples, and a short set of practice problems to check understanding. It pairs with the Student Workbook and the Teacher Edition.

INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 Language and Meaning
02 Long Passages and the Power of Nouns
03 Mystery and Grammar
04 Craft and Perspective
05 Modifiers and Precise Description
06 Sentence Craft
07 Voices of the Harlem Renaissance
08 Conventions and Word Choice
09 Capstone: Style, Revision, and Reflection

IN THIS BOOK

- Clear lesson goals: “I can…” statements
- Key vocabulary with student-friendly definitions
- Models, examples, and Key Idea summaries
- A study guide and glossary for every unit

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook

You are holding this book



Workbook



Teacher Edition

Each lesson has the same number in all three books, and every day of the year is mapped to its lesson in the VenvLearning planner.